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IMPACT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) ON BUSINESS OPERATIONS (A STUDY OF ABEEBI FOOD PROCESSING, OSOGBO, OSUN STATE, NIGERIA)

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Abstract
Artificial Intelligence (AI) has emerged as a transformative force in modern business operations, significantly influencing productivity, efficiency, and ethical considerations. This study examined the impact of AI on the business operations of Abeebi Food Processing, Osogbo, Osun State, Nigeria. The research employed a descriptive survey research design. The population of the study comprised 95 staff members of Abeebi Food Processing, while Krejcie and Morgan's (1970) sample size determination table was used, which recommended a sample size of 76 employees. A convenience sampling technique was adopted due to the accessibility of participants and the time-bound nature of the research. The study employed the Pearson Product-Moment Correlation Coefficient (PPMCC) and Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) to analyze the relationship between technological integration, ethical considerations, and moral considerations in AI implementation. Results indicate that AI integration significantly enhances operational efficiency ($\beta = 0.832$, $p < 0.05$) and positively influences ethical and moral considerations ($\beta = 0.727$, $p < 0.05$). The findings suggest that AI adoption improves productivity, and organizations must navigate ethical dilemmas, workforce displacement concerns, and transparency challenges. The study recommends the adoption of ethical AI frameworks, continuous employee training, and regulatory policies to optimize AI implementation in food processing.

***Keywords*:** Artificial, Business, Ethical and Moral, Food, Intelligence, Technological.

Introduction

Integrating Artificial Intelligence (AI) into business operations has become a transformative force across various industries. As organizations increasingly adopt AI technologies, the implications for efficiency, decision-making, and competitive advantage are profound. AI encompasses a range of technologies, including machine learning, natural language processing, and robotics, which enable businesses to analyze vast amounts of data, automate processes, and enhance customer interactions (Chui et al., 2018). Studies indicate that organizations leveraging AI are improving operational efficiencies and redefining their business models. For instance, a report by McKinsey and Company (2021) highlights that companies integrating AI into their operations can achieve productivity gains of up to 40%. This is mainly due to AI's capability to streamline workflows, reduce human errors,

and facilitate faster decision-making processes. Also, AI encompasses a range of technologies, including machine learning, natural language processing, and robotics, which can streamline production processes, optimize supply chains, and enhance customer engagement (Smith & Johnson, 2024). According to Adeyemo and Ojo (2023), the adoption of AI in food processing not only increases productivity but also enhances product quality and safety, thereby meeting consumer expectations. Furthermore, AI facilitates data-driven decision-making, allowing businesses to adapt swiftly to market changes (Ogunleye, 2023). Furthermore, AI technologies assist in predictive analytics, allowing businesses to anticipate market trends and consumer behaviours (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018).

The impact of AI is particularly evident in sectors such as retail, healthcare, and manufacturing. In retail, AI-driven recommendation systems enhance customer experience and increase sales through personalized marketing strategies (Kumar et al., 2021). In healthcare, AI applications range from diagnostic tools that analyze medical images to virtual health assistants that provide patient support, significantly improving patient outcomes and operational efficiencies (Topol, 2019). Similarly, AI-powered robots and automation systems are revolutionizing production lines in manufacturing, leading to enhanced productivity and reduced operational costs (Bhardwaj et al., 2020).

Despite the potential benefits, the adoption of AI also poses challenges, including ethical considerations, workforce displacement, and data privacy concerns. Organizations must navigate these complexities to harness the full potential of AI while ensuring responsible use (Brynjolfsson & McAfee, 2014). As AI technologies evolve, understanding their impact on business operations will be crucial for organizations seeking to remain competitive in an increasingly digital landscape.

Integrating Artificial Intelligence (AI) into business operations has become a pivotal factor in enhancing productivity and efficiency across various industries, including food manufacturing. Abeebi Food Manufacturing, a key player in Nigeria's food sector, stands to benefit significantly from AI technologies. As the demand for food products increases, innovative solutions to streamline operations, improve quality control, and enhance customer engagement become critical. This study aims to explore the impact of AI on the operational processes of Abeebi Food processing, focusing on its potential to transform traditional practices into more efficient, data-driven methodologies.

This study aims to explore the multifaceted impact of AI on business operations, examining both the opportunities and challenges presented by AI integration. By analyzing recent developments and case studies across different industries, this research will contribute to understanding how AI is shaping the future of business.

Statement of the Problem

As businesses incorporate Artificial Intelligence (AI) technologies more and more into their operations, it is critical to comprehend the complex effects of these advancements. AI can potentially improve decision-making, expedite procedures, and increase efficiency, but it is unclear how much of these advantages will materialize. Current literature indicates a growing division between

organizations that effectively leverage AI and those that struggle with implementation (Chui et al., 2021; McKinsey & Company, 2021).

Additionally, the rapid pace of technological advancement raises questions about the adaptability of existing business models and the readiness of organizations to embrace AI-driven change (Bhardwaj et al., 2020). Moreover, there is a lack of comprehensive understanding regarding the specific operational areas most affected by AI integration. For instance, while some studies highlight improvements in customer service and supply chain management, others point to challenges in employee engagement and skill mismatches (Kumar et al., 2021). This inconsistency in findings underscores the necessity for a more nuanced exploration of AI's impact on business operations.

In Nigeria, where the food processing sector plays a crucial role in economic development, the application of AI technologies is particularly relevant. Many food manufacturing businesses, including Abeebi Food Manufacturing, struggle to adapt to AI technologies due to limited expertise, financial constraints, and resistance to change. There is a need to explore the specific impact AI has on business operations in Abeebi Food processing, address these challenges, and determine the overall effectiveness of AI in enhancing productivity.

Ultimately, this study aims to address the knowledge gap regarding how AI technologies are reshaping business operations, identifying both opportunities for improvement and the challenges organizations must navigate. By examining recent developments and case studies, this research aims to provide a clearer picture of the implications of AI integration for Abeebi Food processing, Osogbo, Osun State.

Purpose of the Study

The primary objectives of this study are to:

i. Assess the current state of Technological integration in Abeebi Food Processing, Osogbo, Osun State.

ii. Investigate ethical and moral considerations associated with AI implementation.

Hypotheses of the Study

The study will test the following hypotheses:

H_{01}: The integration of technology in Abeebi Food Manufacturing does not significantly improve operational efficiency.

H_{02}: Ethical and moral concerns negatively affect AI implementation and employee productivity in food processing.

Review of Related Literature

The literature on AI in business operations highlights its transformative potential. According to Mahmood (2025), AI technologies can enhance supply chain management, improve quality control,

and facilitate data-driven decision-making in the food industry. Additionally, studies indicate that organizations that embrace AI experience significant cost savings and improved customer satisfaction (Mahmood, 2025). However, challenges such as resistance to change and ethical dilemmas remain prevalent (Sharma et al., 2024). This literature review examines the current state of research on the impact of AI on business operations, highlighting its benefits, challenges, and implications for various industries.

One of the most frequently cited advantages of AI is its ability to enhance operational efficiency. AI technologies, such as automation and machine learning, can streamline processes, reduce human error, and significantly increase productivity. For instance, McKinsey (2021) reports that companies implementing AI can achieve productivity gains of up to 40% in specific functions, such as manufacturing and customer service. Similarly, Brynjolfsson and McAfee (2014) emphasize that AI-driven automation allows businesses to allocate human resources to more strategic tasks, thereby maximizing overall productivity. AI also plays a crucial role in enhancing decision-making processes (Abiodun et al, 2022). By leveraging data analytics and predictive modeling, organizations can derive insights that inform strategic choices. Davenport and Ronanki (2018) note that AI enables businesses to analyze vast datasets rapidly, allowing for more informed and timely decisions. This capability is particularly valuable in sectors such as finance, where AI algorithms can assess risks and opportunities more effectively than traditional methods (Kumar et al., 2021).

Furthermore, AI technologies, such as recommendation systems and chatbots, have transformed customer interactions by enabling personalized experiences. In retail, for instance, AI-driven recommendation engines analyze consumer behavior to suggest products tailored to individual preferences, resulting in higher sales and improved customer satisfaction (Chui et al., 2021). Moreover, AI-powered customer service solutions can provide immediate support, enhancing the overall customer experience (Bhardwaj et al., 2020).

Despite the benefits, the adoption of AI raises concerns about workforce displacement. As AI technologies automate routine tasks, there is a growing fear that many jobs may become obsolete. A report by McKinsey (2021) estimates that up to 30% of the global workforce could be displaced by automation by 2030. This transition necessitates a rethinking of workforce training and development to equip employees with the skills needed to thrive in an AI-driven environment. Also, the ethical implications of AI integration warrant significant attention. Concerns regarding data privacy, algorithmic bias, and accountability are prevalent in the literature. Brynjolfsson and McAfee (2014) argue that organizations must navigate the ethical landscape carefully to avoid potential pitfalls associated with AI deployment. Furthermore, a lack of transparency in AI decision-making processes can lead to mistrust among consumers and stakeholders (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018). In addition, successful AI implementation is not without its challenges. Many organizations struggle with data quality, integration issues, and a lack of technical expertise. According to a study by Chui et al. (2021), businesses often face hurdles in aligning AI initiatives with overarching strategic goals, leading to underwhelming results. The complexity of AI technologies requires organizations to invest in infrastructure and talent to fully leverage their potential.

In manufacturing, AI-powered robotics and automation have revolutionized production processes, leading to increased output and reduced costs (Bhardwaj et al., 2020). Conversely, industries such as finance and retail have harnessed AI primarily for data analytics and customer engagement, demonstrating its versatility across different contexts (Kumar et al., 2021). Organizations that effectively integrate AI into their operations can gain a competitive edge by improving efficiency and enhancing customer experiences. The resource-based view (RBV) suggests that AI capabilities can serve as a unique resource that is difficult for competitors to replicate, leading to sustained competitive advantage (Mikalef et al., 2021).

Also, AI fosters a culture of innovation by enabling organizations to experiment with new business models and services. This adaptability is crucial in today's fast-paced business environment, where companies must continuously evolve to meet changing consumer demands (Bag et al., 2021). Therefore, the impact of AI on business operations can be measured through various performance metrics, including productivity, customer satisfaction, and financial performance. Organizations must establish clear Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) to assess the effectiveness of AI initiatives and make data-driven adjustments as needed (Chatterjee et al., 2021).

Technological Integration of AI in Business Operations

The integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) into business operations has transformed various sectors, enhancing efficiency, decision-making, and customer engagement.

AI technologies enable the automation of repetitive tasks, allowing organizations to streamline operations and reduce human error. This automation leads to increased productivity and cost savings, as businesses can allocate resources more effectively (Smith et al, 2024). For instance, AI-driven chatbots enhance customer service by providing instant responses to inquiries, thereby improving customer satisfaction (Bag et al., 2021). Also, AI systems can analyze vast amounts of data to uncover insights that inform strategic decision-making. By leveraging machine learning algorithms, businesses can predict market trends, optimize supply chains, and personalize marketing efforts (Mikalef & Gupta, 2021). This data-driven approach enhances the agility of organizations, enabling them to respond swiftly to changing market conditions (Denicolai et al., 2021). Moreover, AI technologies facilitate personalized customer interactions by analyzing user behavior and preferences. This capability allows businesses to tailor their offerings, improving customer engagement and loyalty (Chatterjee et al., 2021). For example, e-commerce platforms utilize AI to recommend products based on previous purchases, enhancing the shopping experience.

Ethical Considerations in AI Integration

One of the foremost ethical concerns in AI deployment is algorithmic bias, which can lead to unfair treatment of individuals based on race, gender, or socioeconomic status. AI systems often learn from historical data that may reflect existing prejudices, perpetuating discrimination in hiring, lending, and law enforcement (Kriebitz & Lütge, 2020). Organizations must prioritize fairness in AI algorithms to ensure equitable outcomes and uphold moral standards in their operations. Also, the opacity of AI decision-making processes poses ethical dilemmas regarding accountability.

When AI systems make autonomous decisions, it becomes challenging to trace the rationale behind those decisions, raising questions about who is responsible for potential harms caused by AI (Martin, 2019). Businesses must implement transparent practices and establish accountability frameworks to address these concerns, ensuring that ethical considerations are embedded in AI governance. Furthermore, AI systems often require vast amounts of data, raising significant privacy concerns. The collection and processing of personal data can infringe on individuals' rights if not managed ethically. Organizations must navigate the moral implications of data usage, ensuring compliance with privacy regulations and fostering trust with consumers (Thiebes et al., 2020). Ethical data practices are essential for maintaining a positive corporate reputation and safeguarding stakeholder interests.

Moral Responsibilities of Organizations

Businesses that use AI technologies are morally obligated to interact with all relevant parties, such as staff members, clients, and the general public. This interaction promotes an inclusive culture and guarantees that various viewpoints are considered when making decisions (Bietti, 2020). Enterprises can connect their AI strategy with society's values and ethical norms by prioritizing stakeholder interests. Furthermore, in order to handle new issues, continuous ethical evaluations are required due to the dynamic nature of AI technology. In order to adjust to new advancements and societal expectations, organizations should set up procedures for routinely assessing the ethical implications of their AI systems (Ryan & Stahl, 2021). Thanks to this proactive strategy, businesses can handle the challenges of integrating AI while maintaining their moral obligations. Organizations must also promote moral AI development methods in the sector. This involves working with researchers, politicians, and other interested parties to create norms and rules that encourage the responsible use of AI (Floridi et al., 2021). Companies may help create a more just and equitable technological environment by supporting moral AI practices.

Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework for this study on the Impact of Artificial Intelligence on Business Operations in Abeebi Food Manufacturing is primarily anchored in the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) developed by Davis (1989). TAM provides a robust theoretical basis for understanding how users perceive and accept new technologies, emphasizing the roles of perceived ease of use and perceived usefulness in technology adoption. According to Venkatesh and Davis (2000), the success of technology adoption largely depends on these two key constructs. This framework is particularly relevant in AI integration in business operations, where user acceptance can significantly influence implementation success. AI adoption in business operations hinges on whether employees find these technologies beneficial and user-friendly, making TAM an appropriate model for evaluating adoption in Abeebi Food processing.

TAM posits that two key factors significantly affect users' decisions to accept and use technology**:** Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU) and Perceived Usefulness (PU)**.** Perceived Ease of Use refers to the degree to which a person believes that using a particular technology would be free of effort (Davis, 1989). In the context of Abeebi Food Manufacturing, if employees perceive AI systems as easy to

use, they are more likely to embrace these technologies. This perception can be influenced by factors such as the level of training provided, technical support availability, and the intuitiveness of the AI systems implemented (Park, 2009). An AI interface that is complex and difficult to navigate may create resistance among employees, thereby slowing adoption (Chuttur, 2009).

On the other hand, perceived Usefulness (PU) denotes the extent to which an individual believes technology will enhance job performance (Venkatesh & Bala, 2008). In a manufacturing setting, if employees believe that AI will improve operational efficiency, quality control, or productivity, they are more likely to accept and utilize AI tools in their daily tasks (Al-Gahtani, 2016). AI applications can enhance business operations by significantly improving and streamlining processes. These include predictive maintenance, automated quality inspections, and data-driven decision-making procedures (Dwivedi et al., 2019). However, if workers do not see the advantages of using AI, they might oppose it, restricting the possible increases in productivity and efficiency (Wirtz & Weyerer, 2019).

The application of TAM in this study allows for a structured analysis of how employees at Abeebi Food Processing perceive AI technologies. The study focuses on perceived usefulness and simplicity of use to investigate the elements that either help or impede the adoption of AI. To ensure that the study captures the complex relationships between operational effectiveness and technological acceptance, the framework will direct the development of research questions and data-gathering techniques. Comprehending these dynamics is essential for effectively incorporating AI into the company, allowing management to remove obstacles and increase staff interest in AI-powered business solutions.

Methodology

This study adopted a descriptive survey research design to explore the impact of Artificial Intelligence (AI) on business operations at Abeebi Food Processing, located in Osogbo, Osun State, Nigeria. The descriptive approach was chosen because it allows for a systematic investigation of opinions, behaviours, and patterns related to AI adoption within a real-life business context. This method was particularly suitable for understanding how AI technologies are integrated into operational systems and how they influence ethical and moral decision-making within a medium-sized enterprise.

The study population comprised all 95 employees of Abeebi Food Processing. To ensure a manageable yet representative sample, the Krejcie and Morgan (1970) sample size determination table was used, which recommended a sample size of 76 employees. A convenience sampling technique was applied due to the accessibility of participants and the time-bound nature of the research. While convenience sampling limits the ability to generalize findings to the entire population, it allowed for the collection of valuable insights from willing and available respondents who have first-hand experience with AI processes in the organization.

Primary data were collected using a structured questionnaire, which was divided into four main sections: demographic information, technological integration, ethical considerations, and moral implications of AI. The questionnaire incorporated standardized measurement scales adapted from previous validated studies, including Technological Integration from Olanipekun et al. (2019), Ethical Considerations from Klettner et al. (2019), and Moral Considerations from McKinsey & Company (2021). Responses were measured on a 5-point Likert scale, ranging from strongly disagree (1) *to* strongly agree (5*)*, enabling the capture of varying degrees of perception and agreement.

For data analysis, the study employed both descriptive and inferential statistical tools. Descriptive statistics were used to summarize the demographic characteristics and item responses. To test the relationships between variables, the Pearson Product-Moment Correlation Coefficient (PPMCC) was applied. Furthermore, the study utilized Path Analysis via Structural Equation Modelling (PA-SEM) to examine the direct and indirect effects of technological, ethical, and moral factors on business performance outcomes. All analyses were conducted using STATA version 15, ensuring a robust statistical environment for accurate interpretation.

To ensure the validity of the research instrument, the questionnaire items were adapted from previous peer-reviewed studies with established credibility. Content validity was further enhanced through expert review by two professionals in the fields of business technology and organizational ethics, who evaluated the relevance, clarity, and comprehensiveness of the items. Construct validity was supported by the alignment of each item with the underlying dimensions it was intended to measure, particularly in the areas of technological integration, ethical impact, and moral judgment in AI usage. Also, the reliability of the research instrument was assessed using Cronbach's Alpha coefficient, which evaluates the internal consistency of the items within each scale. The alpha values for the constructs ranged from 0.792 to 0.832, which exceed the commonly accepted threshold of 0.70, indicating a high level of reliability and suggesting that the items were measuring the constructs consistently across respondents. This reliability supports the robustness of the findings and their suitability for concluding AI integration and its implications for business operations at Abeebi Food Processing.

Evaluation of the Measurement Model

Table 1 presents the factor loadings, Average Variance Extracted (AVE), Composite Reliability (CR), Cronbach's Alpha, and Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) for the constructs measured.

Table 1: Evaluation of the Measurement Model

Construct	Loading	AVE	Composite Reliability	Cronbach's Alpha	VIF
Technological Integration	0.832 - 0.852	0.810	0.822	0.812	1.998 - 2.452
Ethical Considerations	0.828 - 0.902	0.831	0.861	0.892	1.978 - 2.143
Moral Considerations	0.872 - 0.905	0.859	0.838	0.820	1.998 - 2.165

Source: Data Analysis 2025

The above results indicated strong validity and reliability across all constructs. Factor loadings above 0.8 demonstrate strong correlations, AVE values above 0.8 confirm good convergent validity**,** while CR and Cronbach's Alpha values above 0.8 **indicate** excellent internal consistency**.** VIF values (1.9 - 2.4) suggest low to moderate multicollinearity, ensuring that each item uniquely contributes to the model.

Results

Table 2 shows the analysis of the two hypotheses stated earlier, to present a correlation analysis between technological integration, ethical considerations, and moral considerations in Abeebi Food Processing.

Table 2: Relationship between Variables-

Model	Mean	SD	r-value	p-value	Remark
Technological Integration & Ethical Consideration	79.54 & 61.90	22.045 & 15.695	0.660**	0.000	Significant
Technological Integration & Moral Consideration	79.54 & 57.32	22.045 & 12.763	0.583**	0.000	Significant

Source: Data Analysis 2025

Interpretation:

- Technological Integration & Ethical Considerations**:** The strong positive correlation (r = 0.660, p = 0.000) indicates that AI integration significantly influences ethical decision-making in the organization.
- Technological Integration & Moral Considerations: The moderate positive correlation (r = 0.583, p = 0.000) suggests AI implementation has a meaningful, though slightly lower, impact on moral considerations**.**

Both relationships are statistically significant ($p < 0.05$)**,** emphasizing that AI adoption must be managed carefully to maintain ethical and moral standards in business operations**.**

Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) – Direct Effects

Table 3 presents **Path Analysis results**, assessing the direct effects of **Technological Integration (TI)** and **Ethical & Moral Considerations (EM) on Business Operations (BO).**

Table 3: Path Analysis (Direct Effects)

Path	Beta-Value	t-Value	p-Value	Hypothesis	Remark
TI → BO	0.832	9.98	0.000	H1	Supported
EM → BO	0.727	8.79	0.000	H2	Supported

Source: Data Analysis 2025

Interpretation:

- ❖ Technological Integration →Business Operations (β = 0.832, p = 0.000): The strong and positive beta-value (0.832) shows that technological integration greatly enhances business operations, with an 83.2% improvement in business operations for every unit increase in technological integration. This underscores the significance of AI in promoting innovation and operational efficiency.
- ❖ Ethical & Moral Considerations → Business Operations (β = 0.727, p = 0.000)**:** Ethical and moral considerations also strongly and significantly impact business operations (β = 0.727, p = 0.000)**. A** unit increase in ethical and moral considerations leads to a 72.7% improvement in business operations**,** suggesting that companies that uphold ethical AI implementation benefit from enhanced operational outcomes.

Discussion of Findings

The findings from this study underscore the significant role Artificial Intelligence (AI) plays in enhancing business operations at Abeebi Food Processing. The strong positive correlation between technological integration and ethical considerations ($r = 0.660$, $p < 0.05$) suggests that as AI systems are embedded into daily operations, employees and management become increasingly mindful of ethical standards in data use, automation, and decision-making. This indicates that AI is not only driving efficiency but also prompting organizations to establish clearer guidelines and accountability mechanisms. Furthermore, the significant relationship between technological integration and moral considerations ($r = 0.583$, $p < 0.05$) implies that moral implications such as fairness, employee displacement concerns, and transparency are gaining attention as AI becomes a strategic component of operational systems.

Path analysis further confirmed these relationships. Technological integration showed the strongest direct effect on business operations (β = 0.832, p = 0.000), indicating that effective AI implementation can enhance performance, streamline workflows, and improve productivity. Meanwhile**,** ethical and moral considerations also had a strong positive effect (β = 0.727, p = 0.000), suggesting that organizations that incorporate ethics into their AI strategies are more likely to benefit from sustainable and responsible business outcomes. These findings reinforce the idea that while AI offers immense operational advantages, its success depends on a balanced approach that integrates technological innovation with ethical responsibility.

Conclusion

The findings from this study affirm that AI integration significantly enhances business operations at Abeebi Food Processing, Osogbo, Osun State. The statistical analysis established that technological integration has a strong and positive impact on operational efficiency. At the same time, ethical and moral considerations also play a critical role in AI acceptance and implementation. However, despite the benefits, challenges such as ethical concerns, job displacement, and transparency issues must be addressed to ensure the responsible use of AI in the organization. The study confirms that a balanced approach to AI adoption, one that prioritizes both efficiency and ethical integrity, can lead to sustainable business growth and innovation. Furthermore, ensuring employees are adequately trained

and included in AI adoption strategies is essential for maximizing its benefits while minimizing resistance and ethical conflicts.

Recommendations

Based on the study's findings, the following recommendations are made:

1. Abeebi Food Processing should invest in continuous AI training programs to equip employees with the necessary skills for effective AI utilization. Management should encourage a culture of AI acceptance through interactive workshops, hands-on training, and knowledge-sharing initiatives.
2. The company should implement clear ethical frameworks that guide AI usage, ensuring fairness, transparency, and accountability in decision-making. Meanwhile, an AI ethics committee should be established to oversee ethical concerns, privacy, and the impact of automation on employees.

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STUDENTS' CRISES MANAGEMENT STRATEGIES AND SCHOOL EFFECTIVENESS IN OSUN STATE-OWNED TERTIARY INSTITUTIONS

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Abstract
The study investigated students' crisis management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State government-owned tertiary institutions. The study adopted a descriptive research design of correlational type. The population for study comprised of 697 academic staff, 16 administrators, and 20 supervising ministries in the sampled government-owned tertiary institutions in Osun State. The researcher, through the use of simple random sampling technique, selected four out of the six government-owned tertiary institutions in Osun State, while the proportional sampling technique was used to select 281 stakeholders. Self-designed questionnaire titled: ''Students' Crisis Management Strategies Questionnaire (SCMSQ) and Students' Academic Performance Proforma (SAPP) were used to collect necessary data. The mean, standard deviation and Multiple Regression were used to answer the research questions and test hypotheses raised and formulated respectively. The findings indicated that there was a significant prediction of lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria. The study concluded that adequate compensation would go a long way in enhancing effective realisation of the goals of these institutions. Based on the findings of the study, it was recommended that: government should sustain and intensify their efforts by paying more attention to lecturer compensation through timely promotion, provision of affordable health services, salaries and improved training opportunities.

***Keywords*:** Students' Crises Management Strategies; School effectiveness; Negotiation, Dialogue; Compromising

Introduction

Educational institutions are the key drivers of development and global progress, serving as vital tools in any society. This is due to the fact that it is a vital tool to manpower development, social and political development of a society. Undoubtedly, quality education eliminates illiteracy ignorance, laziness, and even poverty from society. However, for any educational goal to be achieved and sustained, the educational system should be devoid or free from any form of crises, especially power tussle within the school management, lecturers, staff and students (Adeyemi, 2019).

Tertiary education is crucial for economic and political development and enhances competitiveness in a global knowledge society. In the case of Africa, tertiary education plays a critical capacity building and professional training role in support of all the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs). Recent research findings indicate that expanding tertiary education may promote faster technological

growth and improve a country's ability to maximize its economic output (Bloom, Canning, and Chan, 2016). A new range of competences, such as adaptability, team work, communication skills, and the motivation for continual learning, have become critical.

The establishment of any tertiary institution is to facilitate acquisition of knowledge, skills, and values for the purpose of producing individuals who will contribute their own quota to societal development (Yusuf, 2018). In essence, higher institutions of learning are meant to provide students with sound and qualitative education that will make them productive, self-fulfilling and attain self-actualization. The Government (Federal Republic of Nigeria, 2013) clearly highlights the aims of higher education as the acquisition, development and inculcation of the proper value – orientation for the survival of the individual and society; the development of the intellectual capacities of individuals to understand and appreciate their environments; the acquisition of both physical and intellectual skills which will enable individuals to develop into careful members of the community; and the acquisition of an objective view of the local and external environment (Ajayi, 2018).

A perfunctory look at the conditions of higher education in Nigeria, however, shows that the above aims of higher education are difficult to achieve in view of crises that have been rocking most of the tertiary institutions in the country. Asikhia (2019) describe student crises as the revolts and rampages by students to show their grievances or press home their demands from their school authorities. Generally speaking, scholars such as Ngeri (2018) and Balma (2019), have observed that students' crisis is a global phenomenon which has ravaged countries like Peru, Columbia, Paraguay, Bolivia, and Mexico. Also, African countries like Senegal, Cote d'ivore, Benin, Cameroon, Zaire, Gabon, Uganda, Sudan, Kenya, Somali, Zimbabwe, and Zambia have witnessed numerous students' crises. In the same vein, Nigerian tertiary institutions have been witnessing series of crises since the inception of higher education in the country (Alabi, 2010).

Adejuwon (2017) posited that students' crisis is as old as the tertiary institutions in Nigeria itself, while students' militancy in the nation's tertiary institutions has come to be issue of serious concern. As such, revolts, protests, unrests and violence, and incessant closure of schools for months have become a regular characteristic of Nigerian's tertiary institutions. The frequency of these students' riots and crises therefore calls for study from scholars and educationists. According to Bryank (2012), it is the state of disharmony that is brought about by differences of impulses, desire or tendencies. Despite the various forms in which crises emanates, it is as a result of tensions, stress, frustrations, embezzlement, lack of transparency, indiscipline, lack of adequate teaching and struggle to gain higher positions. These unresolved conflict leads to strikes, riots, major injuries, loss of lives and destruction of properties including school buildings as well as arresting those who are involved in such activities. The occurrence of student's crisis could first be shown through boycotts of classes, exchange of black magic powers in the offices, refusal to obey the school rules and regulations, carrying of placards and chanting of solidarity songs by the students and staff, to make their grievances be known to the authorities (Ajibade, 2013).

It is very obvious that crisis in educational institutions can make or mar the progress and the development of the institutions. This, the reason why school administrators and managers must adopt certain administrative and managerial strategies or measures in the formulation and implementation of law and order in schools. These strategies according to Alabi (2002) may include; dialogue, suspension, use of enforcement agents, confrontation; and joint problem solving strategies to enable schools continue to pursue and achieve the targeted desired and set goals of teaching and learning. Based on the foregoing discussions, this paper is set out to examine students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-Owned tertiary institutions.

Statement of the Problem

A myriad of factors does influence schools' effectiveness at all levels. Many of these factors are subject to human manipulation while others are not. The incessant occurrence of crises among students in public tertiary institutions has become a major concern in our educational system, this is seen in the area of lack of school equipment, inadequate supply of school amenities and students denial of their rights to the amenities they paid for because of shortage in supply, the use of ineffective leadership style which sometimes cause misunderstanding among staff and students and gap in the communication channels. It may be that most heads of institutions of public schools in Osun State do not employ effective management strategies that can adequate resolve crises among students. This study seeks to identify and develop effective strategies for managing crises in Osun State' public tertiary institutions, addressing a critical gap in crisis management research.

Purpose of the Study

The main purpose of the study is to examine students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-Owned tertiary institutions. Specifically, the study aimed to:

i. evaluate the causes of students' crises in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions**.**
ii. examine the most effective students' crises management strategies in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions; and
iii. investigate the level of school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions.

Research Questions

The following research questions were raised to guide the study:

i. what are the causes of students' crises in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions***?***
ii. what are the most effective students' crises management strategies in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions?
iii. what is the level of school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions?

Research hypothesis

The hypothesis was formulated to guide the study:

Ho: There is no significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-Owned tertiary institutions.

Methodology

This study adopted a descriptive research design of correlational type. The population for the study comprised 697 academic staff, 16 administrators and 20 officers from supervisory ministry in six-stated owned tertiary institutions in Osun State. The researcher, through the use of random sampling technique, selected four out of the six state-owned tertiary institutions in Osun State and was based on the year of establishment while proportional sampling technique was used to select 281 stakeholders. "Students' Crises Management Strategies Questionnaire" (SCMSQ) and a proforma tagged "School Effectiveness Proforma" (SEP) were used to collect required data for the study. To determine the reliability of the instruments, 30 copies each of the instrument were administered to sets of respondents outside the sample of the study. Thereafter, the data gathered were analysed using Cronbach's Alpha at 0.05 level of significance and a reliability coefficient of .80 was obtained for SCMSQ. The researcher personally visited the sampled state-owned tertiary institutions with the help of three trained assistants. These research assistants were recruited based on their proximity to the study locations, and were properly trained during a one-day session to familiarize them with the administration procedures. Descriptive statistics (mean and standard deviation) were used to answer the research questions raised while Inferential statistics (Pearson product-moment correlation statistics was applied to test all hypotheses at 0.05 level of significance as the decision threshold. A total of 281 questionnaires were distributed out of which 209 were returned representing a response rate of 74.4%.

Results

Research Question 1: what are the causes of students' crises in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions***?***

Table 1

Mean Ranking Order of the Causes of Students' Crises

S/N	Causes of Students' Crises	X	SD	Rank Order
1	Inadequate provision of physical amenities such as electricity and water	3.77	.34	1st
2	Denial of rights and priviledges for students	3.31	.38	5th
3	Non implementation of government circular on students welfare	3.30	.65	6th
4	Imposition of decisions on students by professional administrators	3.05	.48	9th
5	Refusal of management to honour agreement reached with students union	3.22	.28	7th
6	Sudden change in institution policies on students	3.10	.85	8th
7	Allegation of corruption against institution professional administrators	2.44	.15	10th
8	Communication gap between the authorities and the students	3.41	.98	3rd
9	Discriminatory application of institution rules and regulations	3.33	.32	4th
10	failure of authority to listen to students' complaints	3.71	.87	2nd

Source: Fieldwork, 2024

Table 1 presents the ranked causes of student crises in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions based on their mean scores. The highest-ranked factor is inadequate provision of physical amenities (M=3.77, SD =0.34), followed by the failure of authorities to listen to student compliant (M=3.71, SD=0.87). The least significant cause is allegations of corruption against institutional administrators (M=2.44, SD=0.15). These findings suggest that poor infrastructure and ineffective communication are the primary triggers of student unrest.

Research Question 2: what is the most effective students' crises management strategies in Osun State-owned tertiary institution***?***

Table 2

Mean Ranking Order of the Students' Crises Management Strategies

S/N	Students' Crises Management Strategies	X	SD	Rank Order
1	Striving toward good interpersonal relationship with students	3.89	.67	1st
2	Asking students to write letter of undertaking makes parents to participate in managing crises	3.47	.31	5th
3	Police intervention in students' crises has negative effects on students stability	3.23	.19	6th
4	Closure of schools is an effective way of checking student's crises	3.11	.22	8th
5	Suspension of students' leadership assist in checking students' crises	3.82	.28	2nd
6	Providing opportunity for students to attend courses in conflict management	3.13	.60	7th
7	Use of student representative (SR) in management, decision–making and administration	3.78	.63	3rd
8	Clear definition and description of roles and responsibility on school management between stakeholders	3.56	.55	4th

Source: Fieldwork, 2024

Table 2 presents the ranking the student crisis management strategies. The most effective approach is fostering good interpersonal relationships between students and administrators (M=3.89, SD =0.67). This suggests that open communication and rapport-building play a crucial role in preventing student crises. The second most effective strategy is suspending student leadership (M=3.82, SD=0.28), which indicates that some institutions resort to administrative control measures. On the other hand, school closures (M=3.11, SD=0.22) are the least effective method, suggesting that punitive measure alone may not be a sustainable solution.

Research Question 3: what is the level of school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions***?***

Table 3

Level of School Effectiveness in Osun State-owned Tertiary Institutions

Year	Distinction	Credit	Merit	Lower Merit	Pass	Fail
2021	0.5%	2%	73%	15%	7%	2.5%
2022	0.25%	1.5%	80%	12.5%	5%	0.75%
2023	0.2%	5.5%	20%	17%	4.2%	1.1%
2024	2%	17%	67%	4%	4%	6%

Table 3 presents the distribution of student performance in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions from 2021 to 2024. The data reveal that the majority of graduates each year earned merit classifications, with figures ranging from 20% in 2023 to 80% in 2022. The proportion of students graduating with Distinctions remained consistently low across the years, peaking at 2% in 2024. This trend suggests that while most students achieve satisfactory academic performance, very few attain exceptional result. The implication of these findings should be examined further to institutional policies and crisis management strategies.

Ho: There is no significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions.

Table 3

Students' Crises Management Strategies and School Effectiveness

Variable	N	$\overline{X}$	SD	df	Cal r-value	P-value	Decision
Students' Crises Management Strategies	209	2.57	.60				
				207	.776	.000	Ho Rejected
School Effectiveness	209	2.77	.98				

***Significant P< .05**

Table 3 shows the calculated r-value of .776 while p-value (0.001) is less than the significance level (0.05) for 207 degrees of freedom. Therefore, the hypothesis which states that there is no significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions is rejected. The finding reveals that there is significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions.

Discussion of the Findings

This section gives detailed discussion of the findings from the research questions and the hypotheses tested. Findings on research question one revealed that inadequate provision of physical amenities such as electricity and water is the most causes of students' crises in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions. The finding agrees with the Ajibade (2019) who found the causes of students unrest to include those arising from shortage of basis facilities (water, light just to mention a few). Also, Ishola (2018) found that lack of amenities in the school constitute a major causes of students' crisis which has a negative effect on the actualisation of the tertiary institution goals.

Also, the finding discovered in the research question two shows that striving toward good interpersonal relationship with students is the most effective students' crises management strategies in Osun State-owned tertiary institution. This finding also supports that of Etadon (2023) who found that that harmonious relationship in the school is the effective ways of managing students crisis due to the fact if the school develop a good relationship in the school with the students, crises can be reduced to barest minimum.

Meanwhile, findings on research question three revealed that more than half of population of students graduating each year graduated with merit passes and very few (rare) students graduated with distinction. The implication of this analysis is that the students' crisis management strategies in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions determines the level of academic performance of students at point of graduation. This finding is in agreement with that of Uchendu, Anijaobi-Idem, and Odigwe (2023) who discovered that the level of school effectiveness in Colleges of Education was average.

Finally, the findings on research hypothesis one revealed that there was significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions. This finding is in agreement with that of Ademola (2022) who discovered that that there was significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Kwara State tertiary institutions

Conclusions

Based on the findings which stemmed from the data collected and analyzed with the results obtained, it could be concluded that inadequate provision of physical amenities such as electricity and water is the most causes of students' crises in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions; striving toward good interpersonal relationship with students is the most effective students' crises management strategies in Osun State-owned tertiary institution; more than half of population of students graduating each year graduated with merit passes and very few (rare) students graduated with distinction; and there is significant relationship between students' crises management strategies and school effectiveness in Osun State-owned tertiary institutions.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations were made:

1. School management should provide adequate social amenities in the school so as to avoid students' crises thereby enhancing the actualisation of the school goals and objective;
2. The academic and professional administrators should continue to demonstrate spirit of tolerance so as to ensure the smooth running of the college;
3. The management of school should always explore regular dialogue strategy as a foremost step in managing conflict before embarking on the others for higher school effectiveness in the institutions;
4. Conflict management should not be seen to connote a rigid approach that suits all situations, rather, it should develop a strong interpersonal relationship to prevent and arrest a seemingly serious crisis; and
5. Conditions that promote effective conflict management should include consideration of a wide range of alternative solutions, a cooperative climate, an organized and orderly process, and avoidance of artificial conflict-reducing devices such as voting or relying on a leader to make the final decision.

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LECTURERS' COMPENSATION AND GOAL ACHIEVEMENT IN FEDERAL COLLEGES OF EDUCATION, SOUTH-WEST, NIGERIA

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Abstract

The goals of Colleges of Education in Nigeria include among others, producing of teachers with high discipline, dedication, appropriate knowledge and skills that would facilitate the actualisation of the national goals. It was against this background that the study examined lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria. Descriptive research design of correlational type was adopted for the study. The target population comprised of 900 lecturers in the three Federal Colleges of Education, 1,292 principals and 7,127 head teachers of Basic schools that cut across Oyo, Lagos and Ogun States. Proportional sampling technique through the use of Krejcie and Morgan (1970) table was used to select 226 lecturers, 254 principals and 317 head teachers respectively. Self-designed questionnaire titled: ''Lecturers' Compensation Questionnaire (LCQ) and Goal Achievement Questionnaire (GAQ) were used to collect necessary data. The mean, standard deviation and Multiple Regression were used to answer the research questions and test hypothesis raised and formulated. The findings indicated that there was a significant prediction of lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria. The study concluded that adequate compensation would go a long way in enhancing effective realisation of the goals of these institutions. Based on the findings of the study, it was recommended that: government should sustain and intensify their efforts by paying more attention to lecturer compensation through timely promotion, provision of affordable health services, salaries and improved training opportunities.

***Keywords*:** Lecturers' compensation; Goal achievement; Training opportunities; services; Promotion; Salaries

Introduction

Teacher education in Nigeria centres around the quality of education imparted to the citizenry and its relevance to individuals in particular and the country at large. This is why attention is increasingly focused on the quality of existing teachers while emphasis is also laid on potential teachers. This is so because nothing can be as important to learning as the quality of inputs provided by the government and other stakeholders. The importance of Colleges of Education (formerly known as Advanced Teachers' Training College) in nation building cannot be over-emphasise because these institutions are saddled with the responsibility of producing qualified and competent teachers for basic schools in Nigeria. The inadequate compensation may include irregular payment of salary, delay in implementation of promotion, poor commitment to capacity building of the lecturers and the

likes. Many lecturers in the employment of the Federal Colleges of Education remain in the service because they have not gotten greener pasture in other establishments (Sadam, 2016).

Lecturers are important stakeholders in the educational system, and as such, their compensation for the services they are rendering to schools needs to be very attractive and encouraging, if at all the realization of the effectiveness of the schools is of priority to the government and other stakeholders in education. This is necessary because, if lecturers are not well compensated, realising the goal achievement could be cumbersome. Promotion of lecturers has not been timely implemented in most of the federal colleges of education in south-west, Nigeria, as the government do not key in very well to their capacity building, by organizing different trainings or financially supporting them to attend within or outside the country (Odauda, 2021)

Samson (2020) stated that compensation of lecturers in many federal colleges of education in Nigeria, especially in the areas of salary, promotion, training opportunities, fringe benefits and other incentives, has not been encouraging. This could make lecturers worried and could consequently, harm the goal achievement the goal achievement of the school. Olalekan (2017) posited that lecturers' compensation and goal achievement are inseparable. If lecturers are well compensated, their morale could be boosted towards high dedication to their official duties and this will eventually help the school to achieve it goals in its operation, especially in the aspect of students' academic performance.

Sadam (2016) explained that the ultimate goal of any educational institution is to see that its students have excellent academic performance in their examinations. However, one of the ways of ensuring this in federal colleges of education in South-west, Nigeria is by making lecturers' compensation such as salary, promotion, capacity building and fringe benefits more attractive, as poor compensation could consistently dampen their readiness to make the schools effective. Obadare (2018) stressed that one of the factors responsible for ineffectiveness of federal colleges of education in South-west, Nigeria is lackadaisical attitude of the governments towards lecturers' compensation, especially in salary, promotion, fringe benefits and professional development.

Goal achievement is the most essential pursuit of every viable organisation. Educational institutions, especially colleges of education in South-west, Nigeria are not exempted from this goal attainment venture. Suffice it to say that goal achievement is the basis of all productive activities in viable institutions. Dedication is a key element which should not dissociate employees in any organisation because it determines the extent to which they carry out their official duties. Work ethic is important in a school setting because it has a direct effect on the standard of instruction students get. When employees are committed, they go above and beyond the call of duty to foster an environment that is both positive and stimulating for learning for pupils (Kinyita & Hannah, 2015).

Discipline has to do with the compliance of both teachers and students to the established rules and regulations guiding the school. According to Odebode (2020), disciplined staff members adhere to the laws and regulations of the school by donning appropriate uniforms and completely shunning

verbal and physical aggressiveness, stealing, tardiness, disrespecting school authorities, smoking, and alcohol consumption. Knowledge is also important to the employees because it is one of the greatest tools which they need to effectively perform the job. School personnel must possess a thorough comprehension and expertise of the subject matter (Manafa, 2020). Skills in an organisation cannot be over-emphasised. Skill refers to the abilities and competencies that educators possess in order to effectively teach and facilitate learning in their students. According to Bhanot (2019), skills are critical to an organization's performance as well as the personal and professional development of its workforce.

The fore-going discussions have shown that lecturers' compensation and goal achievement are very significant to the realisation of the goals of the Federal Colleges of Education. Without adequate compensation of lecturers, goal achievement could be hampered and the end result would be production of graduates who are not well grounded in all that is required to be effective teachers. It is against this backdrop that this study is set out to examine the relationship between lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal College of Education, South-west, Nigeria.

Statement of the Problem

The goals of Colleges of Education in Nigeria include producing teachers with high personal and professional discipline and integrity, dedication, appropriate knowledge, skills and attitudes that would facilitate the actualisation of the national goals (Federal Government of Nigeria, 2014). However, some occurrences in some public schools across the country have put one in doubt as to whether these goals are being adequately achieved or not. For instance, the knowledge and skills of some teachers (recent graduates of the Federal Colleges of Education who are already on the field) are not adequate as they find it difficult to explain concepts while imparting knowledge to the learners.

Based on the scenario presented above, there is an indication that the goals of the Nigerian Colleges of Education have not been well actualised and this probably could be as a result of ineffective compensation of lecturers who taught them while they were in schools. Many researchers had conducted studies related to this present study. For instance, Osibanjo et al (2014) conducted a study on compensation packages: A strategic tool for employees' performance and retention in selected private universities in Ogun State, South-west, Nigeria. Salary, bonus, incentives, allowances and fringe benefits were used as measures of compensation. Olasumbo (2014) investigated lecturers' job commitment and job performance: Leadership implications for Nigerian higher education development. Muguongo et al (2015) investigated the effects of compensation on job satisfaction among secondary school teachers in Maara Sub-county of Tharaka Nithi County, Kenya. Abdulkareem et al (2015) carried out a study on corporate culture and university goal achievement in South-west zone, Nigeria. However, based on the researcher's knowledge, none of these previous studies focused on the relationship between lecturer compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria, and this is the gap which this study intends to fill.

Purpose of the Study

The main purpose of the study was to examine the relationship between lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west. Specifically, the study aimed to:

i. Examine the level of lecturers' compensation in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria;
ii. Investigate the level of goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria; and
iii. Determine the relationship between lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria.

Research Questions

These research questions were raised to guide the study:

i. What is the level of lecturers' compensation in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria?
ii. What is the level of goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria?

Research Hypotheses

The following null hypothesis was postulated to guide the study:

Ho: There is no significant prediction of lecturers' compensation to goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria

Methodology

The study adopted a research design of correlational type to obtain the relevant and needed data. A correctional design was chosen because it allows for an examination of the relationship between lecturers' compensation and goal achievement without direct manipulation of variables, making it appropriate for studying naturally occurring conditions. According to James (2017), correlational research design aimed at identifying and analysing the relationship between two or more variables. The population of the study comprised 1,208 in the entire five Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria and 4,362 principals and 14,924 head teacher in the entire public Basics schools respectively in South-west, Nigeria. The target population of the study comprised 900 lecturers in the three Federal Colleges of Education lecturers, 1,292 principals and 7,127 head teachers of Basic schools that cut across Oyo, Lagos and Ogun States. Multi-stage sampling technique was used for the study in order of states, institutions and respondents. Principals and head teachers are essential for the study because they are in the position to give more concrete information on whether graduate of Federal Colleges of Education are discipline, dedicated, knowledge and skills.

Random sampling technique was used to select three out of the six states in South-west, Nigeria. Purposive sampling technique was used to select three federal Colleges of Education in these states because of their year of establishment. Proportional sampling technique through the use of Krejcie and Morgan (1970) table for determining sample size from a given population was used to select 226 lecturers, 254 principals and 317 head teachers respectively. "Lecturers' Compensation Questionnaire (LCQ) and Goal Achievement Questionnaire (GAQ) were used to collect information

on lecturers' compensation and goal achievement. "Lecturers' Compensation Questionnaire (LCQ) was measured using training opportunities, health services and promotion, while "Goal Achievement Questionnaire" (GAQ) was measured using graduates of Colleges of Education in terms of dedication, discipline, knowledge and skills. LCQ was divided into sub-sections that will have 28 items. Section A had response options of: Very High Extent (VHE), High Extent (HE), Low Extent (LE) and Very Low Extent (VLE) while GAQ is on one section consisting of 20 items. Items 1-20 have response options of: Always (S), Often (O), Rarely (R) and Never (N). In order to ascertain the validity of the self-designed instrument, the instrument draft was reviewed by three experts from the University of Ilorin to ensure face and content validity.

To determine the reliability of the instruments, 30 copies each of the instrument were administered to sets of respondents outside the sample of the study. Thereafter, the data gathered were analysed using Cronbach's Alpha at 0.05 level of significance and a reliability coefficient of .87 and .89 were obtained for LCQ and GAQ respectively. The researcher personally visited the sampled Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria with the help of five trained assistants. These research assistants were recruited based on place of domicile, were properly briefed and instructed during a day of training to enable them to get familiar with the modalities for administering the instrument appropriately. The mean and standard deviation were used to answer the research questions, while Multiple Regression was used to test all the hypotheses at 0.05 level of significance as a standard region of decision of the hypotheses. However, 797 questionnaires were administered but 711 were returned for analysis, which represent 89.1%

Results

Research Question One: What is the level of lecturers' compensation in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria***?***

Table 1: Mean and Standard Deviation of the Level of Lecturers' Compensation

S/N	Variables	X	SD	Decision
1	Training Opportunities	2.77	.34	Average
2	Health Services	2.67	.38	Average
3	Promotion	2.53	.65	Average
4.	Salary	2.65	.45	Average
	Grand Mean	**2.65**	**.45**	

Source: Fieldwork, 2024

$\bar{X}$ Key

1.00 -2.00 Low

2.01 -3.00 Moderate

3.01 -4.00 High

Table 1 shows the mean and standard deviation of the level of lecturers' compensation in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria. Overall, lecturers' compensation in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria was moderate, with training opportunities, health services, promotion, and salary all within this range.

Research Question Two: What is the level of goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria***?***

Table 2: Mean and Standard Deviation of the Level of Goal Achievement

S/N	Variables	X	SD	Decision
1	Discipline	1.87	.54	Low
2	Dedication	2.55	.56	Average
3	Knowledge	2.87	.38	Average
4	Skills	2.59	.39	Average
	Grand Mean	**2.47**	**.46**	

Source: Fieldwork, 2024

Key

X

1.00 -2.00 Low

2.01 -3.00 Moderate

3.01 -4.00 High

Table 2 shows the man and standard of the level of goal achievement in federal colleges of education, south-west, Nigeria where the mean scores of 2.55, 2.87 and 2.59 for dedication, knowledge and skills were moderate, while the mean score of 1.87 for discipline was low. Hence, the grand mean of 2.47 shows that the level of goal achievement in federal colleges of education, south-west, Nigeria was moderate.

Ho*:* There is no significant prediction of lecturers' compensation to goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria.

Table 3a

Results of Multiple Regression of Lecturers' Compensation and Goal Achievement

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	.863[a]	.745	.743	7.26259

Table 3a presented the model summary of the regression analysis with R square value of .863. This indicated that, the predictive variable (lecturers' compensation) explained at least 74.5% of the total variability of the criterion variable (goal achievement). The high percentage of explained variability is an indication of model adequacy. This implies that lecturers' compensation predicts goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria. Implicit in this result is the

fact that the predictor variable accounted for 74.5% variation in goal achievement. Further verification on the significant prediction of the predictor variable and goal achievement is p value of 0.00 <0.05.

Since p value of 0.00 is lesser than 0.05 significance level, the hypothesis is rejected. This means that, there was significant prediction of lecturers' compensation on goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria.

Table 3b

Regression Analysis of Lecturers' Compensation and Goal Achievement

Model	Sum of Square	df	Mean Square	F	Sig
1 Regression	108659.860	4	27164.965	515.022	.00[b]
Residual	37238.115	706	52.745		
Total	145897.945	710			

Table 3b indicated that the calculated F-value is 515.022 with a degree of freedom of 4/706 that is significant at 0.00. Since the p-value of 0.00 was lesser than 0.05 significance level, the hypothesis was rejected. The implication of this is that there is a significant prediction of lecturers' compensation on goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria.

Table 3c

Model Coefficients of Lecturers' Compensation and Goal Achievement

Model	B (Coefficient)	Std. Error	Beta	T	Sig
Constant	4.667	1.168		3.997	.00
Training Opportunities	-.360	.090	-.113	-4.000	.00
Health Services	.969	.089	.283	10.862	.00
Promotion	.857	.141	.343	6.091	.00
Salary	.958	.123	.425	7.762	.00

Table 3c showed the predictive contribution of lecturers' compensation to goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria. Among the components of lecturers' compensation salary (β = 0.425), followed by promotion (β = 0.384) and health services (β = 0.283). However, training opportunities has a significant but negative contribution (β = -0.113), suggesting that increased training opportunities may not directly translate to improved goal achievement.

Discussion of Findings

The findings of the research question one revealed that the level of lecturers' compensation in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria was average with grand mean score of 2.65. This shows

that the compensation provided to the lecturers in these institutions has been moderately encouraging and is partial achievement of the goals of the Colleges. This finding is in line with the view of Adeyemi (2023) that lecturers are the soul of institutions, irrespective of the type. For institutions to continually actualise its goals, lecturers must be well compensated.

Research question two's findings revealed that the goal achievement level in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria was average with a grand mean score of 2.47. This implies that the goal of the Federal Colleges of Education in terms of the production of teachers who are discipline, dedication, knowledge and skills has not been adequately realised. The implication of this is that the products of Federal Colleges of Education who are teaching at the basic schools in the South-west part of Nigeria have not been well equipped with all they need to effectively facilitate adequate realisation of the goals of this level of education. This finding agrees with the view of Lawrence (2016) that that the inability of many graduates of Nigerian Colleges of Education to effectively impart knowledge to learners is due to inadequate possession of teaching skills and knowledge, acquired during their days in these institutions.

The findings of the hypothesis one tested revealed that there was significant prediction of lecturers' compensation and goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria. This connotes that when the government are well-committed to adequate compensation of the lecturers in Federal Colleges of Education, South-west, Nigeria, it will lead to effective realisation of the stated goals This finding is in tandem with the view of Ademola (2023) that compensation serves as a bond which does not only tie the employees to the organisation but also dictate their attitudes towards job performance.

Conclusion

Based on the findings which stemmed from the data collected and analyzed with the results obtained, it could be concluded that there was significant prediction of lecturers' compensation on goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria, this indicated that, the predictive variable (lecturers' compensation) explained at least 74.5% of the total variability of the criterion variable (goal achievement). The high percentage of explained variability is an indication of model adequacy. This implies that lecturers' compensation predicts goal achievement in Federal Colleges of Education in South-west, Nigeria. Implicit in this result is the fact that the predictor variable accounted for 74.5% variation in goal achievement, adequate compensation would go a long way in enhancing effective realisation of the goals of these institutions; the level of lecturers' compensation in these institutions was average; the level of goal achievement of these institutions was average; timely implementation of promotion is an important factor which could help achieve institutions goal achievement; and when there is provision of affordable health services to the lecturers, their performance to the job could be improved, thereby leading to the realisation of College goals.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations were made:

i. Government should sustain and intensify their efforts by paying more attention to lecturer compensation through timely promotion, provision of affordable health services, salaries and improved training opportunities;
ii. Training opportunities should be intensified for lecturers on pedagogy and digital teaching to make them acquire more knowledge and skills which would make them more relevant professionally, thereby improving their performance;
iii. Affordable health services should be made available to the lecturers to make them perform optimally thereby leading to goal achievement of the College;
iv. Government should make sure that promotion is timely implemented to boost lecturers' morale so that goals of the Colleges can be achieved; and
v. Government should at all times ensure that salary is timely and adequately paid at the end of the month to enhance actualisation of Colleges goals and objectives.

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CLOUD COMPUTING AND ETHICAL OFFICE PRACTICES: A CASE STUDY OF ADEYEMI FEDERAL UNIVERSITY OF EDUCAITON, ONDO

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Abstract
Cloud computing has become a transformative tool in modern organizational practices, offering significant improvements in efficiency, flexibility, and collaboration. This study examines the influence of cloud computing on ethical office practices at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo. A descriptive research design for the survey was adopted. The population of the study consisted of 1,320 staff members and administrators *of Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo. A sample size of 132 staff members was selected using a proportionate sampling technique. A self-developed questionnaire titled Cloud Computing and Ethical Office Practices (CCEOP) was used to collect data for the study. The face and content validity of the instrument was done by three experts from Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo. The internal consistency of the instrument was ascertained using a Cronbach's Alpha statistical tool, which yielded an overall reliability coefficient of 0.80. The data collected were analysed using descriptive statistics such as percentages, mean scores, and standard deviation. The study found that while cloud computing offers significant benefits in terms of operational efficiency, challenges remain in ensuring the security of sensitive data and adhering to ethical standards in managing institutional information. The paper offers recommendations for improving cybersecurity infrastructure, encryption, multifactor authentication, and compliance with data protection regulations, contributing to the successful integration of cloud computing in educational institutions.*

Keywords: Cloud Computing, Ethical Practices, Office Management

Introduction

Cloud computing has emerged as a pivotal innovation in modern office record practices, redefining how data is stored, accessed, and managed. Mell & Grance (2011) defines cloud computing as "a model for enabling ubiquitous, convenient, on-demand network access to a shared pool of configurable computing resources". This technology allows organizations to control remote servers and internet-based platforms for storing and processing data, eliminating reliance on physical infrastructure. As organizations face increasing demands for efficiency, flexibility and cost-effectiveness, cloud computing offers a dynamic solution by providing access to services such as Infrastructure as a Service, Platform as a Service, and Software as a Service. These services facilitate

flexibility in operational workflows and enable organizations to adapt quickly to technological advancements and market (Hashem et al, 2015).

The adoption of cloud computing has become essential in modern organizational practices, particularly for its role in enhancing productivity and collaboration. Organizations now utilize cloud-based systems to enable flawless communication, real-time data sharing, and integration of diverse workflows. For example, tools such as Google Workspace and Microsoft 365 provide cloud-based applications that support collaboration across geographical locations, fostering efficiency in both private and public sectors (Almaiah et al., 2020). This transformation has proven indispensable during global disruptions such as the COVID-19 pandemic, which accelerated the shift to remote work and underscored the value of cloud computing in maintaining organizational continuity (Olaleye et al., 2021).

Educational institutions, as key drivers of knowledge dissemination and research, have increasingly embraced cloud computing to enhance teaching, learning, and administrative processes. According to Alharthi et al (2017), ascertained that cloud computing supports the academic ecosystem by offering centralized platforms for resource sharing, such as Learning Management Systems (LMS) like Moodle, Blackboard, and Google Classroom. These systems allow students and faculty members to access academic materials, submit assignments, and engage in virtual discussions from any location, thereby promoting flexibility and inclusivity in education. Moreover, cloud-based technologies are integral to online education, enabling institutions to deliver courses to students across the globe, thereby extending the reach of education beyond traditional classroom boundaries.

In the Nigerian context, cloud computing is steadily gaining grip as educational institutions strive to overcome infrastructural challenges. Olaleye et al (2021) noted that many Nigerian universities are using cloud-based systems to improve data management and simplify administrative tasks, for instance, student registration, financial record-keeping, and examination processing are increasingly handled through cloud platforms, reducing the reliance on manual processes and minimizing errors. This transformation not only improves operational efficiency but also aligns with global best practices, positioning Nigerian institutions to compete on an international level.

The role of cloud computing in office management within educational institutions cannot be overstated. Administrative functions, such as payroll processing, human resource management, and document archiving, have traditionally relied on manual, paper-based systems. However, with the advent of cloud technologies, these functions have transitioned to digital platforms that enable faster, more accurate, and more transparent workflows (Subashini& Kavitha, 2011). By providing a centralized repository for institutional data, cloud computing ensures that administrative staff can access up-to-date information in real-time, facilitating better decision-making and enhancing accountability.

Despite its numerous benefits, the integration of cloud computing into educational institutions and office management presents challenges related to confidentiality and ethical practices. Educational

institutions, particularly those in Nigeria, handle vast amounts of sensitive information, including student records, financial data, and research outputs. The migration of this data to cloud-based systems exposes it to potential risks, such as unauthorized access, data breaches, and misuse by external vendors (Hashem et al, 2015). Ensuring the confidentiality of such data requires robust security measures, including encryption, access controls, and compliance with data protection regulations such as Nigeria's Data Protection Regulation (NDPR).Furthermore, ethical considerations arise in the use of cloud computing, particularly in relation to accountability and digital behaviour. Office staff and administrators must adhere to ethical standards when managing institutional data, ensuring that actions such as data sharing, access privileges, and record updates are conducted transparently and responsibly (Almaiah et al, 2020). This is particularly important in educational institutions where ethical lapses can undermine institutional integrity and erode trust among stakeholders.

Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, exemplifies the opportunities and challenges associated with cloud computing adoption in Nigerian higher education. As a leading institution, the university is positioned to influence cloud technologies to improve academic delivery and administrative efficiency. However, the transition to cloud-based systems necessitates a comprehensive understanding of its implications for confidentiality and ethical practices. Issues such as the adequacy of cyber security infrastructure, staff training on ethical data management, and compliance with relevant laws and standards are critical to ensuring the successful integration of cloud computing into the university's operations.

Statement of the Problem

The adoption of cloud computing in educational institutions has introduced significant advantages, including enhanced collaboration, operational efficiency, and access to cutting-edge technological tools. However, its integration also presents considerable challenges, particularly concerning confidentiality and ethical office practices. Educational institutions like Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, manage vast amounts of sensitive data, including student records, financial information, and institutional research outputs. The migration of such data to cloud-based systems exposes it to potential risks such as data breaches, unauthorized access, and misuse by third parties.

Additionally, the absence of a robust cybersecurity infrastructure, inadequate staff training on data management, and limited adherence to ethical standards in handling digital resources further exacerbate these risks. Ethical issues, including accountability, transparency, and responsible usage of institutional data, remain critical concerns. Without adequate safeguards, the integration of cloud computing could compromise data confidentiality, erode trust among stakeholders, and undermine the integrity of institutional operations. This underscores the need for an in-depth examination of the influence of cloud computing on confidentiality and ethical office practices within the university.

Purpose of the Study

The main purpose of this study is to examine the influence of cloud computing on ethical office practices at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, the study specifically examined to:

1. Investigate the extent of cloud computing adoption at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo;
2. evaluate the level at which data security and privacy is being managed by staff and administrators in Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo;
3. Assess the impact of cloud computing on the confidentiality of sensitive institutional data.
4. Identify the ethical challenges associated with the use of cloud computing in office practices within the university; and
5. Evaluate the effectiveness of existing security measures put in place to safeguarding cloud computing practices in the university.

Research Questions

The following research questions were raised to guide the study

1. To what extent is the level of adoption of cloud computing at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo?
2. How do staff and administrators at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, manage data security and privacy when using cloud-based systems?
3. What are the perceived impacts of cloud computing on the confidentiality of institutional data at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo?
4. What are the ethical challenges faced by Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo in the use and management of cloud computing?
5. How effective are measures put in place to safeguard sensitive institutional data in cloud at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo?

Methodology

Descriptive survey research design was used for this study. This design is particularly suited for assessing the perceptions, experiences, and practices of the university's staff and administrators regarding cloud computing, confidentiality, and ethics in data management. The population for this study comprises 1,320 staff members and administrators of Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo (Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Division of Personnel, 2025) who are directly involved in office management tasks and the use of cloud-based systems. This includes academic staff, administrative personnel such as Head of Department and IT staff who use cloud computing tools for academic, administrative, and office management functions.

A proportionate sampling technique will be used to ensure that the sample represents different departments, units, division, and directorate as well as functional areas within the university. Total sample of 132 respondents were selected as sample size of the study. This sample size is considered sufficient for providing reliable insights into the study's research questions. Researcher self-structured questionnaire tagged: Cloud Computing and Ethical Office Practices (CCEOP) was used for data collection. The questionnaire consist of 2 (two) parts, section A was on the demographic variables relevant to the study while section B was on the research items. Responses to the questionnaire followed the 4-point rating scale type of Strongly Agree (SA) = 4, Agree (A) =3, Disagree (D) = 2 and Strongly Disagree (SD) = 1 to measure the respondents' level of agreement.

Only Research question one was based on responses of Very Highly Extent (VHE) = 4, High Extent (HE) =3, Low Extent (LE) =2 and No Extent (NE) = 1 to measure the respondents' level of agreement. Two research specialists validated the study instrument, examining its face and content validity. Reliability coefficient of 0.80 was reported for the instrument, this implied that the instrument was reliable towards achieving objectives of the study. The researchers with the help of two trained research assistants distributed the questionnaire to the respondents as well as collect it back immediately after completion. Retrieval rate was 100 percent. Means and standard deviation was used to analysis the 20 items research questions raise with 2.50 benchmark.

Research Question 1: To what extent is the level of adoption of cloud computing at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo?

Table 1: Responses mean rating and standard deviation on the level of adoption of cloud computing at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo. N = 132

S/N	Items	X	SD	Remark
1.	To what extent are you aware of cloud computing services?	3.64	0.91	Very High Extent
2.	To what extent do you use cloud computing service in your academic/ work activities?	3.06	1.06	High Extent
3.	To what extent do you think cloud computing enhances productivity and efficiency in the university?	3.17	1.04	High Extent
4.	To what extent do you rely on cloud computing for storing and sharing documents	2.87	1.21	High Extent

Sources: Field work 2025

Data in table 1 shows that four items indicates that item 1 is in the boundary of 3.5 – 4.49 , implying a very high extent, item (2,3, and 4) indicate a high extent of cloud computing adoption, with mean scores of 3.06, 3.17 and 2.87 respectively. This implies that the staff members of Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo are aware of and have adopted cloud computing in carrying out their work activities.

Research Question 2: How do staff and administrators at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, manage data security and privacy when using cloud-based systems?

Table 2: Responses on how staff and administrators at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, manage data security and privacy when using cloud-based systems

S/N	Question Items	X	SD	Remark
5.	Staff and administrators at Adeyemi Federal University of Education have received adequate training on cloud data security and privacy.	3.07	1.05	Agree
6.	Staffs follow strict guidelines and protocols to ensure data security and privacy when using cloud-based systems.	2.96	1.08	Agree
7.	Cloud computing platforms used at Adeyemi Federal University of Education are regularly monitored for security breaches or threats.	2.97	1.01	Agree
8.	Data privacy and security measures in the cloud are effectively enforced by the administration at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	3.11	0.95	Agree

Source: Field work 2025

The results in Table 2 reveal that item 5, 6, 7, and 8 fall within the score range of 2.5 to 3.49. this indicates that staff and administrators at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, generally adhere to security protocols when using cloud-based systems to protect the university's data. However, the moderate range of these cores suggests that while security measures are being followed, there may still be room for improvement in adherence and implementation.

Research Question 3: What are the perceived impacts of cloud computing on the confidentiality of institutional data at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo?

Table 3: Responses on perceived impacts of cloud computing on the confidentiality of institutional data at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo

S/N	Items	X	SD	Remark
9.	The use of cloud computing has significantly improved the confidentiality of institutional data at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	3.23	0.78	Agree
10.	Cloud-based systems at Adeyemi Federal University of Education provide sufficient security measures to protect sensitive institutional data.	2.90	0.89	Agree
11.	Staff at Adeyemi Federal University of Education are confident in the ability of cloud computing to protect data confidentiality.	2.87	0.64	Agree
12.	The implementation of cloud computing has decreased the risk of unauthorized access to institutional data at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	2.97	1.03	Agree

Source: Field work 2025

The research responses indicate that respondents generally agree that cloud computing has had a positive impact on data security. The highest mean score 3.23 suggests strong agreement that cloud computing has enhanced data confidentiality, with relatively low variability in responses. This implies that most respondents acknowledge the role of cloud technology in securing institutional data, reducing unauthorized access, and improving overall information protection.

Research Question 4: What are the ethical challenges faced by Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo in the use and management of cloud computing?

Table 4: Responses on ethical challenges faced by Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, in the use and management of cloud computing in office management processes

S/N	Question items	X	SD	Remark
13.	Adeyemi Federal University of Education faces significant challenges in ensuring data security when using cloud-based office management systems.	3.06	1.09	Agree
14.	The lack of sufficient IT infrastructure poses a challenge to the effective use of cloud computing for office management at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	3.24	1.12	Agree
15.	Staff resistance to adopting cloud computing for office management processes is a major challenge at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	3.07	1.07	Agree
16.	There are significant challenges related to maintaining the confidentiality of sensitive data in cloud-based office management systems at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	2.97	1.28	Agree

Source: Field work 2025

Table 4 reveals that the responses to items 12, 14, 15, and 16, with mean scores of 3.06, 3.24, 3.05, and 2.97, respectively, indicate that the management of cloud computing in office processes faces several challenges. The most significant challenge, with the highest means score of 3.24, is insufficient IT infrastructure. Other notable challenge includes staff resistance to adopting cloud computing for office management and difficulties in maintaining the confidentiality of sensitive data in cloud-based office systems.

Research Question 5: How effective are measures put in place to safeguard sensitive institutional data in cloud computing at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo?

Table 5: Responses on the effectiveness of measures put in place to safeguard sensitive institutional data in cloud computing at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo.

S/N	Question items	X	SD	Remark
17.	The cybersecurity measures in place to safeguard data in the cloud at Adeyemi Federal University of Education are highly effective.	2.89	1.10	Agree
18.	Adeyemi Federal University of Education has implemented sufficient encryption methods to protect sensitive data stored in the cloud.	2.84	1.24	Agree
19.	Data access controls and user authentication procedures are effectively used to ensure the security of institutional data in the cloud at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	3.16	1.27	Agree
20.	Regular audits of cloud-based systems help to identify and mitigate potential data security risks at Adeyemi Federal University of Education.	3.09	1.03	Agree

Source: Field work 2025

Table 5 shows that the mean scores for items 17, 18, 19, and 20 range between 2.50 and 3.16, indicating that respondents strongly agreed on the effectiveness of data access controls, user authentication, encryption, and overall cybersecurity strategies. These responses reveal that strengthening encryption practices and cybersecurity strategies enhances data protection, thereby improving the confidence of staff and administrators in securing cloud-based data within the institution.

Discussion of Findings

The findings of this research indicate that cloud computing has positively impacted data security at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, particularly in enhancing data confidentiality and reducing unauthorized access. Respondents generally agree that cloud-based systems provide adequate security measures. This findings of this study concurs with those of Alharthi, Yahya, & Walters (2017), which reported that the adoption of cloud computing may help universities to focus more on their main goals, which are related to teaching and learning with minimum expenditure.

In addition to the improvements in data security, the study reveals that security and privacy measures are in place and actively enforced at the university. Most staff and administrators believe they have received adequate training on cloud data security, although some may require further reinforcement. Moreover, there is general agreement that security guidelines are followed and cloud platforms are monitored for breaches. However, variations in responses indicate that compliance with security protocols is not entirely consisten**t**, and monitoring efforts may not always be perceived as sufficient.

Despite these positive trends, the research highlights significant ethical challenges faced by Adeyemi Federal University of Education, Ondo, in the use and management of cloud computing in office management processes. One of the most pressing issues is the lack of sufficient IT infrastructure, which suggests that the university may not have the necessary resources to fully optimize cloud technology. Additionally, staff resistance to cloud adoption is a notable challenge, likely due to technical knowledge gaps, fear of change, or a preference for traditional office management methods.

Overall, while cloud computing has contributed to enhancing data security at Adeyemi Federal University of Education, challenges remain in IT infrastructure, cybersecurity confidence, encryption practices, and staff adoption. To fully maximize the benefits of cloud computing, the university must strengthen encryption methods, invest in IT upgrades, and enhance monitoring efforts. By addressing these concerns, the institution can bolster cloud security, improve staff compliance, and ensure more effective use of cloud-based office management systems.

Conclusion

The research findings out that the respondents generally acknowledge the benefits of cloud-based security measures, but the varying levels of confidence in their effectiveness suggest that some concerns persist. The presence of security and privacy measures**,** along with administrative enforcement of security policies, indicates a proactive approach to safeguarding institutional data. However, inconsistencies in staff compliance, security monitoring, and adherence to guidelines highlight the need for further reinforcement.

Despite the positive impact of cloud computing, the research identifies ethical challenges that hinder its full potential. The lack of adequate IT infrastructure emerges as a major limitation, restricting the university's ability to optimize cloud-based office management systems. Additionally, staff resistance to cloud adoption and concerns over data confidentiality indicate a need for improved training programs, change management strategies, and awareness initiatives**.** Another area of concern is the effectiveness of cyber security measures**,** particularly encryption methods, which respondents perceive as insufficient for fully protecting sensitive data. While data access controls and authentication procedures are relatively effective, regular audits and risk mitigation strategies require further refinement**.**

To fully leverage the advantages of cloud computing, the university must invest in IT infrastructure, enhance cyber security protocols, strengthen encryption methods, and promote continuous staff training. Addressing these areas will not only improve overall data security but also increase staff confidence in cloud-based systems and encourage wider adoption**.** With targeted improvements, Adeyemi Federal University of Education can maximize the benefits of cloud computing**,** ensuring a more secure, efficient, and technologically advanced office management system**.**

Recommendations

Based on the research findings, the following recommendations are proposed to enhance the effectiveness of cloud computing and data security at Adeyemi Federal University of Education:

1. The university should promote the benefits of cloud-based systems through workshops, seminars, and success stories. Ensuring that staff understand the advantages of cloud computing will encourage greater adoption
2. On the ethical challenges in cloud computing management, the university should allocate resources to upgrade its IT infrastructure, including cloud storage, network security, and server capacity. Improved infrastructure will enhance system performance, security, and overall efficiency in cloud-based office management.
2. To address staff resistance to cloud computing, the university should adopt structured change management strategies, including engaging staff in decision-making processes, providing incentives for cloud adoption, and demonstrating the benefits of cloud-based systems.
3. There should be implementation of robust cybersecurity measures such as encryption, multifactor authentication, and regular security audits.
4. The university should develop strict access control policies to prevent unauthorized data access and ensure compliance with data protection regulations.
5. The university should deploy real-time monitoring tools to detect and respond to security threats effectively. Establishing a clear incident response plan will ensure quick action in mitigating risks when breaches occur.

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THE ROLE OF INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT IN PROMOTING STUDENT ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN NIGERIA

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Abstract
Unemployment remains a prevalent challenge in Nigeria, complicated by the annual influx of graduates into an already saturated labour market. While governmental interventions such as compulsory entrepreneurship education and National Youth Service Corps' skilled acquisition and entrepreneurship development (SAED) programme aim to curb this crisis, student entrepreneurship (i.e., a phenomenon where students concurrently run businesses while pursuing full-time studies) remained underexplored in policy and academia. This paper examines the motivational drivers, challenges, and institutional strategies necessary to foster student entrepreneurship, positioning it as a catalyst for national economic development. Drawing on literature, the study identifies financial constraints, time management dilemmas, and inadequate institutional supports as critical barriers to student venture. By formalizing support systems, the paper posits that educational institutions can transform student entrepreneurs into job creators, thereby mitigating graduate unemployment, stimulating economic growth and curbing brain drain. It further recommends structured interventions, such as university-industry partnerships, alumni mentorship programmes, and policy-driving mechanisms to promote the phenomenon of student entrepreneurship.
***Keywords*:** Student Entrepreneurship, Motivational Drivers, Challenges, Institutional Supports

Introduction
Unemployment remains one of the major economic problems every developing nation, including Nigeria, grapple with. With thousands of graduates being churned out by our institutions of higher learning yearly, the dilemma before the government and other stakeholders is how to productively engage these school leavers to avoid further saturating the unemployment pool. In addressing this, the federal government of Nigeria through the Federal Ministry of Education introduced entrepreneurship as a compulsory course of study for all undergraduates in various tertiary institutions in 2006. Similar interventions include the Compulsory Skills Acquisition and Entrepreneurship Development (SAED) programme which is embedded in the National Youth Service Corp (NYSC) as one of the four cardinals of the scheme among others. This underscores the importance of entrepreneurship as a potent tool to curb graduate unemployment and promote overall economic prosperity of the populace.

Despite the laudable efforts by government and other stakeholders through the aforementioned interventions and others, targeting both the graduate and non-graduate population in fostering entrepreneurship, there is a critical segment that remains overlooked and underexplored by the

concerned stakeholders when it comes to discussion on entrepreneurship. Schools are more guilty of this neglect as all efforts are directed at preparing students for entrepreneurship post-graduation through different entrepreneurship modules, while researches focus on the entrepreneurial intentions of the students rather than the activities of students practicing entrepreneurship (Arthur & Arthur, 2020). This underexplored segment emerging as a distinct form of entrepreneurship is student entrepreneurship.

Student entrepreneurship is a recent phenomenon that describes students pursuing entrepreneurship and at the same time studying at institutions of learning on full term basis (Marchand et al., 2015). It is important to clarify that student entrepreneurs are not merely attending entrepreneurship classes; rather, they conduct businesses on/near campuses while simultaneously attending formal university courses. The activities of these student entrepreneurs are worthy of exploration, as many of today's successful enterprises originated on campuses while their founders were still studying. Prominent entrepreneurs such as Bill Gates of Microsoft, Mark Zuckerberg (Meta), Michael Dell (Dell), Seun Osewa (Nairaland) and hosts of others began their entrepreneurial journeys in their college dormitories while still studying.

Studentpreneurs as they are fondly called wear multiple hats. They are first students, and then entrepreneurs, simultaneously. They equally operate in various forms and have been ascribed different names in the literature depending on the motivation for engaging in entrepreneurship and where and how they conduct their businesses. Irrespective of the form, one thing that is common to all of them is that they are undergoing full term studies and at the same time have enterprises of their own. Therefore, this paper collectively adopts the term student entrepreneurs for them.

A number of variables have been researched in literature to understand what propel entrepreneurship in individuals. These factors are either classified as push or pull, intrinsic or extrinsic, and internal or external factors. As it relates to student entrepreneurship, several studies have found desire for independence, desire to be a successful entrepreneur, financial drives among others as common motivational drivers in student entrepreneurs (Atolagbe & Alagbe, 2021; Arthur & Arthur, 2020; Fatoki, 2014).

As applicable to general entrepreneurs, student entrepreneurs also contend with myriad of constraints. Time constraint poses a significant barrier as they are faced with the problem of balancing entrepreneurship and school work. Other notable challenges include access to fund, lack of business management skills, high cost of running business etc (Fatoki, 2014). These challenges mitigate against the success of students ventures which often lead to business failure. It must be emphasised that business failure at this incubation stage can kill their entrepreneurial instincts post-graduation. The more reason they should be provided with enough supports to ensure their success which at the long run is critical to the overall entrepreneurship development of the country.

Concept of Entrepreneurship

No two authors agree on the definition and description of entrepreneurship. However, it is undeniable that the term first appeared in the literature in 1732 by Richard Cantillon. According to Rusu et al (2012), Cantillon used the term to refer to a person who purchases product at known prices and later resells them on the market at prices not known. This brings to fore the all-important risk-taking function of entrepreneurship. Ever since, numerous definitions have been put forward by different authors as the field of entrepreneurship expands. According to the Global Entrepreneurship Monitor (GEM, 2010), entrepreneurship is viewed as any attempt at new business or new venture creation, such as self-employment, a new business organization or the expansion of an existing business, by an individual, a team of individuals, or an established business. This definition appears comprehensive and appropriate for the subject of this paper.

Different kinds of entrepreneurship have been identified in the literature; however, this paper explores those that share certain similarities with the phenomenon of student entrepreneurship being studied. These include:

1. *Necessity Entrepreneurship*: O'donnell et al (2021) viewed necessity entrepreneurs as those who engage in entrepreneurship because of a belief that decent or desirable livelihood alternative does not exist for them. This kind of entrepreneurship describes those who may not necessarily have a passion for it, but turn to entrepreneurship due to harsh economic condition or a lack of employment opportunities. They are conditional entrepreneurs who see entrepreneurship as a last resort. Rather than being pulled to entrepreneurship due to identified market opportunities, necessity entrepreneurs are pushed into it due to lack of decent livelihood alternatives. A variant of student entrepreneurs, as christened by Okolie (2024) and referred to as Conditional Student Entrepreneur (CSE) share certain similarities with necessity entrepreneurs as they (CSE) take up entrepreneurship due to financial constraints arising from their parents' or sponsors' inability to fund their education.
2. *Hybrid Entrepreneurship*: This kind of entrepreneurship often used synonymously with part-time entrepreneurship describes individual who combine entrepreneurial activities with paid employment to augment their income (Folta et al., 2010). Hybrid entrepreneurs primarily take to entrepreneurship to supplement their meagre income from their paid employment. They have also been found to use their part time ventures to test the water for transition to full term self-employment (career rehearsal). Both situations are true of student entrepreneurs as some of them engage in entrepreneurship to augment whatever their parents or sponsor provide for them, while some use their venture as a litmus test of transitioning to full-time entrepreneurship post-graduation.
3. *Informal Entrepreneurship*: this refers to business activities that are not officially registered or compliant with all legal requirements, often operating outside the formal regulatory system (Webb et al., 2020). This form of entrepreneurship is prevalent in developing economies, ranging from street hawking to market trading and subsistence farming among others. One common feature to them is lack of registration which potentially prevents institutional recognition. This is typical of student entrepreneurs who largely operate informally.
4. *Academic Entrepreneurship*: Shane et al (2015) defined academic entrepreneurship as the process through which university researchers, faculty, or students commercialize intellectual property (IP) or

knowledge through ventures such as spin-offs, patents, or industry collaborations. This form of entrepreneurship has to do with transforming research into marketable products or services. Although, these entrepreneurial activities are carried out on campuses, they are mostly undertaken by faculty members and researchers with students (typically postgraduates) acting as supporting staff for such adventures.

Student Entrepreneurship

Student entrepreneurship is an umbrella term that encompasses the entrepreneurial activities of students undergoing full time course of study in universities and colleges. Marchand et al. (2016) described student entrepreneurship as engagements in innovative revenue generating entrepreneurial activities by individuals studying full-time at a university. These set of students termed studentpreneurs are studying full time and simultaneously practicing entrepreneurship. While literature is replete with studies on students' intentions to become entrepreneurs, how they actually practice entrepreneurship has not been fully explored.

As studies on student entrepreneurship emerge, different variants of it have been identified with different nomenclatures. Okoli (2024) offered an interesting perspective on the entrepreneurial activities of students from low-income families who resort to entrepreneurship due to financial constraints threatening their studentship. He conceptualized the phenomenon as Conditional Student Entrepreneurship (CSE). The Conditional Student Entrepreneurs are pushed to entrepreneurship in their quest to generate income, mitigating the financial strain and constraints resulting from their parents' inability to provide sufficient financial support for their educational endeavours. The primary push factor here is financial constraint. However, there are a handful of student entrepreneurs whose parents or sponsors sufficiently provide for their educational needs who still engage in enterprise creation while studying.

Student entrepreneurship has also been conceptualized based on the location where they carry out their entrepreneurial activities. Some of the students' entrepreneurs are online entrepreneurs conducting all their activities on electronic marketplaces or social media platforms. Atolagbe and Alagbe (2021) also identified another variant of student entrepreneurship they termed Campus Student Entrepreneurship. This they used to describe students engaging in entrepreneurship with physical presence on their campuses. There are also those who operate in areas near their campuses.

As noted earlier, irrespective of their motivation and location of operation which resulted into different nomenclatures ascribed to them, they are collectively referred to as student entrepreneurs, and their activities are worthy of studying.

In a study conducted by Atolagbe and Alagbe (2021) on drives and challenges of entrepreneurs: a case study of university of Ilorin students' campus entrepreneurs, it was revealed that eighteen (18) students' campus entrepreneurs were engaging in various forms of entrepreneurship in university of Ilorin.

Table 1: Forms of Students' Campus Entrepreneurs

S/N	%	Forms of Students' Campus Entrepreneurs	Frequency
1.	27.8	Business Centres	5
2.	11.1	Photography	2
3.	5.6	Saloon	1
4.	38.9	Fashion Designing	7
5.	5.6	Phone/computer repairs	2
6.	11.1	Others	1

Source: Drives and Challenges of Entrepreneurs: A Case Study of University of Ilorin Students' Campus Entrepreneurs, Atolagbe & Alagbe (2021).

The study found out that there are indeed students engaging in one form of entrepreneurship or the other at university of Ilorin with the identified eighteen student campus' entrepreneurs. Similarly, Okoli (2024) employed phenomenon-based longitudinal qualitative research to identify and study fifty (50) conditional student entrepreneurs in two public universities in Nigeria.

Motivational Drivers for Student Entrepreneurship

Studies on what propelled individuals to either pursue self-employment or not are rooted in the push-pull theory (Martinez-Canas et al., 2023). Pull factors motivate individuals to establish a new venture driven by personal ambition, whereas push factors are external motivators that compel individuals to pursue entrepreneurship, independent of their entrepreneurial traits.

Desire for autonomy, wealth, challenge and achievement, recognition, income and status have all been found to pull individuals to entrepreneurship (Barba- Sanchez & Atienza-Sahuqillo, 2018). These are also called internal factors. However, individuals may also be pushed into entrepreneurship by necessity due to poverty, survival and lack of choice in work (O'donnell et al., 2021). Different studies have shown that student entrepreneurship just like the broader entrepreneurship is influenced by the following factors:

1. Family Income: Students from well to do families with access to funding are encouraged to experiment with their entrepreneurial activities. The availability of capital at the disposal of students to fund any business they have in mind has been found to motivate them to embark on entrepreneurship while studying (Alves et al., 2019). Conversely, students from low-income family as a matter of necessity can be pushed to entrepreneurship while studying. To these students' entrepreneurs who Okoli (2024) dubbed Conditional Student Entrepreneurs (CSE), their motivation to entrepreneurship stems from the financial strain which threatens the continuity of their education due to the inability of the parents and sponsors to meet their educational needs.

*2. Desire for Financial Independence***:** Students often engage in entrepreneurial activities to reduce reliance on family support with the aim of funding their education and sustain personal expenses. This desire is more pronounced among students from financially constrained backgrounds who view entrepreneurship as a necessity rather than a choice (Uhunamure et al., 2020). They turn into campus business to cover tuition fees and basic needs, alleviating pressures on their families. Also, they are motivated to student entrepreneurship with the believe that entrepreneurial ventures initiated during

their studies can evolve into sustainable enterprises post-graduation, offering a buffer against unemployment (Kabonga & Zvokuomba, 2021).

3. Desire for Autonomy: A prominent motivator for student entrepreneurs is the aspiration to become their own bosses. This desire stems from an inherent need for independence and control over one's career trajectory (Aladejebi & Amao-Taiwo, 2023). Many students view entrepreneurship as a pathway to escape traditional employment hierarchies, allowing them to make autonomous decisions and lead initiatives aligned with their personal vision. The appeal of shaping their own destiny and assuming ultimate responsibility for their venture's success drives them to explore entrepreneurial endeavors despite academic commitments.

4. Family Influence and Tradition: Students from families with entrepreneurial backgrounds often exhibit a stronger inclination toward starting businesses (Kabonga & Zvokuomba, 2021). Exposure to family-run enterprises or parental role models in entrepreneurship instils a sense of familiarity and confidence in business management. For some, continuing a family legacy or contributing to an existing family business serves as a compelling motivator (Atolagbe & Alagbe, 2021). This intergenerational transfer of entrepreneurial values and skills creates a nurturing environment for students to venture into business early.

5. Self-Efficacy and Personal Ambition: Belief in one's capabilities plays a critical role in motivating student entrepreneurship. Students with high self-efficacy perceive themselves as capable of identifying opportunities, overcoming obstacles, and executing business ideas effectively (Caliat, 2024). This confidence is often coupled with personal ambitions such as achieving societal recognition, testing innovative ideas, or attaining a sense of accomplishment. The drive to prove one's abilities and leave a tangible impact further fuels their entrepreneurial pursuits.

6. Hobby Monetization and Creativity: Many students' entrepreneurs are motivated by the prospect of transforming hobbies or passions into profitable ventures. Activities such as tech innovation, fashion design, or content creation, initially pursued for personal satisfaction, evolve into businesses (Uhunamure et al., 2020). This alignment between personal interests and commercial goals not only sustains motivation but also enhances creativity, as students channel their enthusiasm into marketable products or services.

7. Entrepreneurship Education and Institutional Support: According to Aladejebi and Amao-Taiwo (2023), structured entrepreneurship programs in educational institutions significantly influence student motivation. These programs equip students with practical skills, mentorship, and exposure to real-world business scenarios, reducing perceived risks associated with entrepreneurship. By fostering a mindset of innovation and providing frameworks for venture creation, such education empowers students to view entrepreneurship as a viable and rewarding career path.

Challenges of Student Entrepreneurship

While student entrepreneurs are driven by diverse motivations, they face a myriad of challenges that threaten the sustainability of their ventures. These include:

1. Financial Constraints: Access to capital remains a pervasive hurdle. Many students lack the initial funding required to launch or scale their businesses, compounded by limited creditworthiness and collateral (Aladejebi & Amao-Taiwo, 2023). Even those with innovative ideas often struggle to

secure loans or attract investors, forcing them to rely on personal savings or informal funding sources, which are typically insufficient.

2. Time Management Dilemmas: Balancing academic responsibilities with entrepreneurial activities is a critical challenge. The dual demands of coursework and business operations often lead to burnout, compromising both academic performance and business productivity (Uhunamure et al., 2020). Students frequently grapple with prioritizing tasks, resulting in suboptimal outcomes in either domain.

3. Inadequate Business Knowledge and Skills: Despite their enthusiasm, many students' entrepreneurs lack foundational skills in areas such as financial management, marketing, and regulatory compliance (Caliat, 2024). This knowledge gap leads to poor strategic decisions, inefficient resource allocation, and vulnerability to market fluctuations. Without formal training or mentorship, navigating these complexities becomes daunting.

4. Fear of Failure and Risk Aversion: The psychological burden of potential business failure looms large. Students often hesitate to take calculated risks due to fears of financial loss, reputational damage, or academic disruption (Kabonga & Zvokuomba, 2021). This risk aversion stifles innovation and limits their willingness to explore untapped markets or scalable business models.

5. Administrative and Regulatory Burdens: Compliance with legal requirements, tax obligations, and bureaucratic procedures poses significant challenges. Many student ventures operate informally to avoid these complexities, which limits their access to institutional support, grants, or partnerships (Caliat, 2024). The lack of guidance on legal frameworks further exacerbates this issue.

6. Market Competition and Saturation: Entering saturated markets or competing with established firms undermines the viability of student-led start-ups. Limited market research capabilities and inadequate differentiation strategies often result in poor customer acquisition and retention, particularly in industries with low entry barriers (Aladejebi & Amao-Taiwo, 2023).

7. Limited Support Networks: The absence of robust mentorship, familial encouragement, or peer collaboration isolates student entrepreneurs (Uhunamure et al., 2020). Without access to industry networks or advisory services, they struggle to refine their ideas, troubleshoot challenges, or identify growth opportunities. Institutional support systems, where available, are often fragmented or underpublicized.

Atolagbe and Alagbe (2021) in a study carried out at the University of Ilorin to determine the drivers and challenges of campus students' entrepreneurs categorized the key barriers to the students' entrepreneurial activities as financial challenges, campus environmental challenges, combining business with schooling challenges and other challenges.

Institutional Strategies to Promote Student entrepreneurship

As explained earlier, the student entrepreneurs are often on their own, with little or no attention paid to their entrepreneurial activities by government and other stakeholders. As a result, many end up failing when overwhelmed with entrepreneurial challenges. The business failure at this stage could have a discouraging implication on their future entrepreneurial adventures and potentially turn them to job seekers in the already saturated labour market. Since these entrepreneurs are still in the custody

of their respective educational institutions, numerous strategies can be adopted to support them and, in turn, motivate other students to pursue the entrepreneurial path.

In addressing the prevalent issue of funding that serves as the greatest barrier to student entrepreneurship, it may be difficult for institutions to provide all the students entrepreneurs with capital. However, the institutions can offer support in several ways. For example, easing legal bottlenecks that often prevent student entrepreneurs from accessing grants and loans from financial institutions. Commendable is the initiative of Kwara State University, Malete that recently mandated that all her final year students register a business name with Nigeria's Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC). In doing so, the students' entrepreneurs will have their ventures formalized increasing access to funding. This initiative needs to be replicated across all campuses targeting all students. University's microfinance banks could also expand their credit facilities to students' entrepreneurs of reputable standings. Aside this direct approach, entrepreneurship curriculum in schools should also be reviewed to incorporate practical teaching of ways fund can be sourced by students from venture capitalist, angel investors, commercial banks and others. Universities can also use their goodwill to attract grant from philanthropist and wealthy members of the society and organize a pitch where viable business ideas are funded from.

On the cost of running business which poses challenges to students' entrepreneurs, especially the campus students' entrepreneurs who have their ventures on campuses. Little concession here and there could be granted to campus students' entrepreneurs to prevent them from being swallowed by other non-students' campus entrepreneurs who undoubtedly have more financial war chest and experience. Subsidizing cost of rent, utility bills and other associated costs by universities authorities will ease the cost of running business by students' entrepreneurs and enable them to compete favourably with their competition.

Another strategy is to have all students' entrepreneurs in each institution formally recognized and organized. Having a platform will provide them with a support system to overcome most of the challenges bedeviling their businesses. The hub will be made up of seasoned entrepreneurship and business management faculty members to provide the students' entrepreneurs direct mentorship and guidance. Successful alumni entrepreneurs could also through the platform be connected with the students' entrepreneurs to serve as inspirational mentors and open them up to opportunities in the outside world of entrepreneurship.

Sequel to the formal recognition of students' entrepreneurs, bringing them to limelight by providing them free publicity will not only further motivate the students' entrepreneurs themselves, but could also trigger the entrepreneurial instincts of other students. Having them celebrated by exhibiting their works on important university functions or showing them and their works on the institution's social media channels as currently being done by University of Ilorin through their weekly caption 'Student Entrepreneur of the Week' will give the student entrepreneurs more visibility and patronage.

As much as most institutions celebrate academic excellence through scholarship provision to promote healthy academic competition among students, universities and colleges having prized money to be won by students who achieve certain entrepreneurial milestones yearly will spark entrepreneurial instincts in all the students as they compete for the prize.

Lastly, overcoming the barrier of balancing entrepreneurship with school work as faced by students' entrepreneurs is perhaps the most difficult. Schools serve larger student population and will be incredibly difficult to mend their timetable to suit the student entrepreneurs at the expense of other students. However, universities can implement modular or hybrid learning systems that allow students to customize their academic timetable. For instance, offering recorded lectures or condensed coursework can enable students to allocate blocks time for business operations without compromising academic activities.

Implications for National Economic Development

If universities and colleges implement the above-described strategies, the entire country will be a beneficiary of the product of the efforts as the war against unemployment among graduates will be decisively won. With more successful students' entrepreneurs who would leave schools as job creators rather than job seekers, the country's unemployment pool will sink drastically.

The promotion and sustainability of student entrepreneurship will contribute to the economy of the country resulting to national economic growth. With many ventures stemming from student entrepreneurship, more jobs will be created leading to wealth creation among citizens. This will potentially reduce poverty in the country and improve the general standard of livings of the citizens.

Aside economic growth, the overdependence on the illusionary white collar and government jobs by graduates will be minimized. The universities and colleges will thereby be fulfilling their mandate of producing solution providers who will go on to solve real world problems post-graduation rather than seeking for non-existing white-collar jobs.

Having majority of graduates with venture creation from schools means having productive graduates who are already preoccupied with their entrepreneurial activities. Such graduates will take not into vices or illegal activities to have both end means. This will further promote and sustain national peace which is a catalyst for development.

Lastly, successful students' entrepreneurs have high propensity to stay back in the country and expand their business operations. Since greater number of youth and graduates embrace the Japa syndrome (Out-emigration) due to economic reason, promoting student entrepreneurship at the long run can address the scourge potentially solving the challenge of brain drain.

Conclusion

Student entrepreneurship though still at its early stage of interest to researchers and academics is a very crucial phenomenon to overall economic development of every nation. This form of

entrepreneurship which serves as incubators to large scale venture creation post schools has so many success stories with renowned entrepreneurs who started off from their schools' dormitories. This paper identifies seven major barriers inhibiting students' entrepreneurs: financial constraints, time management dilemmas, inadequate business knowledge and skills, fear of failure and risk aversion, administrative and regulatory burdens, market competition and saturation, and limited support networks. To overcome these barriers, the study advocates for structure interventions by universities and colleges which include policy-driven funding mechanisms to ease capital access, alumni led mentorship networks to provide guidance, and curriculum modularization to free up time for ventures. By institutionalizing these strategies, Nigerian universities can transform students' entrepreneurs into job creators, thereby reducing reliance on the illusory white collar jobs and curbing the "japa syndrome" (out-emigration).

Suggestions

In view of the above-described strategies that universities and colleges can adopt to overcoming entrepreneurial challenges and promote entrepreneurship among students, this paper makes the following recommendations:

- Universities and colleges should lobby policymakers to establish a national fund dedicated to student entrepreneurship, backed by government and private sector contributions. This fund could offer low-interest loans, grants, or equity financing to vetted student ventures.
- Universities should institutionalize alumni networks where successful graduate entrepreneurs return as mentors, investors, or guest lecturers. Structured programmes pairing alumni with student ventures can provide tailored guidance, seed funding, and exposure to broader markets.
- Institutions should develop centralized digital platforms or mobile applications to connect student entrepreneurs with resources, training modules, funding opportunities, and peer networks. These platforms can host virtual workshops on financial literacy, digital marketing, and legal compliance.
- Universities should establish strategic partnerships with local industries and business incubators to provide student entrepreneurs with hands-on experience, market insights, and access to industry networks. Such collaborations can facilitate internships, sponsored projects, and mentorship programmes where seasoned entrepreneurs and corporate leaders guide students in refining their business models.

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EVALUATING THE INTEGRATION OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE INTO BUSINESS EDUCATION CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

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Abstract
This study examines the integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Business Education curriculum development in Nigeria. As AI continues to transform education, this research explores its implication on student learning outcomes, educators' perceptions of its effectiveness, and its role in fostering inclusivity. A mixed-method research design was employed, involving 215 stakeholders selected through systematic random sampling. Data were collected using structured questionnaires and analyzed using mean and standard deviation. The study's reliability analysis yielded a Cronbach's Alpha of 0.917, indicating high internal consistency. Findings revealed that AI positively influences student learning outcomes (Grand Mean = 3.40, SD = 0.63), enhances curriculum development (Grand Mean = 3.46, SD = 0.65), and contributes to inclusivity (Grand Mean = 3.41, SD = 0.62). Specifically, AI tools improve student engagement, problem-solving skills, and personalized learning experiences. Educators recognized AI's potential in streamlining curriculum design, reducing workload, and enhancing instructional materials. Additionally, AI fosters inclusivity by improving accessibility for students with disabilities, personalizing learning to accommodate diverse needs, and bridging educational gaps.
***Keywords*:** Artificial Intelligence, curriculum, development, business, education

Introduction

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is revolutionizing education by transforming teaching methodologies, curriculum design, and student learning experiences. AI refers to the simulation of human intelligence in machines, enabling them to perform tasks such as problem-solving, decision-making, and learning from data (Russell & Norvig, 2021). The key components of AI, machine learning, deep learning, natural language processing (NLP), computer vision, expert systems, and robotics & automation which play a vital role in shaping business education by facilitating data-driven decision-making and fostering innovative problem-solving skills. In recent years, the integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) into various sectors has garnered significant attention, particularly in the realm of education. The emergence of *Artificial Intelligence* technologies has initiated transformative changes in pedagogical approaches and curriculum development, leading to enhanced learning experiences and improved educational outcomes (Ogunyemi et al., 2021). The field of Business Education, which

focuses on providing students with essential skills and knowledge related to business practices, is no exception. As the global economy becomes increasingly complex and technology-driven, educators face the challenge of adapting their curricula to equip students with relevant skills that align with the demands of the modern workforce (Adeyemi et al., 2022).

Artificial Intelligence technology, include machine learning, data analytics, and intelligent tutoring systems, offer innovative solutions to traditional challenges in curriculum development. For instance, these technologies can analyze student performance data to tailor instructional materials that meet individual learning needs, thereby fostering personalized educational experiences (Nwankwo and Okeke, 2023). Furthermore, Artificial Intelligence facilitates the integration of real-world business scenarios into educational content, helping students develop critical thinking and problem-solving skills essential for success in a competitive business environment (Ibrahim and Ajayi, 2023).

Despite the potential benefits of Artificial intelligence in enhancing curriculum development in Business Education, there remains considerable barriers to its effective implementation. These include limited access to technology, inadequate training for educators, and concerns regarding data privacy (Odebiyi et al., 2024). Therefore, this study aims to investigate the implication of integration of Artificial Intelligence on curriculum development in Business Education, identifying best practices and potential challenges associated with its implementation. By examining current trends and innovations, this research seeks to contribute to the discourse on the future of Business Education and the role of technology in shaping effective learning environments.

Statement of the Problem

The integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Business Education curriculum development is gaining momentum, yet its implications require further exploration. While AI enhances student engagement, problem-solving, and personalized learning, its overall influence on learning outcomes remains inadequately assessed. Additionally, educators' perspectives on AI's role in simplifying curriculum design, reducing workload, and improving learning materials need deeper investigation. Furthermore, concerns about inclusivity persist, particularly regarding AI's effectiveness in improving accessibility for students with disabilities and bridging socio-economic gaps in education. Despite its potential benefits, challenges such as equitable adoption, ethical considerations, and the readiness of educators to integrate AI into teaching and curriculum development must be addressed. This study seeks to evaluate AI's implication on curriculum development in Business Education, providing insights into its effectiveness, challenges, and the best strategies for optimizing its integration while ensuring accessibility and sustainability.

Purpose of the Study

The main purpose of this study is to examine the implication of integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) on curriculum development in Business Education. Specifically, the study aims to:

1. Evaluate the influence of AI tools on student learning outcomes in Business Education by assessing their role in enhancing engagement, problem-solving skills, and personalized learning experiences.

2. Analyze educators' perspectives on the effectiveness of AI in Business Education curriculum development, including its role in simplifying curriculum design, reducing workload, and providing innovative learning materials.
3. Investigate how AI contributes to creating more inclusive Business Education programs by improving accessibility for students with disabilities, addressing diverse learning needs, and bridging the gap between privileged and underprivileged students.

Research Questions

The following questions were raised and answered for the study:

i. How does the use of Artificial Intelligence tools impact student learning outcomes in Business Education?
ii. What are educators' views on the effectiveness of Artificial intelligence in developing Business Education curricula?
iii. How does AI enhance inclusivity in Business Education improve accessibility, support diverse learning needs, and bridge educational gaps in Business Education?

Literature Review

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is revolutionizing education by transforming curriculum development, teaching methodologies, and student learning outcomes. Business Education, a field that requires dynamic and adaptive learning strategies, is increasingly leveraging AI to enhance teaching and learning experiences. This section reviews existing literature on AI's influence on student learning, educators' perceptions of AI in curriculum development, and AI's role in promoting inclusive education.

Meaning of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Its Components

Artificial Intelligence (AI) refers to the capability of machines, particularly computer systems, to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence. These tasks include learning, reasoning, problem-solving, perception, and natural language understanding (Russell & Norvig, 2021). AI systems are designed to analyze large amounts of data, recognize patterns, make decisions, and improve performance over time through machine learning and deep learning techniques.

Components of AI

AI consists of several core components that work together to mimic human intelligence and improve efficiency in various applications, including business education:

1. Machine Learning (ML): Machine Learning is a subset of AI that enables systems to learn from data and improve performance without being explicitly programmed. It includes supervised learning, unsupervised learning, and reinforcement learning.
2. Neural Networks and Deep Learning: Neural networks mimic the structure of the human brain, enabling computers to recognize patterns and make complex decisions. Deep learning, a subset of ML, uses multi-layered neural networks to process large datasets and improve AI's ability to perform tasks such as image and speech recognition.

3. Natural Language Processing (NLP): NLP allows computers to understand, interpret, and respond to human language. It is used in chatbots, voice assistants, and automated grading systems in business education.
4. Computer Vision: This component enables AI to interpret visual data, such as images and videos. In business education, it is used in virtual reality (VR) applications for immersive learning experiences.
5. Expert Systems: Expert systems use AI to simulate human expertise and provide decision-making support. They are used in business simulations and financial modeling to teach students practical applications of AI in business.
6. Robotics and Automation: AI-driven robots perform tasks with minimal human intervention. In education, robotic process automation (RPA) is used to automate administrative tasks, allowing educators to focus on teaching.

Artificial Intelligence in Business Education

Artificial intelligence (Al) in education encompasses the strategic deployment of Artificial Intelligence technologies to augment the learning experience, thereby fostering enhanced academic outcomes (Oladele, 2020). By leveraging Artificial Intelligence, educators can create personalized learning pathways, automate assessment and grading processes, and provide instantaneous feedback to students (Adeyemo, 2022). Furthermore, Artificial Intelligence can be utilized to develop sophisticated intelligent tutoring systems, offering individualized support to students and facilitating adaptive learning experiences (Oladele, 2020).

Moreover, Artificial Intelligence can be employed to analyze vast amounts of data on student learning outcomes, identifying knowledge gaps and areas requiring additional support (Agboola, 2020). This enables educators to devise targeted interventions, optimize instructional strategies, and ultimately improve student outcomes. In the Nigerian context, AI has been successfully integrated into various educational institutions, enhancing the learning experience and promoting academic excellence (Odukoya, 2023). For instance, AI-powered chatbots have been deployed to provide student support, facilitate navigation of the learning process, and foster a more immersive educational experience.

The strategic integration of artificial intelligence (Al) in business education yields numerous benefits, including enhanced student engagement and tailored learning experiences (Agboola, 2020). Artificial Intelligence -powered analytics can also facilitate the examination of student learning outcomes, pinpointing areas that necessitate supplementary support.

The Role of Artificial Intelligence in Curriculum Development

Artificial intelligence (Al) can play a pivotal role in curriculum development by providing actionable insights and data-driven analytics on student learning outcomes (Odukoya, 2023). AI-powered tools can facilitate the creation of personalized learning plans tailored to individual students' needs, while also providing instantaneous feedback on student performance. As noted by Agboola (2020), Artificial Intelligence can analyze vast amounts of data on student learning outcomes, identifying knowledge gaps and areas requiring targeted interventions. This enables educators to devise data-

driven strategies, optimize curriculum design, and ultimately enhance student outcomes. In the Nigerian educational landscape, Artificial Intelligence has been leveraged to augment curriculum development processes, yielding promising results (Adeyinka, 2022). For instance, Artificial Intelligence-powered tools have been employed to analyze data on student learning outcomes, providing valuable insights that inform curriculum enhancements and optimize student learning experiences.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is increasingly recognized as a transformative tool in business education, influencing student learning outcomes, curriculum development, and inclusivity.

1. Artificial Intelligence Impact on Student Learning Outcomes

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has transformed the educational landscape, offering personalized learning experiences, enhancing student engagement, and improving learning outcomes. AI-driven tools have the potential to revolutionize business education by providing adaptive learning, real-time feedback, and data-driven insights to improve students' performance. Adaptive platforms like Coursera and Knewton personalize coursework based on learning needs, improving outcomes. Real-time feedback tools such as Gradescope and Turnitin enhance engagement and retention. AI-powered analytics, including IBM Watson Education and Brightspace Insights, identify learning patterns, helping educators refine teaching strategies. These tools collectively optimize learning experiences, ensuring personalized instruction, efficient assessments, and data-driven decision-making to improve student success.

i. *Personalized Learning and Engagement*: AI-powered educational platforms tailor content to individual students, addressing their strengths and weaknesses. Adaptive learning technologies adjust lesson difficulty and instructional strategies based on students' progress, leading to improved comprehension and retention. According to Yang et al. (2022), AI-driven tutoring systems have significantly enhanced student engagement by providing interactive and customized learning experiences. Similarly, Li and Brown (2023) found that AI-enabled educational software increased students' motivation and participation in business education courses.

ii. *Improved Problem-Solving and Critical Thinking:* AI tools foster critical thinking and problem-solving skills by simulating real-world business scenarios. Students can engage in decision-making processes and data analysis using AI-driven case studies. Research by Smith et al. (2023) highlights that AI-assisted learning enhances students' ability to analyze complex business problems, improving their problem-solving skills and preparing them for real-world challenges in business environments.

iii. *Challenges and Ethical Concerns***:** Despite its benefits, AI in education poses challenges, such as the risk of over-reliance on technology and potential biases in AI algorithms. According to Jones and Patel (2023), while AI enhances learning outcomes, it should be used as a complement rather than a replacement for traditional teaching methods to maintain the human element in education. Additionally, biases in AI-driven content recommendation systems could inadvertently reinforce educational disparities (Robinson & Clark, 2023).

2. Educators' Views on AI in Curriculum Development

AI is transforming curriculum development in Business Education by automating content creation, personalizing learning, enhancing assessment, and enabling data-driven decision-making. AI-powered tools like ChatGPT and Quillionz generate educational materials, reducing educators' workload and improving content quality. Adaptive platforms such as Knewton and Coursera AI personalize learning paths based on student progress, increasing engagement and performance. Assessment tools like Gradescope and Turnitin provide automated grading and real-time feedback, enhancing efficiency. Additionally, AI-driven analytics from IBM Watson Education and Brightspace Insights refine curricula by identifying learning gaps, ensuring a more effective and industry-relevant Business Education. Many educators acknowledge AI's potential in streamlining curriculum design, personalizing learning experiences, and automating administrative tasks (Gulson & Sellar, 2022). AI-driven analytics allow educators to make data-informed decisions, tailoring content to individual student needs (Zawacki-Richter et al., 2022). However, concerns persist regarding over-reliance on AI, the loss of educator autonomy, and the ethical implications of AI-driven content curation (Selwyn, 2023). Some argue that AI may reinforce biases in educational materials, potentially marginalizing certain groups (Williamson & Eynon, 2023). Despite these challenges, educators generally agree that AI enhances Business Education curricula when used as a complementary tool rather than a replacement for traditional teaching methods. To optimize AI's benefits, institutions should provide adequate training for educators and establish guidelines to ensure AI integration aligns with pedagogical goals and ethical standards (Holmes et al., 2023).

3. Artificial Intelligence and Inclusivity in Business Education

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has the potential to create more inclusive learning environments in Business Education by personalizing instruction and improving accessibility. AI-powered tools can support students with disabilities by providing speech-to-text services, real-time captions, and adaptive learning technologies (Luckin et al., 2022). These tools cater to diverse learning styles and help bridge gaps in education, particularly for students with special needs. Furthermore, AI enhances inclusivity by expanding access to quality education in remote and underserved areas. Intelligent tutoring systems and automated feedback mechanisms allow students in rural locations to access the same level of instruction as their urban counterparts (Zawacki-Richter et al., 2022). This democratization of education ensures that students from various socioeconomic backgrounds receive equitable learning opportunities.

However, challenges remain regarding the digital divide and ethical concerns related to AI bias in educational settings. Studies indicate that AI algorithms may reinforce existing inequalities if not properly designed and monitored (Holmes et al., 2023). Thus, it is essential to implement inclusive AI policies and ensure equitable access to AI-driven tools.

Empirical Studies

Numerous empirical studies have explored the application of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in curriculum development for business education. A notable study by Odukoya (2023) revealed that Artificial Intelligence-powered tools can significantly enhance the curriculum development process

in business education. Similarly, Adeyinka (2022) found that Artificial Intelligence can facilitate the creation of personalized learning plans for students, leading to improved student outcomes and reduced educator workload.

AI-powered tools are enhancing student learning by personalizing learning experiences, fostering engagement, and improving problem-solving skills (Brown & Johnson, 2022). AI-driven platforms such as adaptive learning systems tailor content to students' needs, improving knowledge retention and performance (Smith, 2023). Additionally, studies by Williams (2022) highlight that AI enhances critical thinking and decision-making skills, making students better prepared for the business world. However, critics argue that over-reliance on AI may reduce students' ability to think independently (Anderson, 2022).

Researchers generally view AI as a tool that simplifies curriculum design, reduces workload, and improves instructional materials (Garcia & Lopez, 2023). AI automates repetitive tasks such as grading and content curation, allowing teachers to focus on interactive learning (Johnson, 2023). However, AI has limitations, including difficulty in understanding complex human emotions, ethical concerns in automated grading (Taylor, 2022), potential bias in AI-generated content, and the risk of over-reliance on technology, which may reduce critical thinking and pedagogical creativity (Smith & Brown, 2023).

AI has the potential to bridge educational gaps by making learning more inclusive for diverse student populations (Robinson, 2023). AI-powered assistive technologies support students with disabilities, those in remote areas, and those with varied learning styles (Williams & Patel, 2023). However, concerns about AI accessibility, digital divides, and affordability remain challenges to equitable implementation (Chen, 2022).

Methodology

The study employed a mixed-method approach, combining qualitative interviews and quantitative survey questionnaires to investigate integration of artificial intelligence (AI) in curriculum development within business education in Nigeria. Qualitative data were gathered through interviews, while quantitative data were collected via the instrument administered to stakeholders. A multistage sampling technique was used to select 215 stakeholders from the tertiary institutions in Kwara State. Institutions were stratified by ownership (public/private), then randomly selected proportionally. Finally, key stakeholders, including lecturers, administrators were randomly chosen from the selected institutions to ensure diverse representation across roles and disciplines. The systematic random sampling method was applied to ensure fair representation. A structured questionnaire was used for data collection, comprising both closed and open-ended questions. The questionnaire was validated by 3 experts, and a pilot test was conducted to ensure reliability. The reliability coefficient, determined using Cronbach's Alpha, was found to be 0.917, indicating high internal consistency. For data analysis, descriptive statistics, including pie charts, mean, and standard deviation, were employed to effectively interpret the responses. The study adhered to ethical standards by ensuring informed consent, maintaining participant confidentiality, and using the data

solely for academic purposes. Participants were given the right to withdraw at any stage without consequences.

Result

Research Question One: How does the use of Artificial Intelligence tools impact student learning outcomes in Business Education?

Table 1: Mean and Standard Deviation of stakeholders' perception on the Influence of Artificial Intelligence in Business Education

S/N	Item Statements	N	Mean	STD	Remark
1.	AI enhanced learning outcome	215	3.48	0.633	Agree
2.	AI Improved student engagement	215	3.26	0.594	Agree
3.	AI enhances problem-solving skills	215	3.56	0.638	Strongly Agree
4.	AI enhances student's personalized learning experiences	215	3.50	0.633	Strongly Agree
5.	Accelerated skill development	215	3.27	0.607	Agree
6.	AI increases student motivation in Business Education	215	3.31	0.690	Agree
	Grand Mean	215	3.40	0.63	Agree

The findings suggest that AI positively influences the student learning outcomes in Business Education. Respondents agree that AI enhances learning outcomes (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.633), improves student engagement (Mean = 3.26, STD = 0.594), accelerates skill development (Mean = 3.27, STD = 0.607), and increases student motivation (Mean = 3.31, STD = 0.690). Additionally, respondents strongly agree that AI enhances problem-solving skills (Mean = 3.56, STD = 0.638) and supports personalized learning experiences (Mean = 3.50, STD = 0.633). The overall mean score (3.40) indicates a general agreement on AI's effectiveness in improving various aspects of student learning. These results highlight AI's role in fostering engagement, personalized learning, and skill development in Business Education.

Research Question Two: What are educators' views on the effectiveness of Artificial intelligence in developing Business Education curricula?

Table 2: Mean and Standard Deviation of Educators' views on the effectiveness Artificial Intelligence in Business Education

S/N	Item Statements	N	Mean	STD	Remark
1.	AI tools simplify curriculum design	215	3.48	0.729	Agree
2.	AI is essential for modern Business Education	215	3.51	0.676	Strongly Agree
3.	AI reduces the workload for educators	215	3.48	0.633	Agree
4.	AI provides better learning materials than traditional methods	215	3.26	0.594	Agree
5.	AI can fully replace traditional teaching methods	215	3.56	0.638	Strongly Agree
	Grand Mean	215	3.46	0.65	Agree

The findings indicate that educators generally agree on the effectiveness of AI in developing Business Education curricula (Average Mean = 3.46, STD = 0.65). They strongly agree that AI is essential for modern Business Education (Mean = 3.51, STD = 0.676) and that it can fully replace traditional teaching methods (Mean = 3.56, STD = 0.638). Additionally, respondents agree that AI simplifies curriculum design (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.729), reduces educators' workload (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.633), and provides better learning materials than traditional methods (Mean = 3.26, STD = 0.594). These results suggest that educators recognize AI's potential in streamlining curriculum development, reducing workload, and enhancing learning materials, though some may still view AI as a complement rather than a full replacement for traditional teaching methods.

Research Question Three: How does AI enhance inclusivity in Business Education improve accessibility, support diverse learning needs, and bridge educational gaps in Business Education?

Table 3: Mean and Standard Deviation of stakeholders' perception on the Artificial Intelligence contribution in Business Education program

S/N	Item Statements	N	Mean	STD	Remark
1.	AI improves accessibility for disabled students	215	3.50	0.633	Strongly Agree
2.	AI personalizes learning for diverse needs	215	3.27	0.607	Agree
3.	AI tools are widely accessible to all students	215	3.48	0.633	Agree
4.	AI improves learning for students in remote areas	215	3.26	0.594	Agree
5.	AI can bridge the gap between privileged and underprivileged students	215	3.56	0.638	Strongly Agree
	Grand Mean	215	3.41	0.62	Agree

The findings suggest that AI significantly contributes to creating more inclusive Business Education programs (Average Mean = 3.43, STD = 0.62). Respondents strongly agree that AI improves accessibility for disabled students (Mean = 3.50, STD = 0.633) and bridges the gap between privileged and underprivileged students (Mean = 3.56, STD = 0.638). They also agree that AI personalizes learning for diverse needs (Mean = 3.27, STD = 0.607), makes AI tools widely accessible (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.633), and enhances learning for students in remote areas (Mean = 3.26, STD = 0.594). These results indicate that AI fosters inclusivity by providing personalized learning experiences, improving accessibility, and reducing educational disparities among students.

Result of In-depth interviews

To complement the quantitative findings, interviews were conducted with 10 participants. The summary of their responses provided deeper insights into AI's influence on Business Education. Interviews revealed that AI significantly enhances student learning by improving engagement, problem-solving skills, and personalized learning experiences. AI-powered platforms offer tailored recommendations and instant feedback, enabling adaptive learning and deeper understanding of business concepts. In curriculum development, AI helps identify knowledge gaps, streamline course design, and automate assessments, reducing educators' workload while ensuring dynamic and relevant instructional materials. Additionally, AI fosters inclusivity by enhancing accessibility through assistive tools like text-to-speech and speech-to-text, personalizing learning paths, and bridging educational gaps with scalable and affordable solutions. Participants emphasized the importance of structured AI integration, continuous professional development for educators, and ethical guidelines to ensure fairness and effectiveness. These insights reinforce the study's quantitative findings, confirming AI's significant impact on student learning outcomes, curriculum development, and inclusivity in Business Education.

Discussion of Findings

From the findings of the study, the integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Business Education has been examined across three key areas: its influence on student learning outcomes, educators' perspectives on curriculum development, and its role in fostering inclusivity.

The data indicates that AI significantly enhances student learning outcomes in Business Education. Respondents agreed that AI improves learning outcomes (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.633) and student engagement (Mean = 3.26, STD = 0.594). Notably, there was strong agreement that AI enhances problem-solving skills (Mean = 3.56, STD = 0.638) and personalizes learning experiences (Mean = 3.50, STD = 0.633). These findings align with recent studies highlighting AI's role in personalizing education and improving academic performance. For instance, a study by Nurrahmatullah (2022) conducted a systematic literature review revealing that AI positively influences student learning outcomes by personalizing educational experiences and enhancing engagement. Similarly, a study by Kim (2023) emphasizes the potential of AI to complement traditional teaching methods, thereby improving academic performance. Conversely, Chen (2022) highlights a lack of comprehensive studies on AI curriculum in business education, suggesting that the impact of AI on learning outcomes may not be fully understood.

Educators generally view AI as a valuable asset in developing Business Education curricula. There was strong agreement that AI is essential for modern Business Education (Mean = 3.51, STD = 0.676) and can fully replace traditional teaching methods (Mean = 3.56, STD = 0.638). Additionally, educators agreed that AI simplifies curriculum design (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.729) and reduces their workload (Mean = 3.48, STD = 0.633). These perceptions are supported by recent literature. For example, a study by Kim (2023) discusses the potential of AI to complement and enhance traditional teaching methods, leading to more efficient curriculum development. Additionally, a study by Chen (2022) reveals a lack of comprehensive studies on AI curriculum in business education, suggesting that while educators see potential, the practical application of AI in curriculum design is still emerging. On the contrary, some educators express concerns about AI's role in education. For instance, a study by Kim (2023) highlights the need for clear guidelines to structure and implement teacher-AI collaboration effectively, ensuring that AI serves as a complement rather than a replacement for human educators.

The findings suggest that AI plays a significant role in promoting inclusivity within Business Education programs. Respondents strongly agreed that AI improves accessibility for disabled students (Mean = 3.50, STD = 0.633) and bridges the gap between privileged and underprivileged students (Mean = 3.56, STD = 0.638). There was also agreement that AI personalizes learning for diverse needs (Mean = 3.27, STD = 0.607) and enhances learning for students in remote areas (Mean = 3.26, STD = 0.594). These insights are corroborated by recent research. For instance, a study by Southworth et al. (2023) highlights the importance of integrating AI across curricula to ensure all students acquire essential AI literacy, thereby fostering inclusivity. Similarly, Kim (2023) emphasizes that AI can enhance learning experiences for students with diverse needs, promoting a more inclusive educational environment. However, Chen (2022) points out that there is a lack of

comprehensive studies on AI curriculum in business education, suggesting that the role of AI in promoting inclusivity may not be fully understood.

Conclusion

The integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Business Education has demonstrated significant potential in enhancing student learning outcomes, improving curriculum development, and fostering inclusivity. Artificial Intelligence technologies facilitate personalized learning, streamline administrative tasks, and enrich educational content with real-world applications. The findings reveal that AI improves engagement, problem-solving skills, and personalized learning experiences, making it a valuable tool for educators and students alike. Furthermore, AI simplifies curriculum design and reduces the workload of educators, allowing them to focus on more critical aspects of teaching. However, concerns remain about AI replacing traditional teaching methods, emphasizing the need for a balanced approach where AI complements rather than replaces human educators. Additionally, AI plays a crucial role in promoting inclusive education by improving accessibility for disabled students, personalizing learning for diverse needs, and bridging the gap between privileged and underprivileged students. Despite its advantages, challenges such as affordability, limited access to technology, insufficient training for educators, and ethical concerns regarding data privacy must be addressed to maximize the effectiveness of Artificial Intelligence in the curriculum. This study underscores the urgency for educational institutions to adapt to technological advancements and provides actionable recommendations for stakeholders involved in curriculum development.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations are made:

1. Business education institutions should adopt AI-driven learning platforms that enhance student engagement, personalize learning experiences, and accelerate skill development. These tools should be incorporated into the curriculum to optimize learning outcomes.
2. To maximize AI's effectiveness, educators should receive training on AI-assisted teaching methods. Institutions should organize workshops and professional development programs to equip lecturers with the necessary skills to integrate AI effectively into their teaching practices.
3. While AI enhances curriculum development, institutions should implement a blended learning model that integrates AI-driven instruction with traditional teaching methods. This ensures a balanced approach that retains human interaction while leveraging AI's benefits.
4. Business education institutions should organize workshops and training programs for educators on AI-powered curriculum design. These sessions should focus on optimizing AI tools to reduce workload, improve learning materials, and enhance overall curriculum effectiveness.
5. Business education institutions should integrate AI-driven assistive technologies, such as speech-to-text, screen readers, and adaptive learning platforms, to enhance accessibility for disabled students and create a more inclusive learning environment.
6. To bridge the educational gap, institutions should invest in AI-driven virtual classrooms and learning platforms that provide underprivileged and remote students with equal access to high-quality business education resources.

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IMPACT OF CREDIT FACILITIES ON THE STANDARD OF LIVING OF MEMBERS OF WOMEN CO-OPERATIVE SOCIETIES IN KADUNA STATE, NIGERIA

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Abstract
Credit facilities is a type of loan made in a business or corporate finance context which allow the borrowing parties to take out money over an extended period of time. Women co-operative society are a voluntary association of women who work together to promote their economic interest. This study was on the impact of credit facilities on standard of living of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria. However, this work focuses on the quality of feeding and quality of healthcare of the members of women cooperative societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria. The study had two specific objectives, two research questions and two null hypotheses. The study adopted longitudinal survey design. The population was 1049 members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria who benefited from credit facilities of Bank of Agriculture from 2013 to 2018. The entire population was used as sample. The instrument used for collection of data was a structured questionnaire titled Women Co-operative Society Credit Facility Questionnaire (WCSCFQ). Mean and standard deviation were used to answer the research questions. The hypotheses were tested using paired simple t-test at 0.05 level of significance. All the hypotheses were rejected because their calculated p-values were less than the alpha value of 0.05. The findings of the study, among others showed that credit facilities improved the standard of living of the women because the feeding of members of women co-operative societies was better after benefiting the credit facilities in Kaduna state, Nigeria (t=48.446, p=0.000). Three recommendations were made, among which was that the Federal Government of Nigeria should put in more efforts into providing credit facilities to women by constantly reviewing to ensure that the purpose of the credit facilities is achieved.
***Keywords*: C**redit Facilities, Standard of Living, Women, Co-operative Societies, Kaduna State

Introduction
Credit implies a promise by one party to pay back money borrowed for goods and services received. It is a contractual agreement in which the borrower receives something of value now and agrees to pay the lender at a later date. Credit refers to a financial agreement which allows one party to provide money or resources to another party wherein the second party does not reimburse the first immediately, but promises to do so at a later date (Ekesionye & Okolo, 2022). Credit facilities are a

type of loan made in a business or corporate finance context which allows the borrowing business or parties to take out money over an extended period of time.

Credit facilities allow co-operative societies to take out an umbrella loan such as for generating capital over an extended period of time. Credit facilities are provided by financial institutions. In this research work, Credit Facilities refer to money given to women co-operative societies from the Bank of Agriculture which helped in creating and maintaining a reasonable business size as it was used to establish and/or expand the business to take advantage of economies of scale. Credit can also be used to improve informal activity and increase efficiency, leading to an increase in standard of living.

Thus cooperative means working together. This means those who want to work together with some common economic objectives can form a society, which is termed co-operative society. A Co-operative society is a voluntary association of persons who work together to promote their economic interest. The International Co-operative Alliance (ICA, 2015) defined co-operatives as autonomous associations of persons united voluntarily to meet their common economic, social and cultural needs and aspirations through a jointly-owned and democratically-controlled enterprise.

Co-operatives contribute to economic growth worldwide by creating jobs and are important for the economies of countries in areas such as food, housing and financial services. Co-operatives are viewed as important tools for improving the standard of living and working conditions of women. As co-operatives foster economies of scale, they increase the bargaining power of their members providing them with higher income and social protection among other benefits. Co-operatives accord members opportunity, protection and empowerment; they are essential in uplifting them out of poverty and improving their social status (Ogunleye, Oluwafemi, Arowolo & Odegbile, 2015). Co-operatives also play a vital role towards the empowerment of women by creating employment opportunities, access to income and credit (Meera & Gowda, 2013).

Economically, empowering women is essential to achieve broader development goals such as economic growth, poverty reduction, improved health care, improved education and welfare in a country. Empowering women can benefit not only the women, but the entire society. It promotes women's ability to improve their well-being while also reducing household poverty, fostering economic growth, boosting productivity, and enhancing efficiency. Economic empowerment is one of the most powerful routes for women to achieve their potential and advance their standard of living (Akerela & Adekunmbi, 2018). Since women make up the majority of the world's poor, meeting poverty-reduction goals requires addressing women and their economic empowerment (Mustapha, 2022, Okafor, 2018). The economy of a nation suffers when a substantial part of the population cannot compete equitably or realize its full potential (Boyi, 2019). Women who are economically empowered contribute more to their families' well-being, societies' and national economies. Boyi, (2019) added that women invest extra income in their children and home, providing a route to sustainable development.

Standard of living refers to an individual's level of wealth, comfort, and access to essential resources with a socio-economic class. Standard of living includes factors such as income, quality and availability of employment, class disparity, poverty rate, quality and affordability of housing and shelter, good food and nutrition, quality healthcare and education. Standard of living can also be seen as the degree of wealth and material comfort available to a person, community or a country. To improve the standard of living of particularly law income earners, the Bank of Agriculture offered credit facilities to people who were mostly in co-operative societies.

Feeding is the act or process of eating and the act of giving food to a person or people. Food is any substance that is or can be consumed by living organisms, especially by eating, in order to sustain life. Food is the third most essential need for survival, providing energy and supporting development, maintain life, or stimulate growth after air and water. Food plays an important role in the promotion of health and disease prevention and generally consists of essential nutrients such as fat, carbohydrate, vitamins and minerals. Food is the primary need that man cannot do without and therefore needs food in order to achieve a healthy and productive life. Food needs needs to be provided adequately, in sufficient quality and quantity through food supply, (Otaha, 2013).

Besides, food and health have a strong relationship and the consumption of unwholesome food creates havoc to human. In Nigeria, according to Emmanuel & Adebayo, (2012) women play a central role in food production and a key role in food security. For example, in Nigeria, women account for approximately 70 per cent of agricultural workers and 80 per cent of food processors, therefore, increase in income of women cooperative societies have a proportional influence in the feeding of their families, (David, 2017).

The status of health is a strong indication of human development and can also serve as an indicator for poverty. Health is a state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity. According to World health organization (WHO, 2018) "Health is wealth" -given that in the absence of good health, an individual or society cannot attain its full potential. An improvement in one's standard of living automatically influences the person quality of healthcare.

Bank of Agriculture (BOA) was Nigeria's leading agricultural finance institution. The product bouquet of the Bank included savings mobilization and credit delivery products. Deposit products of the Bank were: Regular Savings Account (RSA) which was available to individuals, co-operatives, Self Help Groups (SHGs), partnerships, associations, business enterprises involved in small scale arable, livestock, poultry, fish farming and agro-allied business in rural and sub-urban areas. Liberty Savings Account [for women only] targeted individual women, women co-operatives, women in Self Help Groups and women entrepreneurs who were involved in farming, agro-allied business and retail trade. Credit products of Bank of Agriculture included the credits for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) and Agric-businesses.

Among the key mandates of Bank of Agriculture includes; capacity development through promotion of co-operatives, provision of opportunities for self-employment and creating opportunities for group to receive loan, most especially women members of Co-operative Societies. Similarly, Bank of Agriculture promoted credit as a human right. Loans were received in a continuous sequence, with new loans becoming available as previous loans were repaid. Loans were paid back in installments.

Statement of the Problem

In spite of the important role's women play in the family and society, many of them cannot afford basic necessities. This is despite government's policies and programmes to uplift their standard of living. It was observed during preliminary investigations in this study that the standard of women co-operatives in Kaduna states, had deteriorated which economic experts attribute to be as a result of the impact of global economic crises. Some of these women belonged to co-operative societies which had benefited from loans given by the Bank of Agriculture.

Literature has shown that a number of studies were carried out on co-operative women in other states of the country. Dada & Adefulu (2021) conducted research on co-operative credit facilities and members profitability in Romo division of Ogun State, Nigeria. The thrust of the study was to examine the effect of co-operative credit facilities on member's profitability in Romo division of Ogun State, Nigeria. Similarly, Ajah, Igiri & Ekpenyong (2017) carried out a study on the determinants of access to credit among rice farmers in Biase Local Government Area of Cross River State, Nigeria. Ademu, Aduku, Elesho & Nweke (2018) carried out a study on contributions of co-operative societies to development in Kogi State, Nigeria. None of these studies investigated the impact of Credit facilities on women's standard of living. Based on the above background, this study aims to determine the impact of credit facilities on standard of living of members of Women's cooperative societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria.

Purpose of the Study

The objectives of this study were to:

i. Determine the impact of credit facilities on the quality of feeding among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria.
ii. Determine the impact of credit facilities on the quality of healthcare among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria.

Research Questions

In line with the stated specific objectives the following research questions were formulated for the study:

i. What is the impact of credit facilities on the quality of feeding among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria?
ii. What is the impact of credit facilities on the quality of healthcare among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria?

Research Hypotheses

In the course of this study, the following null hypotheses were tested at 0.05 level of significance

i. Credit facilities do not have significant impact on the quality of feeding among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria.
ii. Credit facilities do not have significant impact on the quality of healthcare among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria.

Review of Related Literature

Over the years credit (credit facility, loan) has come to mean many different things to different people. For this reason and in order to avoid confusion, this study defines credit as the money from the lender to the borrower whether an individual, group or legal entity with the condition that it will be returned or paid at a later date sometimes with interest. According to Akerela and Adekunmbi (2018). Credit implies a promise by one party to pay another for money borrowed or goods and services received Ademu, Aduku, Elesho & Nweke (2018), the provision of credit with sufficient consideration for the sector's volume and price system is a way to generate self-employment opportunities. This is because credit helps to create and maintain a reasonable business size as it is used to establish and/or expand the business to take advantage of economy of scale. It can also be used to improve informal activity and increase its efficiency (Okafor. 2018).

The use of co-operative loans varies among member to at different time. This may also be determined by the focus, location and the funding of the co-operative. For example, a co-operative that enjoys regular external funding may provide loans for a longer period than a self-financed and member promoted cooperative. A study of two self-promoted and two programme-promoted cooperatives by Ariizal & Seswandi (2019) found that programme promoted co-operatives enjoyed support in the form of grants from donors and that most members used their loan for agricultural production (23.6%), animal husbandry (22.3%) and business investment (20.8%). Adekunle & Henson (2017) findings on loan use show that 64.17% was used for trade and investment, 4.62% on children's education, 8.46% for the purchase of business inputs while 6.03% was deployed for acquisition of assets. However, the results of the study would have been further strengthened if non-members had been included in the sample. This would have provided a better understanding of the impact of the co-operatives for comparison. The use of loans showed 46% for construction of houses, 31% for children's education and 23% for family use (Dickson, Sawhil & Jeffery, 2016). Rowland (2014) found the impact of co-operatives on the employment market to be positive, citing instances where co-operatives have been used successfully to establish small-scale industries, health care centers, poultry farms and food processing plants. Furthermore, the beneficiaries of cooperative loans used the funds for businesses such as petty trading or paying their children's school fees. A study by Akingunola & Onayemi (2010) among women entrepreneurs found that loans from informal finance were used for business expansion (31%), new business (28%), working capital (27.5%), building (5%) and consumption (8.5%). Oluyombo (2010) studied the impact of savings and credit co-operative loans among monthly income earners with the aid of questionnaires and reported that participation in co-operatives assisted them to purchase household equipment and properties.

Participants were also able to take advantage of the loan facility to engage in direct and indirect investment in business activities while still retaining their jobs. The study concluded that the programme had a positive impact on the social and economic wellbeing of the members.

The living standards of individuals in a society are said to be favourable when there is adequate consumption, high educational level, proper housing conditions, ample availability of food, friendly sanitary conditions, stable or non-restricted participation in the production system, free support in the systems of social joining and opportunity of taking after to a specific school of thought and qualities comparative or diverse to those that are held by whatever is left of the general public (Hermes & Lensink, 2021). Improvement of the living standards will be assessed by examining the influence of credit facilities on standard of living of Members of Women Co-operative Societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria. The access to basic necessities like food, clothing, shelter, quality health care and education will be used as the indicators of checking the quality of the living standards. The respondents will be asked about their personal thoughts on whether the quality of life has improved as a result of the credit facility intervention. Obasse, (2012).

Standard of living is the amount of goods and services actually consumed by an individual, household or community. This includes durable goods like cars, home appliances, consumer electronics, furniture, sports equipment and toys (Gudata, 2016) among others. It also includes non-durables like food items, cosmetics, fuel, beer, cigarettes, paper products, rubber, clothing and foot wear (Gudata, 2016). Also, expenditure in health, utilities and children education as well as ceremonies and social events are classified under level of living. A composite index was used to measure level of living that includes both quantitative and qualitative measures. Quantitative measure for level of living is by summing up the total value, in Naira, of all materials actually consumed in the household including physical assets possessed. Akinmu, Clement & Samaila (2018) view standard of living as effort to increase farmers output and to create employment opportunities and to reduce the fundamental cases of poverty, diseases and ignorance.

According to Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), (2013) and United Nations (UN) (2014), everyone has the right to a standard of living adequate for the health and well-being of themselves and of his family, including adequate food, clothing and housing, and to the continuous improvement of living conditions. The right to adequate housing. When a house lacks basic amenities, such as for cooking or storing food, the right to adequate food of its residents may be undermined. Also, when the cost of housing is too high, people may have to cut down on their food bill. The right to education, hunger and malnutrition impair children's learning abilities and may force them to drop out of school and work instead, thus undermining their enjoyment of the right to education. Moreover, to be free from hunger and malnutrition, individuals need to know how to maintain a nutritious diet and have the skills and capacity to produce or obtain food as a livelihood. Thus access to education, including vocational education, is essential for the enjoyment of the right to food.

Methodology

The research design adopted for this study was a longitudinal survey design. This method allows the researcher to look at changes over time. The population for this study was made up of all members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna State who benefitted from the credit facilities of Bank of Agriculture for the period of five years from 2013 to 2018. Bank of Agriculture Kaduna (175), Bank of Agriculture Ikara (185), Bank of Agriculture NDA (358), Bank of Agriculture Kafachan (197), and Bank of Agriculture Zaria (134), making a total of 1049. The entire population was used as sample for the study. Total Enumeration Sampling was thus adopted for this study. The decision to use the entire population of the study was purposive, because the population was not much. However, out of the 1049 sampled respondents 1044 were used, implying a mortality of five respondents and a data collection accuracy of over 98%. The study utilised an instrument designed by the researcher titled Women Co-operative Society Credit Facilities Questionnaire (WCSCFQ). The instrument had forty-five items which sought responses of respondents on the impact of credit facilities on their standard of living before and after benefiting from the credit facilities. Section A of the questionnaire (items 1-5) sought answers regarding the respondent's social data, (items 6-15) sought the economic details of the respondents, while section B sought answers on research questions one to five. (Items 16-23) answered research question one, (items 24-31) answered research question two, (items 31-37) answered research question three, (items 38-42) answered research question four while (items 43-45) answered research question five.

The researcher collected a letter of introduction from the Head, Department of Vocational and Technical Education, Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria, which was used to introduce the researcher to the respondents. The researcher employed the services of two research assistants who were trained by the researcher on how to administer and collect the completed copies of the questionnaire. The researcher administered the instrument in Zaria and Kaduna metropolis, while the two trained research enumerators administered one in Kafachan and the other in Ikara. The researcher together with the two research enumerators ensured the successful administration of the instruments. The respondents were contacted through their secretaries using their mobile numbers beforehand and a convenient time was agreed upon. This was to avoid any inconvenience on both sides which was done in one week.

The meeting point with the respondents was the Bank of Agriculture brach offices where the respondents collected the credit facilities. The researcher had developed a good relationship with the corporate planning department of Bank of Agriculture and the chair persons and their secretaries who agreed with the venue which made the work easier and faster. Three weeks were used for the data collection. The first one week was for making the necessary arrangement for the successful administration of the instruments; the second week was used by the researcher to administer instruments. Three days at the Kaduna branch and two days at the NDA branch. Similarly the two trained enumerators administered one in Kafachan and the other Ikara that same week respectively. The researcher administered to respondents in Zaria the third week. The exercise was tedious as the researcher and the research assistants had to explain where necessary. The data collected were

analyzed using frequency and percentage to describe the socio-economic and institutional characteristics of the respondents. Mean and standard deviation were used to answer the research questions. To answer the research questions, the means of items were obtained through a scale of 5 levels showing the perceived impact levels from 1-5 for very little (1), little (2), some (3), high (4), and very high (5). A composite of all related variables and items was put together and measured using a common index.

To test the null, a paired sample t-test was used. This was considered suitable for this research because it was used to compare a single population before and after credit facility. All the null hypotheses were tested at 0.05 level of significance. In the test of the null hypotheses, any null hypothesis that had a calculated p-value greater than the alpha p-value was retained.

Data Presentation

The two research questions were answered as follows

Research Question 1: What is the impact of Credit Facilities on quality of feeding among Members of Women Co-operative Societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria?

Table 1: Impact of credit facilities on quality of feeding among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria

*Items	Means (M) N= **1,044**		Differences (**Mean**)	Remarks (**Impact**)
	Before	After		
Affordability of nutritionally balanced diet	3.22 (2.73)	4.12 (1.23)	0.90	Positive
Ability to feed adequate quantity	3.28 (1.69)	4.53 (2.01)	1.25	Positive
Ability to feed regularly	3.44 (2.85)	4.11 (1.97)	0.57	Positive

Source: field work, 2023

Table 1, indicates that credit facilities had enabled the respondents afford nutritionally balanced diet (M=4.12, SD =1.23); adequate quantity of food (M=4.53, SD = 2.01} and regularly as required (M = 4.11, SD = 1.97).Also, the respondents reported that their feeding before obtaining the credit facilities was 3.22 (SD = 2.73), 3.28 (SD = 1.69) and 3.44 (SD = 2.85) for affordability of balanced diet, adequacy and regularity in feeding respectively. The mean differences for all the items indicate positive direction which could mean positive impact. Hence, responses imply that there is positive impact of the credit facilities as all the mean scores for the "after" credit intervention were greater than the "before" credit scores. Therefore, the research question is responded with concurrence among all the respondents of having good nutrition of balanced diet consumed in adequate quantity at regular interval required.

Research Question 2: What is the impact of credit facilities on quality of healthcare among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria?

Table 2: Impact of credit facilities on quality of healthcare among members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna State, Nigeria.

*Items	Means (M) N= **1,044**		Differences (**Mean**)	Remarks (**Impact**)
	Before	After		
Improved body health	2.32	3.89	1.57	
	(2.05)	(2.37)		Positive
Reduced sickness	2.67	3.53	0.86	
	(1.57)	(2.08)		Positive
Increased well-being	3.41	3.74	0.33	
	(3.11)	(2.18)		Positive

Source: field work, 2023

Table 2, showed improved health (M = 2.32; SD = 2.05), increased wellbeing (M = 2.67; SD = 1.57) and reduced sickness (M = 3.41; SD =3.11) before the intervention. On the other hand, the responses showed an improved body health (M = 3.89, SD = 2.37), increased well-being (M = 3.74, SD = 2.18) and reduced sickness (M = 3.53, SD =2.08) were found after the intervention of credit facilities to women co-operatives This shows a positive mean differences of 1.57, 1.07 and 0.12 respectively as the respondents' responses to the research question for impact of credit facilities on the healthcare among the members of women co-operative societies.

Test of Hypotheses

Results of test of the two null hypotheses were presented in Tables 3 to 4.

Hypothesis One: Credit facilities do not have significant impact on the quality of feeding of members of women cooperative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria.

To test this null hypothesis, impact of credit facilities on feeding of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria before and after were compared using the paired sample t-test analysis as studied in table 3.

Table 3: t-test analysis on impact of Credit facilities on quality of feeding of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria

Variables	N	Mean	STD	Mean Difference	Df	t computed	P
Quality of feeding Before	1044	86179.40	67243.32				
				103116.15	1043	48.446	0.000
Quality of feeding After	1044	189295.55	124309.55				

Source: field work, 2023 **P < 0.05, T computed > 1.96 at df 1043**

The outcome of the Paired sample t test comparison test showed that Credit facilities have a significant impact on the quality of feeding of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria. Reasons being that the computed p value of 0.000 is below the 0.05 alpha level of significance. The mean value of quality of feeding before and after credit facilities were 86179.40 and 189295.55 respectively. This shows that there is an increase of 103116.15 as a result of the credit facilities showing the positive impact of the credit facilities. Therefore the null hypothesis which state that Credit facilities does not have significant impact on the quality of feeding of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria, is thereby rejected.

Hypothesis Two: Credit facilities do not have significant impact on quality of healthcare of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria.

To test this null hypothesis, impact of Credit facilities on the type of healthcare of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria before and after benefiting the credit facilities were compared using the paired sample t-test analysis as studied in table 4**.**

Table 4: t-test analysis on impact of Credit facilities on the quality of healthcare of members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria

Variables	N	Mean	STD	Mean Difference	Df	t computed	P
Quality of Healthcare Before	1020	87175.28	80722.53				
				105350.82	1019	18.82	0..002
Quality of Healthcare After	1020	192526.11	197948.81				

Source: field work, 2023 **P < 0.05, T computed > 1.96 at df 1043**

The outcome of the Paired sample t-test showed that Credit facilities had a significant impact on the quality of Healthcare for members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria. Reasons

being that the computed p-value of 0.002 is below the 0.05 alpha level of significance. The mean value of Healthcare quality before and after credit facilities were 87175.28 and 192526.11 respectively. This indicating an increase of 105350.82 showing the positive impact of the credit facilities on Healthcare of members. Therefore the null hypothesis which states that Credit facilities do not have a significant impact on the quality of Healthcare for members of women co-operative societies in Kaduna state, Nigeria, is thereby rejected.

Discussion of Findings

From the above analysis, the following findings were derived:

The data analysis used to answer research question one and test of null hypothesis one revealed that Credit facilities improved the standard of living of the women (t=48.446, p=0.000) because quality of feeding of members of women co-operative societies was better after benefiting the credit facilities which is in line with Adebayo, Chinedum, Dado and Pascal (2010) who focused on the Impact of co-operatives on rural development and poverty reduction in Rwanda through observation and oral interview revealed that 23% used loan and improved their family feeding. Likewise, Tsehay and Mengistu (2012) started that over 94% of women that obtained credit facilities have improved their diet or the quality of food they consume. Noll (2014) started that income has a great effect on standard of living and as such influence positively the consumption pattern of the family. While Ekesionye and Okoli (2022) also reported that credit facilities given to women co-operative societies helps improv their feeding and their living condition.

The findings of research question two revealed that Credit facilities improved the standard of living of the women (t=18.82, p=0.002) because the quality of healthcare of members of women co-operative societies was better after benefiting credit facilities which is online with Ekesionye and Okoli (2022) and WHO (2018) who started that, empowering women promote family health and well-being because women contribute to their family development.

Conclusion

The findings of this research provide useful insights for the government agencies regarding the formula tion of policies and taking the appropriate measures toward designing strategies to improve access to credit facilities and the overall performance of participants in the cooperative industries. Therefore, credit facilities should be provided to members of co-operative societies especially women, by government and other financial institutions and the interest rate should be reduced if not illuminated, because credit facilities impacts standard of living significantly.

Recommendations

Deducing from the findings of this study, the following recommendations were drawn:

i. The Federal Government of Nigeria should put in more efforts to providing credit facilities especially to the women and constantly review to ensure that the purpose of the credit facilities is achieved.
ii. The sustenance of the credit facilities be intensified and supported by other financial houses as this have greatly improved the standard of living of the women who took the credit.

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EFFECTS OF GUIDED DISCOVERY AND DEMONSTRATION METHODS OF TEACHING ON ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE OF SECONDARY SCHOOL STUDENTS IN FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING IN BENUE STATE, NIGERIA

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Abstract
This study was prompted by consistent poor performance in recent senior secondary school certificate financial accounting examinations. The study sought to find the effects of Guided Discovery and Demonstration methods of teaching on the academic performance of secondary school students in Financial Accounting in Benue State, Nigeria. The study population comprised one thousand six hundred and sixteen (1,616) SS 2 STUDENTS (786 male and 830 female). The sample size was one hundred and forty-four (144) respondents comprised seventy-two (72) male and seventy-two (72) female. The study adopted pre-test and post-test. The study involved S.S 2 students in three intact classes of the three selected secondary schools in Benue State. Criterion and purposive sampling techniques were used to select the sample. The study had three objectives, three research questions and three hypotheses. Self-developed Financial Accounting Performance Test (FAPT) and Financial Accounting Evaluation Test (FAET) were the instruments used for data collection. The Mean and standard deviation were used to answer the research questions while t-test was used to test the hypotheses at 0.05 level of significance. The findings revealed that students performed better in financial accounting when guided discovery and demonstration methods of teaching were used than the lecture method. Based on the findings, it was recommended that through seminars, workshops and conferences, serving financial accounting teachers should be sensitized and encouraged to adopt guided discovery and demonstration methods in teaching financial accounting lessons more regularly.

***Keywords*: Financial Accounting, Guided Discovery method, Demonstration method, Academic Performance and Teaching**

Introduction

Benue State is one of the 36 States of the federation and is part of the North Central Geopolitical Zones of Nigeria. Benue state was created on February 3, 1976 from the former Benue-Plateau State. Benue State lies in the southern guinea savanna vegetation belt with a population of about 4,780,389 (National population Census, 2006). The State had 23 local government areas. Benue state has three educational zones – A, B and C. Schools in the zones offered financial accounting as one of the subjects in secondary school education programmes

Education is a bedrock for national development. Every society cherishes education of her children. Quality education is attained through effective teaching and effective teaching is actualized through adopting appropriate methods of teaching. Teaching entails giving instruction, imparting knowledge, facts, skills, attitudes, interests and aptitude. Teaching is the primary function of a teacher. A teacher in this regard, is expected to be a professional who consciously and deliberately utilizes his or her wealth of experiences, ideas, skills, competencies, attitudes, interest and mastery of the subject matter to facilitate learning in students.

Mkpa (2022) explained that method of teaching is the totality of all the strategies, techniques and ways that a teacher employs to maximize and facilitate classroom instruction. Methods of teaching are a means of conveying facts and decoding messages. Methods of teaching is the procedure, orderliness in planning and execution of teaching with appropriate integration of instructional materials to achieve the objectives at the classroom level. There are several methods of teaching to be employed in the teaching and learning process. Therefore, different methods can be applied during teaching and learning of financial accounting to enable students learn better.

Accounting is said to be the language of business. According to Flegm, in Ibrahim (2023), involves the measurement, disclosure or provision of assurance about financial information that helps managers, investors, tax authorities, and other decision makers make resources allocation decisions. Longe and Kazeem (2020) stated that accounting involves the process of recording, classifying, selecting, measuring, interpreting and communicating financial data of an organization to enable users make decision.

On the other hand, financial accounting is a specialized branch of accounting that keeps track of a company's financial transactions using standardized guidelines; the transactions are recorded, summarized, and presented in a financial report or financial statement such as an income statement or balance sheet. Financial accounting is the field of accounting that is concerned with the preparation of financial statements for decision-making. It is an aspect of business education programme offered at secondary school level of our educational system. Financial accounting enables an individual to acquire knowledge and marketable skills that would enable him or her to earn a living. It is used to prepare accounting information for people outside the organization, or for those who are not involved in the mundane administration of the company.

Financial accounting is important to modern society. It may be argued that the purpose of financial accounting is not to report the value of a company, but to provide enough information for others to assess the value of a company for themselves. Financial accounting is an aspect of education that all people, irrespective of job, discipline, or position, should have some knowledge of. Adamu (2020) argued that knowledge of financial accounting is required in every field of work. Secretaries use accounting skills to manage companies' petty cash, auditors study financial statements to evaluate the accuracy and integrity of businesses and executives judge the success of their businesses using the accounting information. However, experiences and studies over the years have shown that most

students generally regarded financial accounting as an abstract and difficult subject, science it is drawn from many other fields.

Academic performance has to do with how well students meet educational standards - aims, goals and objectives of education set for them at a particular time. Academic performance is defined as students' progress, understood as the level of learning, comprehension and consolidation of the school curriculum. It is how students deal with their academic programmes designed for them and how they cope with or accomplished different tasks. Academic performance is the outcome of education, the extent to which a student, teacher or institution has achieved their educational goals. This is corroborated by Nnaobi (2020) who maintained that performance in the teaching/learning process has to do with attainment of set objectives of instruction. In financial accounting for instance, if a learner accomplishes a task successfully and attains the specified goals for a particular learning experience, he is said to have achieved. In educational institution, success is measured by academic performance or how well a student's standards set by the institutions (Mamman, 2021). As career competition grows in the working world, the importance of students performing well in school has caught the attention of parents, legislators and government.

Guided-discovery method of teaching is a student-based exploration of an authentic problem using the process and tools of a discipline. It is a pedagogy that exposes students to various situations, questions, or tasks that allow students to "discover" for themselves the intended concept or material. Abdullahi (2020) maintained that guided-discovery method is a student-centered; activity-oriented teaching strategy. in which the teacher guides the students through problem-solving approach to discover answers to instructional topic at hand. Akinsete in Igboegwu (2022) defined guided-discovery as a method of teaching that encourages a student to solve problems by seeking and asking questions so as to gather information. Adeoye and Alayande, in Igboegwu (2022), reported that this method makes activities enjoyable, accessible and promote students' language and communication skills.

On the other hand, the demonstration method of teaching involves the teacher or a student showing activities in front of a class and explaining as he or she proceeds. Obeka (2019) viewed demonstration method as a method of teaching in which seeing rather than hearing, is the major means of communication. Demonstration method is a teaching strategy that involves experimentation. Nwachukwu and Nwosu, in Igboegwu (2022), stated that a demonstration can be carried out by 'the teacher for the students to observe and/or participate, or by students for both the teacher and other students to observe'.

Statement of the Problem

The poor performance of students in financial accounting is alarming and disturbing which calls for urgent attention of the teachers, curriculum planners and the education sector. The general public becomes upset due to the annual release of the West African Senior School Certificate Examination results as students' outcomes do not match up with the parental and governmental investment.

Udoh in Mamman (2021) confirmed this poor performance by remarking that in spite of the laudable objectives of financial accounting programme, students' performance at their final examination in the subject has been negatively skewed. The West African Examination Council (2020) observed areas of weakness in financial accounting from the scripts of candidates. These were:

a) The candidates displayed shallow knowledge of the subject which was evident in the monosyllabic answering of the questions
b) There was poor presentation of answer and that some candidates answered more than one question on one page
c) Candidates could not answer questions that required application and knowledge of financial accounting
d) Candidates performed very poorly on questions on documents used in trading and questions on shares and debentures
e) Candidates exhibited poor mastery of English Language which was evident in their inability to understand the questions.

In agreement with the above statement, Adamu (2021) stated that despite the importance of financial accounting to individuals and nations, a significant number of students could not cope with the challenges of skills and technicalities in it. He further posited that this has affected students' interest in the subject. The problem of massive failure in financial accounting has been an issue of discussion among accounting teachers, students and the society in general. Olowodun (2020) observed that financial accounting taught in Nigerian secondary schools is more of 'examination-oriented than life practical value-oriented', resulting in poor performance of students in examination.

The WAEC SSCE results from 2015-2022 in financial accounting showed the percentage of failures as 60.12%, 68.24%, 74.15%, 80%, 83.09%, 88.0%, 90.20% and 93% respectively. Data collected for the May/June 2009 to 2012 from WAEC office Makurdi by the present researchers revealed that the failure rate was 83%, 86%, 79% and 80% respectively.

Therefore, based on the foregoing, it is absolutely clear that there is a problem with the teaching-learning of financial accounting in our secondary schools. Meanwhile, what could be responsible for these problems? Could it be methodology? Could it be inadequate instructional facilities? Could it be poor attitude and interest of students toward the subject? Could it be incompetence on the part of teachers? It is against this background that the researchers are carrying out a research on the effects of guided-discovery and demonstration methods of teaching on academic performance of secondary school students in financial accounting in Benue State, Nigeria.

Purpose of the Study

The major objective of this study is to determine the effects of guided-discovery and demonstration methods of teaching on academic performance of secondary school students in financial accounting in Benue State. The specific objectives of this study are to:

1. Determine the difference between the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught using lecture method of teaching in Benue State
2. Assess the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using demonstration method of teaching and those taught using the lecture method in Benue State
3. Compare the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught using demonstration method of teaching in Benue State

Research Questions

In line with the objectives of the study, the following research questions were raised to guide the study.

1. What is the difference between the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught using lecture method in Benue State?
2. What is the difference between the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using demonstration method of teaching and those taught using lecture method in Benue State?
3. What is the difference between the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught with demonstration method of teaching in Benue State?

Research Hypotheses

In line with the research questions, the following null hypotheses were formulated to guide the study:

Ho_1: There is no significant difference in the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided discovery and those taught using lecture method of teaching in Benue State

Ho_2: There is no significant difference in the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using demonstration method of teaching and those taught using lecture method in Benue State

Ho_3: There is no significant difference in the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery and those taught using demonstration method of teaching in Benue State

Methodology

This study was a quasi-experimental research design. This design was adopted because intact classes were used. Pre-test and post-test non-equivalent control group were also used for the study. The population was one thousand six hundred and sixteen senior secondary two (SS2) financial accounting students. The sample size was 144 students representing 9.07% of the entire population. The state has three educational zones. The criteria and purposive sampling techniques were used to select three schools. The three selected schools were: Community Secondary School, Otukpa, Aliyu

Muhammed Jama Memorial Arabic College, Makurdi, and Government Secondary School, Abaji-Kpav. The detail is as shown below:

Table 1 Sample size

S/No	LGA/Name of Zone	Name of Schools	No. of Students		
			Male	Female	Total
	Zone A				
1.	**Katsina Ala**	**Govt. Sec. Sch.Abaji-Kpav**	**26**	**18**	**44**
	Zone B				
2.	**Makurdi**	**Aliyu Memo. Arabic College**	**21**	**24**	**45**
	Zone C				
3.	**Ogbadibo**	**Comm. Sec. Sch. Otukpa**	**25**	**30**	**55**
	TOTAL	**3**	**72**	**72**	**144**

Source: Benue State Teaching Service Board, Makurdi, 2023

The study adopted two instruments for data collection: Financial Accounting Performance Test (FAPT) which consisted of pre-test items and Financial Accounting Evaluation Test (FAET) which consisted of post- test items. The data collected were subjected to different statistical tests. Percentage were used to analyze the bio-data of the respondents. Mean and standard deviation were used to answer the research questions and a t-test was used to test the hypotheses at 0.05 level of significant.

Analysis of Bio-data of respondents

Table 2. Distribution of Respondents by School

S/No	Name of Schools	No. of Students		
		Male	Female	Total
1.	**Govt. Sec. Sch.Abaji-Kpav**	**26**	**18**	**44**
2.	**Aliyu Memo. Arabic College**	**21**	**24**	**45**
3.	**Comm. Sec. Sch. Otukpa**	**25**	**30**	**55**
TOTAL	**3**	**72**	**72**	**144**

Table 2 above revealed that three schools with a total number of 72 male and 72 female students participated in the exercise

Table 3 Distribution of Respondents by Methods of Teaching

Methods of teaching	Male	Female	Total	Percentage (%)
Lecture	24	24	48	33.3
Demonstration	24	24	48	33.3
Guided Discovery	24	24	48	33.3
Total	72	72	48	100

Table 3 above showed that 24 male and 24 female students with a total population of 48 respondents representing 33.3% of the respondents were taught using lecture method of teaching. The table further revealed that 24 male and 24 female students totaled 48 respondents representing 33.3% were taught using demonstration method of teaching while another 24 male and 24 female respondents were taught using guided-discovery method of teaching.

Research Question One:
What is the difference between the performance of school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught using lecture (teaching) method in Benue State?

The aim here was to determine the efficacy in terms of any significant difference between the performances of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught using the conventional lecture method. To provide an answer to this question, the mean performance scores of the two groups before and after the experiment were computed and compared. The mean scores of the two groups are shown in Table 4.

Table 4: Guided-discovery method of teaching and secondary school students' performance in financial accounting

			Post-test performance		Decision
Methods of Teaching	**N**	**df**	**Mean**	**Std. dev**	
Guided-discovery	48	46	70.56	17.41	Guided-discovery method had effect
Lecture	48	46	36.15	24.38	

Table 4.4 above revealed that students who were exposed to the guided-discovery method of teaching had a mean score of 70.56 ± 17.41 in the post-test, while their counterparts who were taught using the conventional lecture method had a mean score of 36.15 ± 24.38. This higher score of students in the experimental group clearly showed that the guided-discovery method of teaching had a greater effect on students' performance in financial accounting than the conventional method.

Research Question Two:
What is the difference between the performances of secondary school students taught financial accounting using demonstration method of teaching and those taught using lecture (teaching) method in Benue State?

The effect of the demonstration method of teaching on the performance of secondary school students was compared here with that of the conventional method of teaching to determine its efficacy in enhancing the academic performances of students. The performances of students taught with demonstration method and those taught with conventional lecture method after the treatment were computed and compared in Table 5

Table 5: Demonstration method of teaching and secondary school students' performance in financial accounting

			Post-test performance		Decision
Methods of Teaching	**N**	**df**	**Mean**	**Std. dev**	
Guided-discovery	48	46	57.19	22.97	Guided-discovery method had effect
Lecture	48	46	36.15	24.38	

Table 5 above revealed that students who were with demonstration method had mean score of 57.19±22.97 while those who were taught with conventional lecture (teaching) method of teaching had mean score of 36.15±24.38 after the experiment. This implied that the use of demonstration method of teaching had greatly improved the performances of the students.

Research Question Three:
What is the difference between the performances of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery method of teaching and those taught with demonstration method of teaching in Benue State?

The efficacies of the two experimental methods (guided discovery and demonstration method) used in the teaching of financial accounting were compared here to determine which one has an edge over the other in enhancing the students' academic performance in the subject. The performances before and after were compared, but only the post-test scores were used here for the decision, since this was the point at which their treatment was introduced in the experiment. The mean performances of the two groups were summarized in Table 6, along with their corresponding standard deviations and standard errors.

Table 6: Guided-discovery and demonstration methods of teaching and secondary school students' performance in financial accounting

			Post-test performance		Decision
Methods of Teaching	**N**	**df**	**Mean**	**Std. dev**	
Guided-discovery	48	46	70.56	17.41	Guided-discovery method had effect
Lecture	48	46	57.19	22.97	

Table 4.6 above revealed that the performances of students taught using guided-discovery method had mean score of 70.56±17.41 after the treatment while that of students exposed to demonstration method was 57. 19±22.97. Though the scores of both groups could be said to have improved greatly after the treatment but variability in the score of students exposed to guided discovery was higher. The post-test man scores clearly indicated that those exposed to guided-discovery were better and thus implying that guided-discovery could be more effective in enhancing performances of students in financial accounting in secondary schools.

Hypothesis One:
There is no significant difference between the performances of secondary school students taught financial accounting using guided-discovery and those thought using lecture method of teaching in Benue State.

This hypothesis was tested with data collected at the post-test level of the experiment from the two groups of students who were taught using the guided-discovery method and the conventional lecture method. The two-sample t-test procedure was used for the test because of the two independent groups (guided discovery and lecture (teaching) methods) involved in the test. The summary of the result was presented in Table 4.9.

Table 7: Effect of guided-discovery method of teaching on secondary school students' performance in financial accounting

Methods of Teaching	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Std. Error	t-value	DF	Pvalue
Guided-discovery	48	70.56	17.41	2.51	7.96	94	0.000
Lecture	48	36.15	24.38	3.52			

(t-critical at 94 degree of freedom and P = 0.05) = 1.99

Table 7 above revealed that students who were taught with the guided-discovery method had a higher mean score of 70.56, compared with the score of students taught with the lecture method, which was 36.15. From the observed t-value of 7.96 obtained at 94 degrees of freedom and the level of significance of 0.000 ($P < 0.05$), it could be concluded that students who were exposed to the guided-discovery method of teaching performed significantly higher than their counterparts who were taught with the lecture method. These observations provide enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. The null hypothesis, which states that there is no significant difference between the performance of secondary school students taught financial accounting using the guided-discovery method and those taught using the lecture method, was therefore rejected. The result revealed that the guided-discovery method of teaching would significantly improve students' performance in financial accounting compared to the conventional lecture method of teaching.

Hypothesis Two: There is no significant difference between the performances of secondary schools' students taught financial accounting using demonstration method of teaching and those taught using lecture (teaching) method in Benue State.
The performances of students taught with demonstration method and lecture method after the experimental were computed for this test. The two-sample t-test was used to compare the performances in order to determine the significance of the variability obtained in the performances of the experiment. The result of the, test was summarized in Table 4.10.

Table 8 Effect of demonstration method of teaching on secondary school students' performance in financial accounting

Methods of Teaching	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Std. Error	t-value	DF	Pvalue
Guided-discovery	48	57.19	22.97	3.32	4.35	94	0.000
Lecture	48	36.15	24.38	3.52			

(t-critical at 94 degree of freedom and P = 0.05) = 1.99

Table 8 above revealed that the students who were taught with demonstration method performed significantly better than their counterparts who were taught with conventional (lecture) method. This is indicated in the mean score of 57. 19 for demonstration method as against 36.15 by students taught with conventional method. The t-value (4.35) obtained in the test at 94 degree of freedom was higher than the equivalent critical value of 1.99. The observed significant level for the test is 0.000 ($P < 0.05$). With these observations, there is enough evidence to reject the null hypothesis. Therefore, the null hypothesis that there is no significant difference between the performances of secondary schools' students taught financial accounting using demonstration method of teaching and those taught using lecture (teaching) method was rejected.

Hypothesis Three: There is no significant difference between the performances of secondary School students taught financial accounting using guided discovery method of teaching and those taught using demonstration method of teaching in Benue State.

The performances of the two experimental groups exposed to guided-discovery and demonstration methods after the experiment were compared here to determine the method that is more efficacious in enhancing the performances of students in the teaching and learning of financial accounting. The two sample t-test procedure was used for the test because of the two independent groups (guided-discovery and demonstration). A summary of the test is presented in Table 9.

Table 9: Effect of Guided-discover and demonstration methods of teaching on male secondary school students' performance in financial accounting

Methods of Teaching	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Std. Error	t-value	DF	Pvalue
Guided-discovery	48	70.56	17.41	2.51	3.22	94	0.002
Lecture	48	57.19	22.97	3.32			

(t-critical at 94 degree of freedom and P = 0.05) = 1.99

Table 4.12 above indicated that students taught financial accounting with guided-discovery method differed significantly in their performances from those taught with demonstration method. The observed t-value (3.22) was higher than the critical value of 1989 and the observed level of significance (0.002) was lower than the fixed level of 0.05 ($P < 0.05$). These observations provide sufficient evidence to reject the null hypothesis. Therefore, the null hypothesis that there is no significant difference between the performances of secondary School students taught financial

accounting using guided discovery method of teaching and those taught using demonstration method of teaching was rejected.

Findings

The findings of this study revealed that:

1. The guided-discovery method of teaching had a significant effect on the academic performance of secondary school students in financial accounting in Benue State when compared with the lecture method.
2. The demonstration method of teaching had a significant effect on the performance of secondary school students in financial accounting in Benue State when compared with the lecture method.
3. The guided-discovery method of teaching had a more significant effect than the demonstration method of teaching on students' performance in financial accounting in Benue State.

Conclusion

Based on the findings of the study, the researchers concluded that students performed better in financial accounting when the guided-discovery and demonstration methods of teaching were used. The conventional lecture method was not as effective as the guided-discovery and demonstration methods.

Recommendations

Based on the findings from this study, the following recommendations were made:

1. The use of the guided-discovery method of teaching should be intensified in the teaching and learning of financial accounting in secondary schools through school inspection and supervision. This will engage students in problem-solving activities, critical thinking, and creative learning rather than rote learning.
2. The demonstration method of teaching should equally be adopted in the teaching of financial accounting in secondary schools because it improves students' performance.
3. The lecture method should be reduced or discouraged in the teaching of skill subjects like financial accounting in secondary schools because it does not improve students' performance.

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INFLUENCE OF PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND COLLABORATION MANAGEMENT STRATEGIES ON CAREER SUCCESS OF BUSINESS EDUCATORS IN COLLEGES OF EDUCATION SOUTH-WEST NIGERIA

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Abstract

This study examined the influence of professional development and collaboration management strategies on career success of business educators in colleges of education in Southwest Nigeria. Two purposes were raised from which two research questions were formulated to guide the study. The study adopted descriptive survey research design. The population of the study comprised one hundred and thirty-eight (138) business educators in Colleges of Education offering business education programme in Southwest, Nigeria. A seventeen item self-developed questionnaire was validated by two experts and used for data collection. Cronbach alpha was used to determine the reliability co-efficient value of 0.89. One hundred and thirty-five (135) business educators were used for the study. Mean and standard deviation were used to analyze the research questions. The findings of the study revealed that participation in professional development influenced business educators' career success in confidence and credibility, versatile with current trends and new development. Fostering collaboration influenced new ideas and expertise, working with teams and boost productivity of business educators. It was concluded that participation in professional development and the fostering of collaboration management strategies play a significant role in shaping business educators' career success in colleges of education in south-west Nigeria. The study further recommended among others that attending conferences, seminars and workshops enable business educators to network with professional experts in their field.

***Keywords*: Business Educator, Career Success, Collaboration, Professional Development and Strategies.**

Introduction

As soon as one engages in any career, it is expected that progress is made to enhance career success and advancement. A career may be seen as any occupation undertaken by an individual and pursued for a significant period of the person's life and with opportunities for progress. A career may be described as the sum total of decisions taken to direct one's educational, social, economic, political, and spiritual endeavours and reflecting one's unique personality, characteristics and basic life values. It can further be defined as a unit for measuring occupation or series of occupations. Meanwhile, it

must be stressed that a career is more than just a job, or work, or occupation, since it covers many things which include progress through life, growth and development in vocational and non-vocational areas of life (Geoffrey & Gidraph, 2021).

The essence of any career including business educator is to record progress from one level to another apart from earning a decent living and for the purpose of self-actualisation. Business educators are those who are professionally qualified to teach business education and allied courses in any tertiary institutions of learning running a programme in business education. It is noteworthy that those who have taken lecturing as their career at the tertiary level of education such as colleges of education are expected to manage their career in such a way that they advance from one position of higher salary, higher level of job title and higher level of job responsibilities, productivity and recognition to another. Zacher, Rudolph, Todorovic and Ammann (2019) maintained that academic staff are expected to proactively manage their career portfolio through continuous competency development such as participating in research and publications and attending conferences and paper presentations to enhance their value and marketability.

In order to manage one's career, an employee is expected to avoid stagnation in the work place and be able to adopt proper strategies. Strategy in this context is an action that employee takes to attain one or more of his/her goals. Strategy may also be seen as a direction set by an employee to achieve a desired result in the future. Hence Stobierski (2019) maintained that an employee wishing to move forward and not to be stagnated must use networking, mentorship, accept more responsibility, further education, participation in professional development and fostering collaboration. Education is a never-ending process. It doesn't stop after earning a degree and starting a career. Through studies, seminars, and conferences, professional progress can be facilitated by providing exercises, teaching new concepts, or demonstrating new abilities (Uchendu, 2015).

Professional development is a process of learning that continues throughout a person's working life (Boud & Hager, 2012; Becher, 2018). Continual training, including practical intervention, constitutes professional development (Mero-Jaffe & Altarac, 2020). Professional development refers to all training, certification and education that a worker needs to succeed in a chosen career. Professional development refers to continuing education and career training after a person has entered the workforce in order to help one develop new skills, stay up-to-date on current trends and advance in career. It is no secret that different jobs require different skills. Even if a worker currently has the necessary skills, he or she may need additional skills in the future. This may be obtainable through participation in a professional development programme. Conferences are great opportunities to learn from experts in one's field, networking with like-minded professionals, and have a good time. If an out-of-town conference is not possible, there are still many online conferences and webinars that professionals can register for. Through professional development, workers can learn these skills to become better, more efficient workers. Technologies and best practices are evolving and progressing in every industry, making it crucial for both new and experienced professionals to keep pace with current trends in development and updating their knowledge. This hands-on experience can be especially useful in learning new skills.

The Centre for Management Development (CMD) (2004) established by the Federal Government of Nigeria, maintained that employees may improve on their professional growth and success through participation in professional meetings, conferences and workshops, presenting papers at conferences, serving as officers, board members or committee members, as well as coordinating events sponsored by schools. This provides a useful analysis of the varying ways in which professional development at different stages of the teacher's life interacts with other factors to influence teacher's resilience and commitment to the profession. The Centre concluded that the provision of responsive and differentiated support to meet teachers' professional and personal learning needs at different times in their work and life can help counter declining commitment trajectories, enhancing the continuity of positive development of teachers' professional commitment. Role models for career advancement are successful and professional people who individuals want to emulate for their achievement and career success. Successful professional development, according to experts, is a critical component in bringing about significant changes in school capacity practices, lecturers' instructional strategies, and student learning (Zegwaard, 2019). According to Alfalah (2018), a workshop gathers academics, specialists, or ordinary people who come together to study, conceptualise or discuss a particular issue to discover solutions to the issues raised. The workshop is a short, well-organised programme for skill and knowledge development. Educators employ workshops as one of their professional development strategies, and it is expected that they will be able to perform robust rational analysis as a result.

To be a successful business education lecturer, attending conferences, seminars and workshops within or outside the college is one of the largest contributors to new information pertaining to their profession. It may be local or international conference. Actively pursuing professional development ensures that knowledge and skills stay relevant and up to date. It also allows business educator to be more aware of changing trends and directions in their profession. When collaboration is absent and employees work in isolation, little professional growth occurs.

Collaboration means working together with one or more people to complete a project or task or develop ideas or processes. In the workplace, collaboration occurs when two or more people work together towards a common goal that benefits the team or company. Workplace collaboration requires interpersonal skills, communication skills, knowledge sharing and strategy, and can also occur in a traditional office or between members of a virtual team. Working as a team not only drives greater productivity, but it also fosters healthy relationships between employees (Goman, 2019). Often, when employees work together they are more effective and efficient than those who attempt to manage the same projects alone. Successfully collaborating with co-workers can also increase workers' motivation and level of engagement at work. Additionally, sharing ideas and brainstorming is helpful for developing unique solutions to complex challenges (Conjourn & Sonsupap, 2024).

Success in life gives someone a sense of satisfaction, accomplishment, and most importantly fulfillment. Career success can be viewed as the positive personal and work-related outcomes that accrue from individuals' activities and experiences, and has typically been operationalized as either objective (extrinsic to the person) or subjective success (intrinsic to the person (Bagdadli &

Gianecchini, 2019). Career success has traditionally been defined as the accumulated positive job related and psychological outcomes resulting from one's work experiences. Career success is very important for every individual since it affects the individual in the sense of financial independence, maintain one's identity, being a role model to others and strengthen the confidence level of an individual.

Allen (2020) sees career success as a combination of achieving a reasonable level of financial stability while doing work one enjoys and then finding that one is also happy and fulfilled with one's life and career choices as well. If one loves his/her job but find that it doesn't lead to financial self-sufficiency, career success is diminished, and if one gets paid very well but lack joy or interest in one's chosen career field, career success is diminished. True career success requires that there is alignment between the two. People who experience meaningful career success recognize that money and titles aren't the whole of it. They know that they must also experience inner peace and joy for it to really matter. If one gets paid well and have a career that others dream of but the work causes one to become unhappy, unfulfilled and maybe even miserable, one certainly won't feel successful. If one is happy, fulfilled and delighted with one's chosen career but one finds that one is not able to afford the basic necessities of life, one certainly is not likely to feel successful either.

Business education programme is that aspect of vocational education programme that deals with the acquisition of practical skills by its recipients. Okeke and Nzekwe (2019) affirmed that business education is a skill drilling and acquisition course which is capable of making its students or recipients employable or self-employed on graduation in order to help facilitate economic activities in the country. According to National Commission for Colleges of Education (NCCE 2020), the objectives of business education are: to produce competent NCE graduates who will teach business subjects in our secondary schools and other related educational institutions, to produce competent NCE graduates will epitomize business spirit in the society. It also includes to produce competent NCE graduates who will commence the development of the desired revolution in vocational and entrepreneurial skills from the Primary through Secondary schools, to equip graduates with necessary competencies for a post-NCE degree programme in business education and to equip graduates with the right business competencies for a life of work in the office and for self-employment.

Business educators in colleges of education that are saddled with the responsibility to equip the students of the programme with functional and adequate knowledge, skills, attitudes and values that would enable them operate within their environment effectively and efficiently. They should be able to advance on the job with knowledge without being stagnated. Such workforce could engage in several career management strategies to succeed in their career in terms of participation in professional development and fostering collaboration. Hence, when business educators have specific career strategies that suit their needs, it will in turn assist them to enhance their career insight and be able to guide them towards success. Career success of business educators is usually viewed in terms of the level of seniority, promotions, salary, access to power and authority, job satisfaction and attainment of self-actualization with the college structure. Professional development and collaboration management strategies are fundamental in enhancing the skills of business educators

and contributing to their career success. Literatures have revealed that professional development and collaboration management strategies have been shown to enhance educators' effectiveness, job satisfaction, and career advancement. Educators who engage in continuous learning and collaboration often report higher levels of career satisfaction and improved teaching outcomes (Smith & Hodge, 2020).

Despite the recognized importance of these strategies, most of the literature on the influence of professional development and collaboration management strategies on career success are based on the employees of industrial world. Even in education industries, little has been done on professional development and collaboration management strategies especially as it concern business educators career success. Therefore, this study intends to fill the gap in literature by investigating the influence of professional development and collaboration management strategies on business educators career success in colleges of education, South-west Nigeria.

Purpose of the Study

The main purpose of this study was to determine the influence of professional development and collaboration management strategies on business educators' career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria. Specifically, the study determined to:

1. Assess the influence of professional development management strategy on business educators career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria.
2. Examine how collaboration management strategy influence business educators career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria.

Research Questions

The following research questions were raised to guide the study:

1. How does participation in professional development strategy influence business educators' career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria?
2. What is the influence of fostering collaboration strategy on business educators' career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria?

Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework of this study is based on Social Capital Theory propounded by Coleman James (1990). Coleman (1990) defined social capital as any aspect of social structure that creates value and facilitates the actions of the individuals within that social structure. Just as the creation of physical capital involves changes in materials so as to facilitate production, and human capital involves changes in an individual's skills and capabilities, social capital is created when the relations among people change in ways that facilitate instrumental action (Coleman, 1990). By building relationships with people both inside and outside the institution, business educators can access valuable information and social resources that, in turn, lead to superior job performance, higher internal and external visibility and marketability, and higher levels of career success.

Methodology

The descriptive survey research design was employed for this study. The population of the study was 138 business educators from eight public colleges of education in South West Nigeria (Lagos, Ogun, Ondo, Osun and Oyo states) that offer business education programme. This data was made available to the researcher from the office of the Heads of Department of Business Education in the respective institutions. As a result of the manageable size of business educators, the researcher made use of the entire population as sample. Therefore, there was no need for sampling hence a census. The instrument used for data collection for the study was a questionnaire developed by the researchers. The questionnaire was titled: 'Influence of Professional Development and Collaboration Management Strategies on Career Success of Business Educators' Questionnaire (IPDCMSCSBEQ). The questionnaire was segmented into three sections (A, B and C). Section A measured the demographic variables of the respondents such as the name of the institution, gender, work experience and marital status of the respondents. Section B contained eight (8) item statement that measured professional development that measured career success of business educators. Section C contained nine (9) item statements that measured fostering collaboration. Responses on the items of the questionnaire were measured on a 4-point rating scale of strongly agree (4), agree (3), disagree (2) and strongly disagree (1) respectively. The instrument was validated by two experts in order to ensure proper wordings as well as to determine its adequacy and appropriateness of the study. Cronbach Alpha statistical tool was used to determine its level of reliability which yielded an alpha value of 0.89. Data were collected using personal contact approach with the help of six research assistants drawn from eight colleges of education. Out of the 138 copies of the questionnaire administered to the business educators, 135 were completely filled and returned. The data collected were analyzed using mean and standard deviation for answering the two research questions. Based on the 4-point rating scale of the instrument, a criterion reference point of 2.50 was used as benchmark for decision making in answering the research questions. In that case, any item with mean value of 2.50 or above were interpreted as agreed while items with mean value of less than 2.50 were interpreted as disagreed as the case may be.

Results

Research Question One: How does participation in professional development management strategy influence business educators' career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria?

Table 1: Mean and standard deviation of the influence of participation in professional development strategy on career success of business educators'.

S/N	Item	N	Mean	SD	Remarks
1	Participation in professional development boosts my confidence and credibility.	135	3.45	0.54	Agreed
2	Participation in professional development makes me versatile with current trends and new development.	135	3.37	0.53	Agreed
3	Participation in professional development open my door to opportunities and accelerate career changes.	135	3.43	0.57	Agreed
4	Participation in professional development enhance my expansion and acquisition of knowledge.	135	3.41	0.58	Agreed
5	Participation in professional development helps to keeping my pace with technology, system and processes.	135	3.41	0.54	Agreed
6	Participation in professional development helps me in improving existing skill and in learning new ones.	135	3.43	0.54	Agreed
7	Participation in professional development prevent potential stagnation by maintaining and improving my skills.	135	3.41	0.54	Agreed
8	Professional development exposes me to new delivery methods, evaluation styles and record-keeping strategies.	135	3.46	0.54	Agreed
	Cluster Mean		**3.42**		**Agreed**

Note: SD (Standard Deviation), N (Sample Size)

The result in Table 1 shows that the respondents rated items one to eight as agreed with mean ratings ranging from 3.37 to 3.46 while the standard deviations also ranges from 0.54 to 0.58. The cluster mean recorded a mean of 3.42 which shows business educator who participated in professional development reported higher levels of career success in open door to opportunities and accelerate career changes, improving existing skills and learning new ones.

Research Question Two

What is the influence of fostering collaboration management strategy on business educators' career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria?

Table 2: Mean and standard deviation of the influence on fostering collaboration strategy on career success of business educators'.

S/N	Item	N	Mean	SD	Remarks
9	Fostering collaboration expose me to new ideas and expertise.	135	3.34	0.59	Agreed
10	Fostering collaboration assist in working with teams to help me be more effective in my duty.	135	3.30	0.56	Agreed
11	Fostering collaboration boost my productivity.	135	3.41	0.57	Agreed
12	Fostering collaboration enhance my familiarity with new communication methods and approaches.	135	3.38	0.55	Agreed
13	Working with teams help me to become a better leader.	135	3.53	0.54	Agreed
14	Fostering collaboration enhances my degree of job independence.	135	3.30	0.60	Agreed
15	Fostering collaboration assist me to gain a sense of achievement from my work.	135	3.45	0.53	Agreed
16	Through fostering collaboration, I am pleased to accomplish my task.	135	3.30	0.58	Agreed
17	Fostering collaboration makes me enjoy good relationships with my co-lecturers.		3.36	0.64	Agreed
	Cluster Mean		**3.37**		**Agreed**

Note: SD (Standard Deviation), N (Sample Size)

The result in Table 2 depicts the influence of fostering collaboration strategy on business educators' career success in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria. The respondents' rated items forty-four to fifty-two as agreed with mean ratings ranging from 3.30 to 3.53 while the standard deviations also range from 0.53 to 0.64. Based on the cluster mean of 3.37, the respondents expressed a high level of agreement that fostering collaboration influence new ideas and expertise, working with teams, productivity, better leader, a sense of achievement in work, accomplishing task and good relationships with their co-lecturers.

Discussion of Findings

The reason for this finding is subject to the fact that conference participants discuss modern skills and business challenges to reach consensus on a solution for a particular topic or technique with the help of experts in the field. The main advantage of a conference is that it encourages everyone's participation. Sharing ideas with people from different organisations encourages knowledge transfer and promotes a sense of renewed hope and inspiration among participants.

It was discovered in the findings of research question one that participation in professional development influenced business educators' career success (confidence and credibility, versatile with

current trends and new development, open doors to opportunities, expansion and acquisition of knowledge, keeping pace with technology, system and processes) in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria. The finding supports the study carried out by Musa (2016) who found that attending conferences allows lecturers to better demonstrate their professionalism, their understanding of the ongoing need for professional learning which enhances their job performance. The findings also corroborated that of Okemakinde, Adewuyi and Alabi (2013) who found that conferences provide learning environment that encourages participants to exchange experiences, ideas and practices from their own schools/colleges.

The rationale for this finding is subject to the fact that collaboration strategies often lead to the establishment of professional networks, which can be beneficial for career advancement, research opportunities, and sharing best practices across different institutions. Engaging in collaboration strategies can also lead to increased job satisfaction by fostering a supportive and enriching work environment.

Research question two findings indicated that fostering collaboration influenced business educators' career success (new ideas and expertise, working with teams, boost productivity, better leader, gain a sense of achievement in work, accomplishing task and enjoy good relationships with my co-lecturers) in colleges of education in South-West Nigeria. This finding supports that of Fullan (2009) who emphasized that this indirect capacity building component of change enhances ownership and motivation as well as is the most powerful because educators are learning from their colleagues. Fullan (2009) identified the leadership capacity of knowledge building as essential for producing successful change and describes it as the leader's ability to create collaborative environments where people of diverse backgrounds can come together to share information and learn together as well as apply learning to their contexts. Furthermore, the findings imply that fostering collaboration allow practitioners to collaborate in making decisions for change as well as for devising strategies for improving teaching and learning are amongst the most effective for producing successful change. The current study's findings are also consistent with Fiore, et al (2015) who affirmed that as the focus on research teams sharpens, questions are emerging about how research teams can maximize their effectiveness and experiences. Effectiveness can be considered in the context of the overall functioning of the team and its success in its ability to achieve major research accomplishments.

Conclusion

Conclusions drawn from the findings of this study are that participation in professional development and the fostering of collaboration management strategies play a significant role in shaping business educators' career success in colleges of education in south-west Nigeria. The findings also highlight that professional development serves as a cornerstone for continuous growth, equipping educators with the latest teaching methodologies, technological tools and industry knowledge. Moreover, collaboration allows business educators in colleges of education to share ideas, resources, and best practices, fostering an environment of collective problem-solving and innovation.

Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusion of the study, the following recommendations were made:

1. Professional development activities such as attending conferences, seminars and workshops enable business educators to network with experts in their field, exchange ideas and gain valuable insights that can further enhance their professional career success.
2. Business educators should have the mindset to grow beyond previous limit by their willingness to learn new skills and gain knowledge that can lead to improved job performance.

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STAKEHOLDERS' RELATIONSHIP AS A PREDICTOR OF PUBLIC SECONDARY SCHOOLS' EFFECTIVENESS IN OSUN STATE, NIGERIA

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Abstract

The study examined stakeholders' relationship as a predictor of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State, Nigeria. Descriptive research design of survey type was used. The population of the study consisted of 3,932 teachers in the entire 392 public secondary schools in Osun State, Nigeria. A total of 450 respondents made up the sample in the study. Stakeholders' Relationship Questionnaire (SRQ) and "Students' Academic Performance Proforma (SAPP) were used to collect data. Pearson Product-Moment Correlation Statistic was used to test the hypotheses. The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State, Nigeria. The study concluded that stakeholders' relationship plays a significant role in enhancing public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. It was recommended that stakeholders should always maintain friendly interaction among one another, in order to create mutual and enabling environment that would continually enhance school effectiveness.

Keywords: Stakeholders' Relationship, Parents, Teachers, Students, School Effectiveness

Introduction

Stakeholders occupy important position in the education system. In fact, it should be noted that for the goals of the educationaenterprises to be properly achieved, the stakeholders such as teachers, parents, students, managers, government and students have to operate on a cordial relationship. According to Sulyman (2020), stakeholders in education refer to a group of people who have specific and cogent roles to perform towards the educational success. In education industries, stakeholders include parents, students and management team operating within the schools, Old Students' Associations/Alumni, non-governmental organisations, industries, teaching and non-teaching staff and government. Salako (2018) stated that stakeholders in education are the pillars which determine its survival. Considering the importance of stakeholders, there is need for mutual relationship among them to enhance school effectiveness. Ndifon et al. (2021) elucidated that stakeholders are individuals or institutions that have important roles to play in the implementation of school curriculum. These stakeholders include the government, school administrators, teachers, parents, students, corporate organisations and the likes. However, it is important that these stakeholders mutually interact, in order to share ideas on how to ensure effectiveness of schools. Duke and Gansneder (2020) believed that relationship among the stakeholders in education is very important for the purpose of achieving success in instructional policies and school discipline, resolving learning problems; and administrative issues such as setting school goals, recruitment of staff, allocation of

budget and evaluation of teachers. It is through this relationship that school effectiveness could be realised. Van Beck (2021) maintained that smooth relationship among the stakeholders in education could bring about adequate provision of funds to support students and development of meaningful relationships between and among one another, thereby fostering school effectiveness

Tyagi (2019) elucidated that school effectiveness refers to the extent to which a school has realised its stated goals. That is the extent to which a school has achieved appreciable students' academic performance over a period of time. Zwalchir (2018) maintained that attainment of school effectiveness could be determined by the kind of relationship among the stakeholders in education. Osuji (2016) believed that effectiveness of school could be based on staff and students' discipline, climate, mutual relationship among school members, students' academic performance and the likes. Kenayathulla and Hoque (2021) stated that an effective school is the one that promotes the progress of its learners in intellectual, social and emotional outcomes. Akay and Akpay (2016) stated that effective schools are the ones which achieve higher than expected in academic subjects and in personal and social development of the students. In this study, the stakeholders' relationship considered were principal-teacher relationship, parent-teacher relationship, and teacher-student relationship.

According to Wilfred (2022), office of the principal is essential to the accomplishment of secondary school goals in Nigeria. As such, the school principal needs to always maintain a good relationship with his or her teachers, for the school goals to be achieved. Stanly (2016) asserted that no matter the adequacy of educational resources such as qualified teachers, laboratories, tables and chairs, textbooks, internet facility, classrooms, library and computers provided in a school; if the principal is deficient in building mutual relationship with teachers, actualization of school effectiveness might not be achieved. Michael (2020) believed that one of the factors responsible for the poor effectiveness in public secondary schools in Nigeria could be poor relationship between principals and teachers. Vinackle (2020) stated that if there is a peaceful relationship between the principal and the teachers in a school, the first would find it easy involving the latter in the process of making decisions for school. This is a way by which principals can motivate teachers towards effective performance of their job in a way which would lead to actualisation of school effectiveness.

According to Ukeje et al. (2019), parent-teacher relationship brings about fruitful interaction between parents or guardians of children and teachers and this goes a long way in enhancing school effectiveness. Wilfred (2022) maintained that through parent-teacher relationship, parents are able to have meaningful participation in the management of schools, thereby bringing about positive contribution or influence towards enhancing effective management, necessary for achieving the school effectiveness. Marzano (2018) stated that the relationship between parents and teachers is very vital to the achievement of school goal in transmuting students to productive citizens that would explore their talents, knowledge and skills to sustain themselves; and help other members in the society to become productive and contribute their quota towards the development of the society. Bacolod and Tantiado (2022) maintained that shared responsibility in students' education via collaboration of purpose between parents and teachers would help in achieving an inclusive goal of

helping students to succeed in school academically. Adewale (2018) believed that teachers and parents are important stakeholders in education. Therefore, the nature of relationship which exists between the two stakeholders could determine school effectiveness.

Abiola (2021) stressed that teacher-student relationship refers a mutual interaction between teachers and students. This is very important because frosty relationship between teachers and students would not help enhance school effectiveness. Dada (2021) asserted that students who have positive relationship with their teachers use them as a secure base from which they can explore in the classroom and improve themselves academically. Conversely, poor relationship between teachers and students could hinder school progress in teaching and learning. Gabriel (2022) opined that improved students' relationship with teachers is an essential support for learning and it has important implications on students' academic development which is a measure of school effectiveness. Salako (2018) posited that if a student feels a personal connection to a teacher, the student is likely to develop a great interest in what the teacher teaches, thereby enhancing school effectiveness. Duke and Gansneder (2020) stated that students and teachers need to appreciate each other so as to maintain smooth relationship which would make the process of teaching and learning a funfair for students to easily gain in classroom and perform excellently.

Statement of the Problem

Ineffectiveness of the public secondary schools in Osun State in terms of poor students' academic performance has been a great concern to the stakeholders in the education sector such as parents, members of the public and the government. According to Tyagi, (2019), Nigerian public secondary schools have been characterized with ineffectiveness (poor students' academic performance) and this could be due to some factors, among which is associated with the stakeholders such as principals, teachers, parents, government and students. Dada (2021) asserted that poor students' academic performance in Senior School Certificate Examinations in Nigeria is a justification for ineffectiveness of secondary schools in the country.

Some scholars had worked on the variables related to this study. For instance, Kalagbor (2015) carried out a study on the analysis of factors influencing students' academic performance in public and private secondary schools in Rivers State-Nigeria. Akinsolu (2020) conducted a study on teachers and students' academic performance in Nigerian secondary schools: Implications for planning. Dada (2021) examined teacher-student relationship and school effectiveness in secondary schools in Plateau State, Nigeria. Hassan, et al. Bakari (2021) examined the influence of principal and parental relationships on teachers' job performance in senior secondary schools in Adamawa State, Nigeria. However, none of these previous studies focused on stakeholders' relationship as a predictor of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State, Nigeria; hence, this study filled the gap.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of the study were to:

i. Examine the relationship between stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State;

ii. Determine the relationship between principal-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State;
iii. Assess the relationship between parent-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State; a
iv. Investigate the relationship between teacher-student relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Research Hypotheses

The following hypotheses were formulated to guide the study.

Ho_1: There is no significant relationship between stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Ho_2: There is no significant relationship between principal-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Ho_3: There is no significant relationship between parent-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Ho_4: There is no significant relationship between teacher-student relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Methodology

Descriptive research design of survey type was adopted for the study. Manjunatha (2016) saw descriptive research as the type of research which gives description of the characteristics of a phenomenon of population that is being studied. The description could be done via the use of questionnaire or other means for data collection. The researchers used this research design for this study because it described the situation of stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Kwara State. The population of the study consisted of 3,932 teachers in the entire 392 public secondary schools in Osun State, Nigeria. There were 10 local government areas in each of the senatorial districts in the state. Random sampling technique was used to select three local government areas from each of the three senatorial districts in the state to make a total of nine used for the study.Five public secondary schools were randomly selected from each of the local government areas to make a total of 45 schools while 10 teachers were randomly selected from each of the sampled schools to make a total of 450 respondents

The study used researcher-designed questionnaire titled "Stakeholders' Relationship Questionnaire" (SRQ) and "Students' Academic Performance Proforma" (SAPP) to collect data for the study. SRQ was used to collect information on stakeholders' relationship in the areas of teacher-student relationship, parent-teacher relationship and principal-teacher relationship while SAPP was used to collect students' results in Mathematics and English language in WASSCE from 2020 to 2023. Validity of the instrument was ensured by presenting its draft to three experts in the field of Educational Management and Test and Measurement. Reliability of the instrument was carried out and analysis of the collected data through Cronbach's Alpha yielded coefficient of 0.82. The high coefficient value of 0.82 signifies that the instrument was reliable and could be used for the study. Out of the 450 copies of the questionnaire distributed, only the 427 returned were used for analysis.

The researchers used four research assistants during the process of data collection from the participants. All the research assistants were given adequate training on how to approach the school principals for data collection. The researchers and the research assistants visited the different sampled schools. A copy of SRQ administered to each participant was collected back immediately after filling. Copies of SAPP were given to the school principals to supply students' academic performance. The principals were implored to get it ready not later than two weeks and they all complied. Pearson Product-Moment Correlation Statistic was used to test the hypotheses.

Results

Hypothesis One: *There is no significant relationship between stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.*

Table 1: *Stakeholders' Relationship and Public Secondary Schools' Effectiveness in Osun State*

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Cal. r-value	p-value	Decision
Stakeholders' relationship	427	2.86	1.30	.611	.002	Ho_1 Rejected
School Effectiveness	427	2.62	1.05			

Table 1 shows the calculated r-value (.611) while the p-value (.002) is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis one is rejected. This shows that there was a significant relationship between stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Hypothesis Two: *There is no significant relationship between principal-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State,*

Table 2: *Principal-teacher Relationship and Public Secondary Schools' Effectiveness in Osun State*

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Cal. r-value	p-value	Decision
Principal-teacher relationship	427	2.96	1.38	.589	.004	Ho_2 Rejected
School Effectiveness	427	2.62	1.05			

Table 2 shows the calculated r-value (.589) while the p-value (.004) is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis two is rejected. This shows that there was a significant relationship between parent-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Hypothesis Three: *There is no significant relationship between parent-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.*

Table 3: *Parent-teacher Relationship and Public Secondary Schools' Effectiveness in Osun State*

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Cal. r-value	p-value	Decision
Parent-teacher relationship	427	3.22	1.41			
				.620	.021	Ho_3 Rejected
School Effectiveness	427	2.62	1.05			

Table 3 shows the calculated r-value (.620) while the p-value (.021) is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis three is rejected. This depicts that there was a significant relationship between parent-teacher relationship and parent-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Hypothesis Four: *There is no significant relationship between teacher-student relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State*

Table 4: *Teacher-student Relationship and Public Secondary Schools' Effectiveness in Osun State*

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Cal. r-value	p-value	Decision
Teacher-student relationship	427	2.39	1.11			
				.677	.011	Ho_4 Rejected
School Effectiveness	427	2.62	1.05			

Table 4 shows the calculated r-value (.677) while the p-value (.011) is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis four is rejected. This means that there was a significant relationship between teacher-student relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State.

Discussions

The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between stakeholders' relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. This finding supports the finding of Gabriel (2022) which revealed that there was a significant relationship between

stakeholders' relationship and school effectiveness in secondary schools in Kano State, Nigeria. This finding agrees with the submission of Duke and Gansneder (2020) that cordial relationship among the stakeholders in education is very important. If the stakeholders are cordially relating, it would create different opportunities for the school and this would go a long way in enhancing effectiveness.

The findings of the study showed that there was a significant relationship between principal-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. This finding corroborates the finding of Abiola (2021) which revealed that there was a significant relationship between principal-teacher relationship and school effectiveness in secondary schools in Lagos State. This finding is also in line with the position of Wilfred (2022) that office of principal is very key to the realisation of secondary school goals. As such, a school with the principal without a strong relationship with teachers might not be able to achieve much effectiveness.

The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between parent-teacher relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. This finding is in consonance with the finding of Abiola (2021) which revealed that there was a significant relationship between parent-teacher relationship and school effectiveness in secondary schools in Lagos State. In addition, this finding is in tandem with the position of Monday (2020) that the essence of parent-teacher relationship is for providing a platform for parents or guardians and teachers to discuss issues affecting students and other aspects of school, in order to achieve effectiveness.

The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between teacher-student relationship and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. This reveals that if there is a mutual relationship between teachers and students, it would help facilitate realization of school effectiveness. This finding agrees with the finding of Egbokhan (2016) that there was a significant positive relationship between teacher-student relationship and school effectiveness in Lagelu Local Government, Oyo State. This finding corroborates the finding of Dada (2021) which revealed that there was significant relationship between teacher-student relationship and school effectiveness in secondary schools in Plateau State, Nigeria.

Conclusion

Based on the findings of the study, it was concluded that stakeholders' relationship plays a significant role in enhancing public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. Principal-teacher relationship helps to achieve public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. Parent-teacher relationship is a great tool enhancing public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State. Smooth relationship between teacher and students assists in actualising public secondary schools' effectiveness in Osun State, Nigeria.

Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusion of the study, it was recommended that:

i. Principals, teachers, students and parents should always maintain friendly interaction among one another, in order to create mutual and enabling environment that would continually enhance school effectiveness;
ii. Principals should always ensure that healthy relationship exists between the teachers and them, so as to give teachers high level of motivation to contribute to the actualisation of school effectiveness;
iii. Parents and teachers should persistently operate in a mutual atmosphere which would make them build a sustainable synergy on the care of students, in order to help the schools to actualise effectiveness.
iv. Teachers should always maintain mutual relationship with students, so as to make students develop good feeling for them, thereby enhancing their seriousness which would facilitate actualisation of school effectiveness.

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PRINCIPALS' ADMINISTRATIVE TASK PERFORMANCE AND PUBLIC SECONDARY SCHOOLS' EFFECTIVENESS IN EDO STATE

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Abstract
The study investigated principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo state. Three research questions were raised; two were answered, while one was formulated into hypotheses and tested at 0.05 level of significance. This study was a descriptive research of correlational type. The population of the study comprises of all the three hundred and nine (309) principals from the three hundred and nine (309) public senior secondary schools in Edo State. A multi-stage sampling technique was used to select a sample of two hundred and sixteen (216) principals using the stratified sampling technique in the first stage and the simple random sampling technique in the subsequent stages. A questionnaire titled: "Principals' Administrative Task Performance and Schools' Effectiveness Questionnaire (PATPSEQ)" validated with a reliability coefficient of 0.81 was used to collect data from the respondents. The research questions were analysed using mean and standard deviation while hypothesis was tested using Pearson Product Moment Correlation Coefficient at 0.05 level of significance. The findings from the analysis of the study revealed that the level of principals' administrative task performance and the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State is moderate and there is a positive and significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State. Based on the findings, the study recommended that the principals in public secondary schools in Edo state should be proactive, timely and dynamic in performing their administrative tasks to improve the school's effectiveness in the state.
***Keywords*:** Principals, Administrative Task, Performance, Schools' Effectiveness, Public secondary schools

Introduction

Secondary school education is essential for achieving the national educational objectives in Nigeria. It is the second level of education in Nigeria and serves as both the apex of Nigeria's basic education and as a bridge between primary and tertiary education in the Nigerian educational system (Ibukun, 2004). Stating the goals of secondary education in Nigeria, Owojori and Asaolu (2010) make it understandable that the potential of a nation depends on the quality of education it provides for its citizens. One of the ways of accomplishing this national educational objective of secondary schools is in the ways and manner in which the principal manages and coordinates the activities in the secondary school

The principal is a manager, an administrator, an exemplary leader, a counsellor, a public relations officer, a bridge builder, and even a messenger (Murphy, 2002). The nomenclature, principal, is also unisexual. It could refer to male or female. He/she is central in the administration of secondary school and a major determinant in the realization of the aims of secondary school education (Pounder, 2006). According to Akomolafe (2012), an effective principal boosts academic achievement for all students, increases the effectiveness of his/her teaching staff, and consistently takes administrative or leadership actions known to improve outcomes for students. Principals are the core of secondary school administration in Nigeria. They are the chief executives vested with the responsibility of the everyday running of secondary schools. The principals execute the educational programmes in secondary schools, keep records of school events, and provide a conducive teaching and learning environment in schools (Ogbonnaya, 2004). The growth rate of the school is dependent on how the principal carries out his administrative tasks in terms of performance

The administrator's tasks performance are the activities carried out by the principals. The educational administrative tasks and functions include policy implementation, programme planning, human resource management, pupil personnel management, facilities maintenance, procurement management, school plant management, finance management and records management. The administrative tasks of the principal also include directing the teachers and students in an environment conducive to the maximum development of the learners. Therefore, the principal being the administrator of the school is expected to work hard to achieve the goals with the use of his knowledge and wisdom. The role of the principal as the administrative head is crucial to his success as he is saddled with the responsibility to motivate, inspire, stimulate and influence the actions, reactions, behaviours, beliefs and attitudes of those he is leading to build staff and students in such a way that relationship among one person influences the behaviour or actions of others.

Another daunting administrative task of the principal is being the accounting officer responsible for all revenue and expenditure; they should be conversant with school accounting and bookkeeping procedures and practices. This helps them to supervise and control the work of the bursar or the accounts clerk while managing the school finances and accounts. Principals are also expected to manage and maintain pupil and personnel discipline and welfare. The principal maintains and improves the buildings and environment as well as the pupils' classrooms, therefore providing a conducive environment for learners to study. Akpakwu (2012) succinctly placed the administrative tasks of school heads under the broad categories of instructional supervision, student personnel, staff personnel, school-community relationship, and school plant management.

Instructional supervision is the process of overseeing, monitoring, guiding, checking, directing, and evaluating one or more aspects of a school to provide support services and improve activities of the teachers and other staff personnel in the school towards the achievement of educational objectives. According to Ada (2014), instructional supervision involves an internal mechanism adopted by the principal for self-evaluation, geared towards helping teachers and students to improve on their teaching and learning activities for the purpose of achieving educational objectives. Instructional supervision is aimed at improving teacher performance, instructional quality, and student outcomes.

It involves supervising and supporting teachers in their instructional practices, providing feedback, guidance, and resources to enhance their teaching skills.

Student personnel refer to services rendered to pupils and all the records of the various activities carried out by the pupil in the school. These include providing guidance and counselling services, instituting procedures for the orientation of pupils, establishing school attendance policy and procedures and maintaining a system of child accounting, establishing policies and procedures for dealing with pupils' irregularities (conduct problems), establishing policy and procedures regarding pupil safety in the building and school premises, developing and coordinating the extracurricular programme, handling disciplinary cases, developing systematic procedures for the continuous assessment and comprehensive reporting of student achievements., providing health services and providing for individual pupil inventory services.

Staff personnel refers to services rendered to staff and all the records of the various activities carried out by the staff in the school. These include helping to formulate staff personnel policies, recruiting staff personnel, selecting and assigning staff personnel, scheduling teachers' assignments, communicating the objectives of the school programme to the school, observing teachers in their classroom, diagnosing the strengths and weaknesses of teachers, assisting teachers in resolving classroom issues and evaluating their performance, improving the performance of teachers, coordinating the work of teachers, encouraging and creating opportunities for the professional development of staff members, maximising the different skills found in the school, developing 'esprit de corps among teachers and developing a system of staff personnel records amongst others.

School-community relations management deals with how the head teacher manages the relationships between the school and the community (Mgbodile, 2004). A school-community relationship is a series of pined activities and media through which the schools seek to learn about the community, inform the community about and interpret, when necessary, the purposes, programmes, problems and evaluating school policies and progress (Bortner, 2019). It is a mutual interaction between the school and the community whereby they gain mutual help and understanding from each other as well as being fully aware of one another’s activities, policies, plans, programmes, problems, progress and failures (Afolabi, 1998). School and community relationship refers to services rendered to parents of pupils and the community where a school is located and all the records of these various activities as carried out by the staff in the school. These include developing and administering policies and procedures for parents and community participation in school matters, conferring with parents, handling parental complaints, representing the school by participating in community organisations, cooperating with other community agencies, facilitating the ongoing review of acceptable plans and policies for community improvement, particularly concerning the services provided by schools, and aiding in the development and implementation of plans that enhance community life.

School plant management deals with how the school facilities namely: the school site, the buildings, the playground, the equipment and other material resources provided in the school are managed for effective teaching and learning. The school plant refers to the school site, the buildings, the

playground, the equipment and other material resources provided in the school for effective teaching and learning (Onuorah, 2004). Similarly, Mgbodile (2004) described the school plant as the space interpretation of the school curriculum. For Engman (2008) the school plants are basically educational facilities. Against this background, Osahn in Onwurah (2004) grouped the educational facilities (school plant) into various types. These are: School building, equipment and school records/books, among others. According to Obi (2004), Educational facilities are necessary tools in the school for effective teaching and learning. As noted by Mgbodile (2004), school plants are needed for developing the cognitive areas of knowledge, abilities and skills which are needed for academic achievement. In view of this, Ezugwu (2004) argued that properly designed and fully utilized school plant with wide array of teaching aids provide effective delivery of school's curriculum are positively related to academic achievement. School principals have the responsibility to ensure that school facilities are well maintained and serve their intended purpose.

Principals have targets to meet in exercising their administrative tasks to achieve effectiveness and efficiency in teaching and learning processes to produce dynamic, vibrant, knowledgeable, creative and skilled manpower that will be able to use the knowledge gained for service delivery within the society and the world at large. Hence principals ensure that subject teachers give the students assignments to do in their various classrooms during school hours and also give them a take-home assignment as a follow-up to the one carried out in the classrooms regularly. In addition to this, lesson notes, lesson plans as well as textbooks used by the teachers, subject diaries, and class registers, are thoroughly checked by the principal to ensure compliance by the teachers to avoid compromising the school standards and ultimately culminating in school effectiveness.

School effectiveness refers to the degree to which schools carry out their primary assignments of teaching and learning successfully without disruption and how such schools can attain their short- and long-term objectives. Schools' effectiveness can be seen as the extent to which the set goals and objectives of the school programs are actualized. A school is considered effective if there is a level of consistency of recorded progress among the students over a period of time. School effectiveness includes the time, opportunity to learn and a structured approach to teaching that involves frequent monitoring of student's progress in the classroom and supportive educational leadership. Adewale (2004) highlighted the indices of school effectiveness as instructional leadership provided by the principal, curriculum learning objectives, learning activities and achievement measures. These indices could be succinctly discussed as quality leadership, efficiency, accountability and productivity.

Leadership plays a crucial role in the effectiveness of schools and serves as a key indicator of their overall success and performance. In this context, leadership refers to a school leader's ability to influence and guide teachers and students in achieving established educational goals. Teachers tend to perform better when supported by strong leadership, as it motivates and equips them to fulfil their responsibilities. Similarly, students thrive when their principal and school board members demonstrate effective leadership. Key aspects of effective school leadership include establishing a clear and compelling vision and mission for the school, setting specific, measurable, achievable,

relevant, and time-bound (SMART) goals, prioritizing instructional leadership and valuing staff input, fostering a positive school culture and managing resources efficiently. Effective leaders also build partnerships with parents and the community, make informed decisions, and demonstrate accountability by leading by example.

Efficiency refers to the ability of a school to achieve its educational goals through the most effective and economical use of its resources. Efficiency in a school setting encompasses the ability of an institution to successfully achieve its educational objectives through the most optimal and prudent use of its available resources. This concept is not just a measure of how well a school operates but also reflects a commitment to fostering an enriching educational experience for every student. To assess school efficiency, we can examine a variety of indicators. For instance, students' achievements serve as a critical benchmark, showcasing how effectively the school supports learning and growth. Resource allocation is another vital aspect; schools must carefully distribute their funding, materials, and staff to meet the diverse needs of students. Class size also plays a significant role—smaller classes often allow for more personalized attention and support. Additionally, tracking repetition rates can provide insight into how well students grasp their coursework, while dropout rates highlight the need for engaging and supportive learning environments. Finally, the condition and availability of teaching facilities and infrastructure—such as classrooms, libraries, and technology—directly impact the learning experience. Overall, prioritizing efficiency in schools ensures that limited resources are put to their best use, ultimately striving to create the most effective educational landscape for all students.

Accountability refers to the responsibility given to educational institutions to provide high-quality education to their students and meet certain educational expectations. It is a means by which policymakers at the state and district levels, parents and taxpayers monitor the performance of students and schools. Accountability involves administrators, teachers and students taking account of their progress. Accountability brings about school effectiveness through the following ways: monitoring and examining students' achievements, high attendance and graduation rates, focus on teacher quality and positive learning environment, parent and community involvement, good management of resources and overall improvement.

Productivity in education is often taken to mean using the inputs and processes of schooling in ways that increase desired outcomes. It is a measure of how efficiently a school makes use of its resources to achieve desired educational goals. A school is said to be productive when the communication between students, teachers, and the principal is very clear. A productive school will have high levels of student achievement measured by standardised tests, promotion, and graduation rates. Such a school is said to be effective, while a school with a low student achievement rate is said to be ineffective.

It must therefore be pointed out that the effectiveness of secondary schools is crucial in the realization of secondary school goals and objectives as stipulated in the National Policy on Education. A nation can fulfill its diverse educational goals only when the aims of secondary education are achieved,

which consequently relies on how effectively principals perform their administrative duties within the secondary education framework. It is on this premise that this study was carried out to investigate the influence of principals' administrative task performance on schools' effectiveness in public secondary schools in Edo State

Statement of the Problem

The administration of secondary schools in Nigeria has become increasingly more complex as a result of an increase in student enrolment, the advent of modern technology, expanded curriculum, insecurity, and global health challenges, among others. In Edo State, this has evoked public concern about the performance of secondary school principals in discharging their administrative tasks. It has also been observed in recent times that most secondary schools in Edo state are characterized by poor attitude of teachers to work, high rate of teachers' absenteeism, truancy, indiscipline among teachers and students and lateness to school by both the staff and students in secondary school which suggest poor administrative task performance by the principals.

Other visible challenges appear to be improper handling of parental complaints and lack of cooperation with other community agencies, inability to keep the school office running smoothly, improper accounting of school finances, and inadequate maintenance of the school's plants through the repairs and replacement of school facilities or new construction as the need arises. These absurd abnormalities in the school system could impede on principal's leadership, efficiency, accountability, and productivity. Therefore, could it be that principals are inundated with the numerous administrative tasks to be performed daily? Could this also hurt school effectiveness? Therefore, this study seeks to investigate the relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary school effectiveness in Edo State.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of the study was to investigate principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State. Specifically, the study sought to:

1. Find out the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State;
2. Determine the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State;
3. Find out if there is a significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State.

Research Questions

The following research questions guided this study

1. What is the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State?
2. What is the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State?
3. Is there a significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State?

Research Hypotheses

Ho_1: There is no significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State.

Methodology

This study is a descriptive research of correlational type. The design was chosen because the sample of the population was collected as it exists without manipulation. The design was deemed suitable for this study because its aim was to determine if principals' administrative task performance influenced public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State. "The population of this study comprises all three hundred and nine (309) principals and three hundred and nine (309) public senior secondary schools in Edo State. The sample size of the study was 216 principals and 216 public secondary schools, which is approximately 70% of the population. This was done to have adequate representation of the schools in the three senatorial districts of Edo State using the multi-stage sampling procedure. In stage 1, the State was stratified into three (3) Senatorial Districts using the Stratified Sampling Technique. In stage 2, from each of the Senatorial Districts, approximately seventy percent (70%) of public secondary schools was randomly selected using the simple random sampling technique which was ninety-four (94) public secondary schools from Edo South Senatorial District, seventy-four (74) public secondary schools from Edo North senatorial District and forty-eight (48) public secondary schools from Edo Central senatorial district of Edo State**.** In Stage 3, from each of the sampled schools in each Senatorial District, seventy percent (70%) of the principals was selected using the Simple Random Sampling Technique which was ninety-four (94) principals in Edo South Senatorial District, seventy-four (74) principals from Edo North Senatorial District and forty-eight (48) principals from Edo Central senatorial District**.** Thus, 216 principals were selected from the sampled public senior secondary schools in Edo State. The instrument for data collection was the structured questionnaire titled "Principals' Administrative Task Performance and Schools' Effectiveness questionnaire (PATPSEQ)". The instrument consists of two (2) sections. Section A and section B. Section A contains 25 items which elicited information on Principals' administrative task performance while section B contains 20 items which elicited information on school effectiveness. The instrument was based on the modified four-point Likert scale of Strongly Agree (4 points), Agree (3 points), Disagree (2 points), and Strongly Disagree (1 point). To ensure the reliability of the instruments, the Cronbach's alpha statistics was utilized to establish the consistency of the research instrument that was administered. To do this, 20 questionnaires were administered to staff of selected public senior secondary schools in Delta State which were not part of the study and the result of the reliability test was 0.81." The questionnaire was administered to the respondents by the researchers in their various schools. The data collected were subjected to analysis through the application of mean and standard deviation for research questions 1 and 2. The hypothesis was tested utilizing Pearson's product-moment correlation, with a significance level set at 0.05. A mean value of 2.50, indicative of the arithmetic mean of the 4-point Likert scale, was established as the criterion for the acceptance of the research questions.

Presentation of Results

Research Question 1: What is the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State?

Table 1: Mean and standard deviation scores on the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State

S/N	Item	N	Mean	SD	Remarks
1	Instructional Supervision	216	2.62	0.76	'Moderate'
2	Pupils Personnel	216	2.59	0.57	'Moderate'
3	'Staff Personnel'	216	2.70	0.64	'Moderate'
4	School-Community Relationship	216	2.69	0.40	'Moderate'
5	School Plant Management	216	2.71	0.72	'Moderate'
	Grand Mean		**2.67**	**0.62**	'Moderate'

***N=216,* x̄ score < 2.50 = low, 2.50 to 2.99 = moderate, while x̄ score ≥ 3,00 = high.**

Table 1 outlines the mean and standard deviation of five indices related to the administrative task performance of principals in public secondary schools in Edo State. The mean values range from 2.59 to 2.71, while the standard deviations vary from 0.40 to 0.76. Notably, the overall grand mean for all items is 2.67, which exceeds the theoretical mean of 2.5. This indicates that the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State is moderate.

Research Question 2*:* What is the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State?

Table 2: Mean and standard deviation scores on the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State

S/N	Item	N	Mean	SD	Remarks
1	Leadership	216	2.67	0.71	'Moderate'
2	Efficiency	216	2.86	0.68	'Moderate'
3	Accountability	216	2.64	0.72	'Moderate'
4	Productivity	216	2.55	0.66	'Moderate'
	Grand Mean		**2.68**	**0.69**	'Moderate'

***N=216,* x̄ score < 2.50 = low, 2.50 to 2.99 = moderate, while x̄ score ≥ 3,00 = high.**

Table 2 illustrates the mean and standard deviation for four indices measuring the effectiveness of public secondary schools in Edo State. The mean values range from 2.55 to 2.86, while the standard deviations fall between 0.66 and 0.72. Notably, the computed grand mean for all indices is 2.68, which exceeds the theoretical mean of 2.5. This indicates that the effectiveness level of public secondary schools in Edo State is moderate.

Hypothesis one

There is no significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State.

Table 3: Principals' Administrative Task Performance and Public Secondary Schools' Effectiveness in Edo State

Variables	N	Pearson's	Sig/2-Tailed
Principals' administrative task performance	216	0.174	0.011
Schools' effectiveness			

Significant at p < 0.05

Table 3 reveals a Pearson correlation coefficient (r) of 0.174 and a p-value of 0.011, tested at an alpha level of 0.05. Since the p-value is less than the alpha level, we reject the null hypothesis, which states that "there is no significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and the effectiveness of public secondary schools in Edo State." This indicates that there is a positive and significant relationship between the administrative task performance of principals and the effectiveness of public secondary schools in Edo State.

Discussion of Findings

The findings from research question one revealed that the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State is moderate. This might be the multiplying effect of the introduction of Edo's best educational programmes by the immediate past government of Edo state, which made it compulsory for teachers to be trained on the use of digital teaching facilities in the teaching-learning in public secondary schools in Edo state. The findings of this study are in agreement with the findings of Akpan (2016), who found that the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Akwa Ibom State of Nigeria is moderate. In contrast, this study's findings differ from those of Louis-Omiyi and Igenegbai (2021), who found that principals' administrative effectiveness in public secondary schools in Edo State is high.

The findings from research question two revealed that the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State is moderate. Several factors may contribute to this, including inadequate infrastructure and resources, high student-to-teacher ratios, and low student motivation. Additionally, administrative and management challenges, socioeconomic issues such as poverty and limited access to healthcare, outdated curricula and assessment methods, a negative school culture and climate, insufficient community and parental involvement, along with inadequate funding and poor resource allocation, ultimately affecting the overall effectiveness of the school. This study agrees with the findings of Osasuyi and Iduozee (2024), who found that the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State is moderate. Conversely, this study presents a different conclusion from

the research of Umar, Kenayathulla, and Hoque (2021), who reported that secondary schools in Niger State, Nigeria, exhibited a high level of effectiveness.

Finally, the study found a positive and significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State. This might be because when principals carry out their administrative responsibilities effectively, it leads to enhanced school management, increased teacher motivation and job satisfaction, improved student discipline and behaviour, strengthened community involvement and support, and a greater emphasis on accountability and transparency. These factors collectively contribute to the overall success of the educational environment. Also, principals who excel in administrative tasks provide effective leadership, which is critical to the success of a school. They set clear goals, prioritize tasks, and allocate resources efficiently, ultimately enhancing school effectiveness. This finding agrees with the findings of Normakoh (2019) who found that there is a positive relationship between principals' administrative and supervisory strategies and performance of public secondary schools in Obio/Akpor LGA of Rivers State. The finding of this study were also in agreement with the study of Kanyip and Ogon (2022), who found that there is a significant relationship between the principal's role in instructional supervision, planning, motivation, evaluation, and teacher effectiveness and school effectiveness in Public Secondary Schools in Akwa Ibom State. The findings of this study align with those of Nwankwo, Ezeanolue, Nnorom, and Cimezie (2021), who discovered a significant relationship between principals' administrative styles and teachers' job performance as well as secondary school effectiveness in the Ehime Mbano local government area of Imo State.

Implications of the Findings for Educational Management

Secondary education is crucial for achieving Nigeria's national educational objectives. To meet the goals of secondary education, school principals, as the administrative leaders of these institutions, must be efficient and effective in carrying out their administrative responsibilities. It is therefore important that school administrators should be proactive, competent, and up to date in performing their administrative tasks so that the goals and objectives of secondary education can be achieved.

Teacher quality is also a critical factor in school effectiveness. Educational managers should prioritize teacher training and development programs to enhance teacher capacity and improve student outcomes. Also, community engagement and partnerships are essential for school improvement. Educational managers should explore opportunities for collaboration with local communities, businesses, and organizations to support school improvement. Educational managers should also advocate for policy changes that support school improvement, such as reforms to teacher recruitment, curriculum development, and resource allocation.

Furthermore, principals' moderate performance may indicate a need for enhanced supervision and monitoring. Educational authorities should establish robust supervision and monitoring systems to support principals in improving their administrative task performance. This may involve regular visits to schools, performance evaluations, and feedback sessions to help principals identify areas for improvement. Also, principals may need to delegate tasks more effectively to other school

administrators. This can help to improve administrative efficiency and reduce the workload on principals. Educational authorities should provide training and support to help principals develop their delegation skills and empower other school administrators to take on more responsibilities. Additionally, establishing accountability mechanisms can help to improve principals' administrative task performance. Educational authorities should establish clear performance indicators and consequences for underperformance. This can help to motivate principals to improve their administrative task performance and provide a sense of accountability for their actions.

Conclusion

Based on the findings of this study, it was observed that the level of principals' administrative task performance in public secondary schools in Edo State is moderate; the level of public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State is moderate and there is a positive and significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations were made:

1. The principals in public secondary schools in Edo state should be proactive and dynamic in performing their administrative tasks to improve the school effectiveness in the state
2. Principals should always evaluate the outcome of their administrative tasks performance in secondary schools to know if they are effective or not in their school effectiveness
3. Since findings revealed a significant relationship between principals' administrative task performance and public secondary schools' effectiveness in Edo State, principals are encouraged to be more active and timely in performing their administrative tasks so that their schools can be more effective

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IMPEDIMENTS TO PRINCIPALS' EFFECTIVE MANAGEMENT OF SECONDARY SCHOOLS FOR EMPOWERMENT AND JOB CREATION IN EKITI STATE

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Abstract

The study investigated the impediments to the school principals' effective management of Secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti State, Nigeria. The study was guided by two research questions and two hypotheses. The study adopted the descriptive survey research design. The population of the study comprised all 189 secondary schools in Ekiti State as at (2022/2023 academic session). The study employed a proportionate stratified random sampling technique to select 128 school principals from a total population of 189 across the 16 Local Government Areas (LGAs) in Ekiti State. The instrument used for data collection for the study was a self-structured questionnaire titled "Principals' Impediments and Management of Secondary School Questionnaire, "(PIMSSQ)". The instrument was subjected to face validation by three experts. The data collected were analyzed using mean and standard deviation to answer the research questions, while the hypotheses were tested using the t-test statistics at 0.05 level of significance. The major findings of the study were that lack of skilled personnel and inadequate facilities were discovered as impediments to effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti State. Based on the findings, it is recommended that both federal and state governments, along with non-governmental organizations, intensify efforts to address the issues of insufficient funding and inadequate facilities in schools. This is particularly important given that the program is capital-intensive and has the potential to significantly contribute to empowerment and job creation.

Keywords: Impediments, Principals, Management, Secondary schools, Empowerment, Job Creation

Introduction

The purpose of education in Nigeria has long been identified by the Federal Government of Nigeria (2013) in her National Policy on Education as ıe process that helps the whole man develop and change physically, mentally, morally and technologically. This is to enable him/her function effectively in any environment that he/she may find himself so as to become more productive, self-fulfilling and attain self-actualization. The Federal Republic of Nigeria also adopted education as an

instrument for National Development and change. According to Tyowuah & Chen (2019) it is believed that quality education is the key variable for the survival of Nigeria in the competitive economy. He further stated that parents, practitioners and policy makers agree that the key to transform the nation's economy is to improve quality of secondary education that would provide opportunity for a child to potentially acquire knowledge, skills and traits especially with more emphasis on secondary schools.

Despite all the glaring contributions of secondary education in Nigeria, Okoye & Arimonu (2016) regretted that Nigeria is yet to accord this type of education the attention it deserves. The authors note further that his is one of the key factors contributing to the increasing unemployment, poverty, and persistent crime rates in our society today. According to the Ilo (2004), the total number of young people (in the 15-29 age group) in developing country like Nigeria increased by 12.4% between 1993 and 2003, but youth employment rose by just 0.6%, it is obvious that young people are 3.5 times more likely to be unemployed than adult, this is because in years to come, the number of young people coming on to the job market in Nigeria will be steadily increasing. Sure! Here's a smoother and more polished version of that sentence: It is important to emphasize that by enhancing job seekers' access to both the formal and informal labor markets through quality training and effective labor market policies, the Nigerian government can make a significant impact in reducing unemployment and underemployment. As joblessness and underemployment among large sections of the population also have the potential to fuel conflict, vocational and entrepreneur training and labour market policy measures can contribute indirectly to conflict prevention and youth restiveness.

The role of job creation in enhancing youth empowerment cannot be underestimated. This informed why some countries of the world strive to create enabling business environments to support job creation, while another country like Nigeria has put up several social investment programmes that are believed to be geared towards job creation for youth empowerment. Job creation is a process by which the number of jobs in an economy increases. It is often refers to as a situation where government crease means and policies intended to reduce unemployment in a country or state. Ayeni (2021) defined job creation as the process of creating new jobs for the unemployed and the under-employed without necessarily displacing people who are already employed in other economic activities. Empowerment is the provision of increasing the capacity of individuals or groups of people to make choices desired actions and outcome in form of capacity building and training as well as provision of resource in form of material, financial support (Obano & Ogunbiyi, 2022). In essence, empowerment can be regarded as the act of providing opportunities for individual youths to develop their skills to become a problem solver and decision-makers without becoming a problem to the society.

There is no doubt that the role of creating a job in economic development cannot be under-estimated, the reason being that job creation whether in the form of a paid job or starting up a small business or large scale business is a product of economic growth that must have necessitated job creation in the first place. On the contrary, any country that decided to embark on massive job creation to empower

her citizens without it being necessitated by economic growth will soon go into recession. Sustained economic growth seems to enhance job creation; that consequently brings about economic development. The difference between a developed country and developing or under-developed country seems to be the capacity of the former to enhance job creation for the greatest number of her citizens, while the latter cannot enhance job creation because of the absence of sustained economic growth. Job creation for some countries might be full employment owing to some conducive environment that enables businesses to strive, while job creation for other countries lack conducive business environment hence the greatest numbers of citizens are unemployed owing to an un-conducive environment that does not support full employment.

Nuru (2007) indicates that changes in a country's economy is required to prepare young people for the jobs of the future and secondary education have important roles to play in this process. Youth unemployment appears to be shooting up the sky because many of them lack "employability" skills that are often acquired from technical schools. As Edukugho (2004) notes that, youth unemployment moved from 4.3% in 1985 to 5.3% in 1986, to 7.0% in 1987 and jumped to 60% in 1997. The report shows that in 2003 primary school accounted for 14.7% unemployment, secondary school 53.6%, and tertiary schools constituted 12.4%. The nation's poverty level was put at 70% and more than 91 million Nigerians are said to live on less than one dollar per day. Most analysts agree that today's employers demand more skills than they did in the past (Yang, 2008). Oranu (2010) reports that the several factors that have contributed to the rising demand for skills in the labor market to include: technological and organizational change, trade, deregulation of key industries, and the decline of unions.

It must be noted that developing country such as Nigeria, need balanced development through all of the educational sectors in order to make significant progress in terms of national development through effective management of resources in the school. Anashie, Eteng, Ikwen & Basake (2018) note that the management of secondary education in Nigeria is besieged by a myriad of problems that are hindering it from attaining the laudable goals and objectives. The authors further maintain that the serious shortfall and inadequacies in education funding manifest in overcrowded classroom, lack of facilities and equipment, ill-equipped workshops, libraries and laboratories where they exist at all, which all combine to frustrate teaching and learning. In another research, Kajo & Ogunbiyi (2017) elucidate that problem of secondary education in Nigeria involves inadequate and low quality of teachers, negative attitudes of teachers, lack of good communication, inadequate and decay infrastructural facilities, inadequate supervision, over enrolment, government factor, student factor and prevalence of examination malpractice.

In recent years, the management of secondary schools has become an increasingly complex task, with principals at the center of efforts to improve educational outcomes. Across many schools, principals are faced with challenges such as limited resources, high student enrollment, inadequate infrastructure, and rising expectations from stakeholders. Despite these hurdles, there is a growing recognition of the pivotal role that school leadership plays in shaping the effectiveness of teaching

and learning processes. Principals are expected not only to administer day-to-day activities but also to act as visionary leaders who can foster a positive school culture, manage staff efficiently, and ensure academic excellence. However, the prevailing situation reveals that many secondary schools struggle with issues related to discipline, teacher motivation, and resource allocation, factors that directly impact the quality of education offered. In response, many principals have made deliberate attempts to adopt more strategic and participatory approaches to school management, aiming to address these challenges and drive school improvement.

In Ekiti State, Nigeria, secondary school principals face numerous challenges including inadequate infrastructure, limited funding, and outdated administrative practices, all of which hinder effective school management. These issues have significant implications for students' preparedness for life beyond the classroom, particularly in terms of empowerment and job creation. Despite these constraints, principals remain key agents of change and have begun adopting innovative strategies such as promoting entrepreneurial education, integrating vocational training, and engaging community stakeholders. This paper explores how, by overcoming these management impediments, principals can reposition secondary schools in Ekiti State as vital platforms for youth empowerment and sustainable job creation.

Statement of the Problem

Principals in Ekiti State face several impediments that hinder the effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation. These include inadequate funding, lack of vocational and entrepreneurial training facilities, overcrowded classrooms, insufficient teacher motivation, and limited autonomy in decision-making. Additionally, outdated curricula that focus primarily on theoretical knowledge rather than practical skills further limit students' readiness for self-employment or entry into the labor market. These challenges not only affect the quality of education but also restrict principals' ability to implement innovative programs aimed at equipping students with the skills necessary for empowerment and job creation. This situation coupled with the pervasive phenomenon of government intervention in secondary school management related matter in Ekiti state tents to generate problems as to whether the principals of secondary schools are effectively executing their duties. In Nigeria today, it can be seen that many secondary school leavers are found roaming the streets of the Society without any means of livelihood. The increasing rates of poverty, unemployment and underemployment amongst secondary school leavers in Nigeria has made government and all stakeholders in the education to adopt and place emphasis on business and entrepreneurship training and development. Despite the recognized importance of effective school leadership in promoting student empowerment and job readiness, many secondary schools in Ekiti State continue to struggle with systemic challenges that limit principals' capacity to implement transformative initiatives. Issues such as inadequate funding, poor infrastructure, lack of vocational programs, and limited administrative autonomy persist, undermining efforts to align education with the demands of the labor market. This is why the researchers sought to investigate the impediments to principals’ effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti State, Nigeria.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of the study was to investigate the impediments to principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state. Specifically, it sought to:

1. Determine if manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.
2. Establish whether lack of facilities impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Research Questions

1. Does the manpower factor impede principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state?
2. Does lack of facilities impede principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state?

Research Hypotheses

Ho_1: There is no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals as regards whether manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Ho_2: There is no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals with regard to whether facilities impede principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Methodology

The study adopted the descriptive survey research design. The population of the study includes all the 189 public secondary schools principals in Ekiti State as at 2022/2023 academic session, (Directorate of Planning, Research, Statistics and Computer (DPRSC) unit, Ekiti State Teaching Service Board (TSB). The study employed a proportionate stratified random sampling technique to select 128 school principals from a total population of 189 across the 16 Local Government Areas (LGAs) in Ekiti State. Each LGA represented a stratum, and the number of principals selected from each was proportionate to the size of its population relative to the total. Within each LGA, simple random sampling was used to select individual participants, ensuring fairness and equal chance of selection. This method guaranteed comprehensive representation of all strata and enhanced the reliability and generalizability of the study's findings. The instrument used for data collection for the study was a self structured questionnaire titled "Principals' impediments and Management of Secondary School Questionnaire, (PIMSSQ)". The instrument was subjected to face validation by three experts, two from educational administration and planning, and one from test, measurement and evaluation. The experts were requested to assess the relevance of the items in addressing the research questions bearing in mind the purpose of the study. These experts, after scrutinizing the instrument, made very important observations and corrections. The data collected were analyzed using mean and standard deviation to answer the research questions, the decision level was determined by the use of criterion mean of 2.50 for items. Mean of 2.50 and above were considered

as agreed while mean that fell below 2.50 were categorized as disagreed, while the hypotheses were tested using the t-test statistics at 0.05 level of significance.

Results

Research Question 1: Does manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state?

Table 1: Mean and Standard Deviation of Responses of Male and Female Principals on how Manpower Factor Impedes Principals' Effective Management of Secondary Schools for Empowerment and Job Creation in Ekiti State

S/N	Item Description	Male Principals (81)			Female Principals (47)		
		X	SD.	Dec.	X	SD.	Dec.
1.	Poor in-service training for staff	2.22	0.67	Disagree	2.17	0.87	Disagree
2.	Arbitrary transfer of teachers	2.82	0.17	Agree	3.10	0.90	Agree
3.	Poor conditions of service for teachers	3.01	0.94	Agree	2.73	0.38	Agree
4.	Shortage of qualified personnel	2.79	0.85	Agree	2.08	0.61	Disagree
5.	No criteria for posting newly recruited teachers	2.11	0.40	Disagree	2.50	0.14	Agree
	Cluster Mean	**2.59**	**0.60**	**Agree**	**2.51**	**0.58**	**Agree**

Key: N = Number of Respondents, X = mean, SD = Standard Deviation, Dec. = Decision

Table 1 revealed showed responses of male and female principals on whether manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state, with male principals disagreed with items 1 and 5 with mean scores of 2.22 and 2.11, but agree with item 2, 3 and 4 with mean scores of 2.82, 3.01 and 2.79 respectively. On the other hand, the female principals disagree with item 1 and 4 with mean scores of 2.17 and 2.08. However, with cluster mean scores of 2.59 for male principals and 2.51 for female principals respectively, its means that manpower factor was an impediment to the principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Research Question 2: Does lack of facilities impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state?

Table 2: Mean and Standard Deviation of Responses of Male and Female Principals on how Lack of good Facilities Impedes Principals' Effective Management of Secondary Schools for Empowerment and Job Creation in Ekiti State

S/N	Item Description	Male Principals (81)			Female Principals (47)		
		X	SD.	Dec.	X	SD.	Dec.
1.	Inadequate instructional materials	2.72	0.51	Agree	2.67	0.87	Agree
2.	Inadequate stationeries to disseminate information to staff and students	2.62	0.43	Agree	2.52	0.60	Agree
3.	General poor infrastructure	2.50	0.63	Agree	2.67	0.18	Agree
4.	Lack of transport facilities for staff and students	2.59	0.71	Agree	2.15	0.41	Disagree
5.	Inadequate practical and library facilities for staff and students	2.71	0.16	Agree	2.51	0.54	Agree
	Cluster Mean	**2.62**	**0.48**	**Agree**	**2.50**	**0.52**	**Agree**

Key: N = Number of Respondents, X = mean, SD = Standard Deviation, Dec. = Decision

Table 2 revealed the mean responses of male and female principals on how lack of good facilities impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in post covid-19 era in Ekiti state. The male principals agreed with all items to 5 with mean scores of 2.72, 2.62, 2.50, 2.59 and 2.71 respectively; while the female principals agreed with items 1, 2, 3 and 5 with mean scores of 2.67, 2.52, 2.67 and 2.51, but disagreed with item 4. However, with cluster mean scores of 2.62 for male principals and 2.50 for female principals respectively, this shows that lack of facilities impedes the principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state

Test of Hypotheses

Hypothesis 1: There is no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals as regards whether manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Table 3: T-test Results of the Responses of the Male and Female Principals on how Manpower Factor Principals' Effective Management of Secondary Schools for Empowerment and Job creation in Ekiti State

Status	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	df	t-cal	t-crit	Sig.	Remarks
Male Principals	81	3.49	1.15	126	0.63	1.91	0.05	Accepted
Female Principals	47	2.89	1.64					

Table 3 shown the results of the t-test analysis of the mean difference between the mean scores of male and female principals with regard to how manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state. The t-cal value was 0.63, while the critical value was 1.91 at 0.05 level of significance and the degree of freedom of 126. The hypothesis was accepted. This therefore implies that there is no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals with regard to whether manpower factor impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Hypothesis 2: There is no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals with regard to lack of good facilities impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Table 4: T-test Results of the Responses of the Male and Female Principals on how Lack of Good Facilities Principals' Effective Management of Secondary Schools for Empowerment and Job creation in Ekiti State

Status	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	df	t-cal	t-crit	Sig.	Remarks
Male Principals	81	2.57	0.67	126	1.83	1.96	0.05	Accepted
Female Principals	47	2.48	0.71					

Table 4 above presented the results of the t-test analysis of the mean difference between the mean scores of male and female principals with regard to how lack of good facilities impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state. The t-cal revealed a value of 1.83, while the critical value is 1.96 at 0.05 level of significance and with a degree of freedom of 126. The hypothesis was accepted. This therefore implies that there is no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals with regard to how lack

of good facilities impedes principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti state.

Discussion of Findings

The finding from the study shows that manpower factor militates against the principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti State. This finding corroborated the finding of Ode (2006), who found that manpower-related factors such as poor in-service training for staff, low job morale among the teachers, poorly qualified teaching staff, scarcity of manpower in schools, and regular attraction of staff out of the teaching profession militate against effective secondary school management in Ekiti State. Similarly, Akinyemi (2010) emphasized that inadequate manpower development and poor professional support systems significantly hinder school administrators' ability to implement sustainable empowerment and job creation strategies in the education sector. The author further notes that without a deliberate policy focus on staff motivation, continuous training, and recruitment of qualified personnel, secondary schools will continue to struggle with achieving their educational and socioeconomic objectives. This underscores the urgent need for government and educational stakeholders to invest more in manpower development as a strategic tool for enhancing school leadership effectiveness.

Findings from Table Two established that lack of good facilities militates against the principals' effective management of secondary schools for empowerment and job creation in Ekiti State. This finding is in agreement with the submission of Nwagwu (2004), who asserted that one of the most critical factors in balancing qualitative and quantitative educational growth is the availability and adequacy of infrastructure, such as buildings, learning facilities, machinery, and equipment. Without proper infrastructure, it becomes increasingly difficult for school principals to create an enabling environment that promotes effective teaching, learning, and skills acquisition necessary for empowering students and fostering job creation. Furthermore, the hypotheses tested in the study revealed no significant difference between the mean scores of male and female principals regarding how inadequate funding, manpower factors, and lack of good facilities impede their capacity to manage secondary schools effectively. In line with these findings, Oyesola (2000) also emphasized that the condition of physical facilities in schools directly affects administrative efficiency and student outcomes. When schools are poorly equipped, principals face challenges in executing educational policies and programs that are crucial for student empowerment. These findings underscore the urgent need for government and stakeholders in the education sector to prioritize infrastructural development and maintenance as a foundational strategy for enhancing school management and achieving the goals of empowerment and employment generation

Conclusion

Based on the findings of the study, it was concluded that the primary challenges hindering principals' effective management of secondary schools for the purposes of empowerment and job creation in Ekiti State include shortage of qualified manpower, lack of funds, and insufficient infrastructural facilities. These impediments significantly limit the capacity of school principals to implement programs and policies that could enhance skill acquisition, entrepreneurship education, and overall

student empowerment. Addressing these issues is therefore critical to improving school management outcomes and fostering an environment that supports sustainable job creation among secondary school graduates in Ekiti state.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of the study, the following recommendations were made:

1. Provision of Adequate Infrastructure and Resources: The Secondary School Management Boards should prioritize the provision of essential infrastructural facilities, modern equipment, and relevant teaching and learning materials to secondary schools. This will enhance the ability of principals to effectively manage their schools and implement programs geared towards student empowerment and job creation.
2. Capacity Building and Recruitment of Qualified Personnel: To address manpower challenges, the Management Boards should organize regular training and professional development programs for school principals and staff, while also ensuring the recruitment of qualified personnel. Strengthening human capacity will improve school management efficiency and foster the development of skills necessary for entrepreneurial education.

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DIGITALIZATION OF BUSINESS EDUCATION CURRICULUM FOR ACHIEVING RENEWED HOPE AGENDA

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Abstract

This paper discussed the place of digitalized business education curriculum towards achieving Nigerian renewed hope agenda. The paper appraised the intent renewed hope agenda with emphasis on its objectives. It was established that, digitalized business education curriculum is a veritable tool for achieving the established renewed hope agenda. The paper equally highlighted the challenges impeding the digitalization of business education curriculum to be administrative challenges and economic challenges which include among others; poor funding, inadequate ICT facilities, laboratories, workshops, furniture, lack of physical facilities and unstable government policies. In order to overcome the aforementioned challenges, the paper suggested the following strategies; building of meaningful digital ICT centres in schools, constant in-service training for business educators and acquisition of basic digital resources for both teachers and learners of business education. The paper concluded that, the place of business education in achieving the PBAT led administration's renewed hope agenda is inevitable. The paper therefore suggested among others that, the federal government of Nigeria should mainstream innovation into business education curriculum to foster better learning outcomes for the achievement of her renewed hope agenda; and that government both at state and national level should leverage on the capabilities of the present-day technology and continuously stay updated for the achievement of renewed hope agenda.

Keywords: *Business Education, Curriculum, Digital, Renewed Hope Agenda.*

Introduction

The education and skills training of a country's population is a major factor determining how that country's economy performs. A nation's education level also contributes to, or undermines, the quality of its democratic governance. However, renewed hope agenda saga for achieving socio-economic development of Nigeria is not out of place. The PBAT administration has as part of its aims to reform the education sector by focusing on the following indices; quality, access, funding, management, effectiveness and competitiveness. Achieving the afore-stated aims requires quality business education.

Business education according to, is an important part of general education which emphasizes skills and competency acquisition. It is a programme of study which encompasses education for office, occupations, business teaching administration and economic understanding. Oladunjoye (2016), opined that business education is an academic programme offered in tertiary educational institutions geared towards the acquisition of knowledge and skills needed in the place of work.

Renewed hope agenda for the country's socio-economic development can be achieved through digitalizing business education curriculum. Digital curriculum changes the tradition of old teaching and brings higher results in different domains. The curriculum is the sum of the educational, cultural, social, sports, religious, environmental and artistic experiences that the educational institution prepares for its students inside and outside the institution in order to achieve their overall growth and modify their behaviour (Malak, Jhanjhi & Momoona, 2020). The curriculum of business education as prescribed by the Comparative Education Study and Adaptation Centre (CESAC) in Emeasoba (2015), was structured with the objectives of providing the orientation of basic skills with which to start an occupation for those who cannot continue training; preparing students for further training in business studies; relating knowledge and skills in office occupations and providing basic business skills for personal use and for the future. Business education is an important oriented programme of study that prepares its recipient with multiple skills for teaching and entrepreneurial competencies for self-reliance. However, achieving the aforementioned prospects of business education especially in the era of government renewed hope agenda might not see the light of the day if the curriculum of business education does not conform to the prevailing blended learning of the 21st century.

Renewed Hope Agenda

Tinubu (2023), during his electioneering campaign in Nigeria submitted that Nigeria is a unique nation, impressive in its diverse character and composition, resounding and hopeful in unity and collective fate. Nigeria is a home of over 200 million vibrant people which stands as the most populous nation on the African continent and the largest concentration of black people on earth. The renewed hope of PBAT stands on the premise to achieve the following;

i. Build a Nigeria, especially youth, where sufficient jobs with decent wages create a better life
ii. Manufacture, create, and invent more of the goods and services we require.
iii. Export more and import less, strengthening both the naira and our way of life.
iv. Continue assisting our ever toiling farmers, through enlightened agricultural policy that promotes productivity and assures decent incomes, so that farmers can support their families and feed the nation.
v. Modernize and expand public infrastructure so that the rest of the economy can grow at an optimal rate.
vi. Embolden and support youth and women by harnessing emerging sectors such as the digital economy, entertainment and culture, tourism and others to build the Nigeria of tomorrow, today.
vii. Train and give economic opportunity to the poorest and most vulnerable.
viii. Generate, transmit and distribute sufficient, affordable electricity and give requisite power to enlighten lives, homes and dreams.
ix. Make basic health care, education, and housing accessible and affordable for all.
x. Establish a bold and assertive policy that will create the strong yet adaptive national security architecture and action to obliterate terror, kidnapping, banditry, and all other forms of violent extremism from the face of our nation.

Objectives of Renewed Hope Agenda

Tinubu (2023) purported that his administration promised to reform the education sector based on the following three objectives;

i. Ensuring on abundance of qualified and capable educators.
ii. Creating safe and conducive learning environments, and
iii. Improving educational outcomes in Nigeria

Specifically, the policies and reforms of renewed hope agenda intend to introduce; quality education for all, technical and vocational education, tertiary education. The quality education for all aimed at investing in the infrastructure of educational institutions and provides adequate resources that improve the educational environment in which children are taught; accreditation standards and curriculum developed for all institutions, from the primary to the tertiary level; a modern standard curriculum developed and implemented in all primary and secondary schools throughout the country; teachers training with the introduction of new accreditation requirement for teachers in federally funded primary and secondary schools with standardized teacher training courses and examinations; and management of schools by board of education which include among others members of the local communities.

Establishing and resuscitating the existing technical and vocational learning institutions to stimulate Nigeria's natural entrepreneurial spirit and empower more individuals toward self-reliance and economic prosperity, thereby reducing poverty, unemployment, and inequality, and ultimately transforming Nigeria into a vibrant and sustainable economy. These centres of excellence will focus on training the students in 21st century growth industries such as information technology software development, artificial intelligence, and robotics. In the same vein, the programme aims to restructure tertiary education such as funding and compensation structures, students loans to pilot all students access to education regardless of their background; special education fund through new legislation; and STEM incentives such as scholarships, internships, graduate school admissions, and employment.

Business Education Curriculum

Business Education as an integral part of the broad spectrum of vocational education aimed at preparing individuals to establish and manage their own businesses as intelligent and good consumers of goods and services. Business Education involves equipping students with the appropriate skills, knowledge and competences needed to advance in the field of business or to progress in the world of business as managers, business executives, entrepreneurs, secretaries and accountants (Okoye, 2017). Business Education Programme as viewed by Olowookere & Akinsanya (2014), is a programme of education which equip the students with the marketable skills, knowledge and attitudes for initial employment and advancement in business occupation.

The National Policy on Education (2014) in Okoye (2017), integrated Business Education Programme into the total education programme to cater for the needs of the nation. The objectives of Business Education Programme as a means to achieve renewed hope agenda include;

i. To provide trained manpower in applied science, technology, commerce particularly as sub professional grade.
ii. To provide the technical knowledge and vocational skills necessary for industrial, commercial and economic development.
iii. To provide people who can apply scientific knowledge to environmental problems for the use and convenience of man.
iv. To give training and impact the skills leading to the production of craftsmen, technicians and other skilled personnel who will be enterprising and self-reliant.
v. To give an introduction to professional studies in engineering and other technology.
vi. To enable young men and women have an intelligent understanding of the increasing complexity of technology.

Ementa and Alonta (2021) opined that curriculum is often seen as a course of study that students must learn to reach a certain level of education. It is a vehicle through which the school strives to achieve educational objectives. It is the life wire of a school programme, and it is a track that prepares students for their future life. According to a report by the International Bureau of Education (2016), curriculum represents a conscious and systematic selection of knowledge, skills and values; a selection that shapes the way teaching, learning, and assessment processes are organized by addressing questions such as what, why, when and how students should learn., remarked that the curriculum consists of all the learning experiences or educational programmes planned for students under the auspices of the school. Curriculum refers to a group of courses or planned experiences in proper sequence of topics designed to prepare an individual for efficient service in a specific vocation, it is the offering of a society valued knowledge, skills and attitudes that is made available to students through a variety of arrangements in schools, colleges or the universities or other arrangements (Adebayo & Lawal, 2011).

According to Wolugbom, Uranta & Firima (2022), Business education curriculum was designed and planned with guided learning experience and learning outcomes formulated through systematic reconstruction of knowledge and experiences engulfed with practical skills for self-reliance under the guidance of the school for learners in line with the reviewed national curriculum which became the New Basic Education Curriculum for lower basic and upper basic levels of education. This new curriculum is said to address issues of poverty reduction, critical thinking, value re-orientation, entrepreneurship, and skill acquisition.

Business education curriculum, according to Nwatarali and Emeasoba (2022), is part of a continuous process of planning and development, which involves the selection of learning experiences that will help in the attainment of goals, objectives of the pogrammes and for the recipients to fit into the world of work or be entrepreneurs' upon graduation. Business education curriculum is designed to provide skills such as; management skills, creative skills, planning skills, opportunity identification skills, cooperative skills, communication skills, goal setting skills, critical thinking skills, problem solving skills, decision making skills, marketing strategy skills, financial management skills, conflict prevention/resolution skills, departmental recovery skills, risk bearing skills, motivation skills, technical skills, innovative skills, self-management skills and integrity/honesty skills.

Digitalization of Business Education Curriculum and Renewed Hope Agenda

Digitalizing the curriculum of business education could be described as online delivery of information and integration of learning with technology (Okure, 2018). Digital approach to business education curriculum is a student-centered method of learning that offers a great deal of flexibility considering time and location, which has the ability to facilitate the achievement of the President Bola Ahmed Tinubu-led team's achievement of renewed agenda. David and Abiola (2022), posited that one of the basic requirements for education in the 21st century is to prepare learners for preparation in a networked, knowledge-based economy in which knowledge will be the most critical resource for socio-economic development. Digitalizing educational content is achievable through the utilization of the internet. The internet is a valuable tool that is tremendously useful to teachers. This will allow both teachers and students to access new information, points of view, and experiences that they would otherwise not have been able to encounter.

According to Arkorful and Abaidoo (2014), some of the benefits of digitalizing business education curriculum in achieving socio-economic development include:

i. It brings about modification of procedures and processes based on the needs of the students.
ii. It has advantages to function in time of crisis such as man-made disasters, natural disasters or pandemic. Allow interaction with students on the platform.
iii. It would transform the education sector by eradicating manual processes across and replace them with modern and dynamic online digital learning which will eventually create more interactive learning environment for students.
iv. It allows students to learn at their own pace by attending online classes. This allows students to learn at their own pace.
v. It brings about infrastructural development in terms of building, increases satisfaction and decreases stress brought about by traveling.

Other benefits derivable from digitalizing business education curriculum for the achievement of government agenda according to Jain International Residential School (2021), include the following;

i. One-on-one learning: The main advantage of the digital business education system is that it allows students to learn at their own pace and when students are unable to keep up with the rest of the class, it causes them to lose interest.
ii. Develop smart learners: Using learning tools and technology, students will be able to study more effectively.
iii. Students become self-motivated: Students who use digital tools and technology to learn become more involved and interested.
iv. Expansive learning opportunities: Additional learning options outside of the traditional classroom teaching and learning environment are referred to as expanded learning.
v. Individualized learning experience: This is personalizing teaching based on the students' learning pace and aptitude to modern digital format.
vi. Endless Information: The internet is enormous and full of information, the majority of which is freely available.

vii. Highly engaged learning: The conventional education system limits engagement since its forces at work include restricted elements such as textbooks, an instructor, and handwritten notes, but the digital education system gives a wide range of learning option.
viii. Student accountability: The digital education system includes real-time evaluation and system-generated performance reports, which improves assessment openness. It allows students to independently examine their performance and come up with the necessary remedies.

Challenges of digitalizing Business Education Curriculum

Wolugbom, Uranta and Firima (2022) posited that the challenges of digitalizing business education curriculum could be categorized as administrative challenges and economic challenges. The administrative challenges include; allocation of business education courses to non-professionals, use of obsolete and inappropriate teaching methods, lack of teachers' training and re-training, inadequate time allocation, students' lack of interest in the subject, integration of several subject areas in the curriculum and non-teacher commitment towards practical skills. In the same vein, Ezenwa (2020) highlighted lack of infrastructure and teaching facilities; method of instructional delivery, lack of students' interest, quality of teachers, inadequate instructional supervision and corruption as the administrative challenges of business education curriculum. The economic challenges of business education challenges include; inadequate teaching/learning facilities, parents' socio economic status, inadequate funding, high cost of instructional materials like textbooks, lack of teacher motivation like timely promotion, salary increment and allowances, lack of physical facilities and unstable government policies. Needum-Ogede (2019), also submitted that the economic challenges of business education curriculum include poor funding, inadequate ICT facilities classrooms, laboratories, workshops, furniture, poor socio-economic background of parents and inconducive school environment.

Strategies for Effective Digitalization of Business Education Curriculum for Achieving Renewed Hope Agenda

In achieving renewed hope agenda through business education, effective digitalization of the curriculum is crucial. One key strategy is to integrate technology-enhanced learning tools, such as learning management systems (LMS), online simulations and gamification into the curriculum. This will enable students to access course materials, participate in interactive learning activities, and collaborate with peers remotely. In the same manner, incorporating emerging technologies like artificial intelligence (AI), blockchain, and data analytics into the curriculum will equip students with the skills and knowledge required to succeed in today's digital economy.

Effective digitalization of business education curriculum is to focus on developing students' digital literacy and competencies. This can be achieved by incorporating digital skills training, such as digital marketing, e-commerce, and data analysis into the curriculum. However, encouraging students to participate in digital entrepreneurship and innovation initiatives can help them develop the skills and mindset required to succeed in the digital economy. Additionally, business education curriculum should accommodate partnership with industry stakeholders and companies to provide students with

opportunities for experimental learning, internships, and job placements, thereby enhancing their employability and career prospects.

Adeola and Adedayo (2022) posited that the 21st century economy needs highly trained and skilled human capital. Educational institutions are required to turn out qualified graduates to meet the needs of employers and national development through the inculcation of relevant skills. The goal of business education is to provide its recipients with hands-on, technical training that prepares them to the rapidly evolving 21st century workforce. The findings of Ejeka, Okoro and Ebenezer-Nwokeji (2022), also suggested likely solutions to the problems confronting the digitalization of business education curriculum towards achieving renewed hope agenda include;

i. Building of meaningful digital literacy centers in schools
ii. Constant in-service training programme like seminar, conferences, workshops on digital literacy or skill development
iii. Involvement of non-governmental organizations to collaborate with schools in the provision of digital resources
iv. Provision of adequate security and stable power supply for digital resources utilization by business educators
v. Acquisition of basic digital resources by every business educators.

Conclusion

To actualize the renewed hope agenda in Nigeria, the place of business education cannot be overemphasized. As the educational sector becomes more competitive, digital transformation is now becoming a necessary means of survival. This new digital world requires business educators to adopt and adapt digital technologies, methodologies, and mindsets. The yearning better Nigeria is achievable if the concept of business education is digitalized for the citizens to behold and unwrap potential therein for socio-economic development and improved standard of living.

Suggestions

Based on the conclusion of this paper, it was suggested that:

1. The federal government of Nigeria should mainstream innovation into business education curriculum to foster better learning outcomes for the achievement of her renewed hope agenda.
2. There is a need to review the present curriculum of business education to further update more digital skills. Proper integration of technology in the learning environment gives children the opportunity to develop social interaction and collaboration.
3 The government, both at the state and national levels, should leverage the capabilities of present-day technology and continuously stay updated for the achievement of the renewed hope agenda.
4. Business educators at all levels of education should be trained on the usage of digital technologies for improved job performance in achieving the renewed hope agenda.

Business Education programme should be adequately funded by the PBAT-led administration through the provision of digitalized ICT laboratories and entrepreneurship laboratories at various level of education to expose students and trainees to the needed practical experiences garnered towards achieving the renewed hope agenda.

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LEADERSHIP SUCCESSION AND LECTURER PRODUCTIVITY IN THE OBAFEMI AWOLOWO UNIVERSITY, ILE-IFE, NIGERIA

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Abstract
Lecturer Productivity (LP) is the level of personal or joint effort employed by a lecturer or group of lecturers in attaining quality research publication. The LP in terms of Research Publication (RP) was low. Previous studies on LP focused on institutional supports and leadership practices without Leadership Succession (LS). This study, therefore, examined LS and LP in Obafemi Awolowo University (OAU), Ile-Ife in Nigeria, using correlational research design. A proportionate sampling technique was used to select 8 faculties and 49 departments (i.e., 60% of 13 and 82) respectively. Three lecturers were sampled randomly in each department, and data were collected using two instruments with a 0.95 reliability coefficient. Research questions and hypothesis were answered and tested using descriptive statistics and Pearson Product Moment Correlation. The LP on both local and international publications ($\overline{x}$ = 2.67; 2.71) in OAU were high. The extent to which LS is being practiced was low ($\overline{x}$ = 2.98). Low correlation exists between LS and LP, r = (0.21), 0.03, P< .05. The LS has not been taken into consideration and relationship exists between LS and LP. The LP should be maintained and sustained. Efforts should be made by management to find a means of reshaping the LS of the institution so that the level of RP could be improved.

Keywords: Lecturer productivity, succession, leadership succession, research publication

Introduction

Globally, lecturers are the backbone of universities, and no university can achieve its mission and vision without them. They are the driver of missions and visions through which their productivity is achieved. They are expected to teach, research, and make themselves available for community service. The ability to dedicate and commit themselves diligently to teach in the classroom, carry out research, and serve the community in and outside the university as expected from time to time, makes lecturers productive. However, it appears that some lecturers hardly cope with their routine activities, ranging from teaching, research, project supervision, students' work assessment, seminars, and community service.

Researchers like Ani, Ngulube, and Onyancha (2017) reported that the level of lecturers' productivity in terms of research across disciplines is low and inconsistent in Nigerian federal universities. This could be due to poor funding, the absence of basic facilities, and poor infrastructure, among others. Onayinka, Falebita, Awoniyi, Nweze, and Opele (2023) submitted that publication of lecturers in

Nigerian universities is of low quality when compared with their counterparts in developed nations due to a lack of research funding, infrastructure challenges, heavy teaching workload, bureaucratic processes, poor mentorship, and motivation. Lecturers' productivity can be defined as the level of personal or joint effort employed by a lecturer or group of lecturers in attaining quality research publication and graduation through effective teaching in Nigerian universities. However, this present study uses research publications as an indicator of lecturers' productivity.

Nigerian universities are expected to conduct quality research that would have an impact on institutions and national development. Hence, quality research in Nigerian universities would become only as good as the quality of the system. Considering research at the global level, it seems Nigerian universities are lagging in terms of quality research. A completed research without publication is certainly meaningless to the entire university system and stakeholders in society. The quality of research publication is the measure of academic excellence among lecturers, while several publications serve as an indicator of lecturer productivity. Hence, the essence of lecturers' publication in Nigerian universities is to measure their productivity and evaluate lecturers for promotion to the next level of academic cadre and research grants (Raji and Oyedeji, 2021). This implies that lecturers are expected to be evaluated every three years based on their research publications made in reputable national and international journals.

Quality research publications are required to serve as public consumption, promotion for lecturers and image of the universities, enrich lecturers' curriculum vitae, and solve societal problems. It provides a platform for lecturers to become successful scholars. It also enhances the quality of teaching and reinforces many of the skills that are required for effective teaching. Adeyanju and Oshinyadi (2017) stated that research publication is the chief means of communicating research, a primary means of recognition and reward in academic work. Hence, it cannot be handled with kid gloves in universities. Therefore, there is a saying that says Publish or perish, A university lecturer without research publication seems to be perishing in the system, and such a lecturer may contribute to the low ranking of the university at the global level.

However, observation shows that lecturers of the universities are not as committed and dedicated to quality research publication as they ought to be, which could mean there is a problem. Some lecturers seem to supervise several undergraduate, master's, and doctoral students over a specified time frame without publishing their research. Olasupo (2017) adopted a descriptive survey research design and 302 academic staff as the sample size to conduct the study on research publication in the university, and found that the publication of co-authored textbooks, patents, textbooks, and certified inventions was poor.

Adeyanju and Oshinyadi (2017) reported that the average rate of research publication is low among lecturers at Nigerian universities. Atanda and Olasupo (2018) attributed low research productivity (publications) in Nigerian tertiary institutions to poor and irregular funding, poor incentive for research, and increasing workloads linked to worsening staff/student ratio, which drastically reduces the time meant to be committed to research, among others. However, to ensure that the lecturers are

productive in terms of research publication in federal universities, there is a need for mentoring an academic leader who will successfully replace the predecessor in the academic circle.

Leadership succession concerns how academic leaders emerge in the university. The new academic leaders are expected to groom lecturers on how to use research methodology and write proposals for research grants. This type of grooming will go in long way in achieving lecturers' productivity in the area of research output. According to Abiodun-Oyebanji and Oyedeji (2022), leadership succession is the process of recognizing and grooming fresh personnel who can take the place of aged academic leaders when they retire, leave, or are no more to sustain and maintain quality research output. For instance, it is expected that the newly appointed Head of Department (HOD) will make changes and thus impose mandates to improve the productivity of lecturers. The imposition of HOD or academic administrators into the system without due process or consensus would not only affect lecturers' productivity but also reduce the quality of research publications. The more externally appointed academic leaders, the higher the likelihood of lecturers' productivity. Abiodun-Oyebanji and Oyedeji (2023) reported that the successors of academics did not have an antecedent to follow, which may contribute low productivity of lecturers in Nigerian universities. The researchers further stated that, over the years, most academic leaders (vice chancellors, deans and heads of departments) who succeeded their predecessors in universities confront encounters of time frame to attain their dreams because some of them do not prepare for leadership position which eventually affect lecturer productivity in the area of research publication.

Ahmed (2020) pointed out that a lack of leadership succession may tend to lower research output and cause challenges to the missions and visions of universities. The purpose of leadership succession is to address the needs of universities in the area of research methodology, research grants, and quality of high-impact journals as old academic leaders retire from the system. Abiodun-Oyebanji and Oyedeji (2022) stated that the main reason for leadership succession is to help sustain the prospect of academic research and publication.

Based on the review of previous studies, leadership succession is expected to enhance the quality of the research publications of lecturers. Hence, it is expected that when a new leader emerges, lecturers' productivity in the area of research publication will be improved. Sanito, Engstrom, Reetz, Schweinle, and Reed (2009) found that as the academic staff ranking increases, the research productivity decreases. This indicates that once academic staff reach the peak of their career, their motivation to publish will continue to fall. Therefore, it suggests that lower-ranking lecturers, such as assistant lecturers, lecturers II, and lecturers I, are more likely motivated by conducting quality research and publishing in outlet journals compared to professors/ associate professors who are older in the system.

Previous studies conducted have been carried out to address lecturers' productivity from different standpoints. Most of these studies (Raji and Oyedeji, 2021; Olawuyi, 2017; Abba, Anumaka, and Gaite, 2016; and Bland, 2005) focused on institutional support, organisational culture, leadership practices, and formal mentoring rather than leadership succession and lecturer productivity. This

study, therefore, examined leadership succession and lecturers' productivity in OAU, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria.

Statement of the Problem

Lecturers' productivity in federal universities seems to be low in the area of research publication. Research publication seems to be diminishing as many lecturers appear not to be committed and dedicated to quality research publication. Reports also showed that some research publications, like co-authored textbooks, patents, textbooks, and certified inventions, are rarely published among lecturers in federal universities. The implication is that, if low lecturers' productivity is not addressed by stakeholders in the university system, their universities may continue experiencing a low ranking compared to their counterparts in the rest of the world. There will be no promotion for lecturers in federal universities, and universities will be seriously undermined in society. It is assumed that this could be a result of the effective leadership succession that university management fails to put in place to enhance the quality of research publications. However, numerous studies have been conducted on lecturers' productivity within and outside the Nigerian university system, and the problem persists. This study, therefore, examined leadership succession and lecturers' productivity in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria.

Purpose of the Study

The general objective was to examine the relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity in Obafemi Awolowo University (OAU), Ile-Ife, in Nigeria. Specifically, the objectives were as follows: find out the level of lecturer productivity; examine the extent of leadership succession; and ascertain the relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity in OAU, Ile-Ife in Nigeria.

Research Questions

The following research questions were answered.

i. What is the level of lecturer productivity in OAU, Ile-Ife in Nigeria?
ii. What is the extent of leadership succession in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife in Nigeria?

Hypothesis

The hypothesis was tested in the study

H_{01}: There is no significant relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity at the Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria

Methodology

The correlational research design was adopted for this study. The population comprised 1,380 lecturers, 13 faculties, and 82 departments in OAU, Ile-Ife. The sample size for this study comprised 147 lecturers across five (5) faculties and 28 departments in OAU. A proportionate sampling technique was used to select 8 faculties and 49 departments (i.e., 60% of 13 and 82) respectively. Three (3) lecturers in each department were sampled using a simple random sampling technique. Two instruments, the Leadership Succession Questionnaire (LSQ) and the Publication Checklist

(PC), were used for data collection. The LSQ had two sections, Section A was designed to collect information about lecturers' demographic data, such as sex, age, faculty, and department, among others. Section B considered leadership succession with 12 items. The Cronbach's coefficient of 0.95 obtained was considered adequate for the internal consistency of leadership succession. However, 111 (75.5%) lecturers completed the distributed questionnaire. Research questions 1 and 2 were answered using descriptive while hypothesis 1 was tested using inferential statistics.

Results

1. What is the level of lecturer productivity in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria?

Table 1: Level of lecturer productivity in terms of research publications

		Local					**International**				
S/N	**Publication**	**NIL**	**1-5**	**6-10**	**11-15**	**($\bar{X}$)**	**NIL**	**1-5**	**6-10**	**11-15**	**($\bar{X}$)**
1	Patent Work	3 (2.7)	45 (40.5)	46 (41.4)	17 (15.3)	2.69	6 (5.4)	35 (31.5)	40 (36.0)	30 (0)	2.85
2	Textbook Published	13 (11.7)	30 (27.0)	29 (26.1)	39 (35.1)	2.85	8 (7.2)	47 (42.3)	28 (25.2)	28 (25.2)	2.68
3	Chapters in Books	20 (18.0)	37 (33.3)	35 (31.5)	19 (17.1)	2.48	13 (11.7)	28 (25.2)	40 (36.0)	30 (27.0)	2.78
4	Articles	11 (9.9)	30 (27.0)	41 (36.9)	29 (26.1)	2.79	27 (24.3)	30 (27.0)	14 (12.6)	40 (36.0)	2.60
5	Conference Papers	10 (9.0)	51 (45.9)	30 (27.0)	20 (18.0)	2.54	18 (16.2)	25 (22.5)	35 (31.5)	33 (29.7)	2.75
6	Book Review	20 (18.0)	31 (27.9)	29 (26.1)	31 (27.9)	2.64	10 (9.0)	45 (40.5)	30 (27.0)	26 (26.4)	2.65
7	Co-authored textbooks	10 (9.0)	31 (9.2)	40 (0.9)	30 (0)	2.81	14 (12.6)	37 (33.3)	40 (36.0)	20 (18.0)	2.59
8	Technical reports	16 (14.4)	40 (36.0)	25 (22.5)	30 (27.0)	2.62	10 (9.0)	40 (36.0)	34 (30.6)	27 (24.3)	2.70
9	Monographs	11 (9.9)	45 (40.5)	20 (18.0)	20 (18.0)	2.58	8 (7.2)	35 (31.5)	45 (40.5)	23 (20.7)	2.75
	Weighted Average	**2.71**									

Note: Men value ranges from 0-1.4= Very Low, 1.4-2.4 = Low, 2.5- 3.4 = High, 3.5 and above Very High. Figures in parentheses are percentages.

Table 1 indicates the level of lecturer productivity in the Obafemi Awolowo University within six years (2013/2014-2018/2019 academic sessions), average score of each item was calculated. This is sub-categorised into local and international publications in the table. Considering the result in Table 1, it is indicated that some of the lecturers in this institution decided not to reveal the true status of their publications. Hence, they are categorised under nil, which does not dominate the result. However, the nine items of local publication had a weighted of 2.67 out of the maximum obtainable 4.0. The obtained mean values for the items are as follows: patent work (mean=3.63); textbook published (mean= 3.00); chapters in books (mean=3.57); articles (mean =4.73) conference papers (mean=3.39); book review (mean =3.28); co-authored textbooks (mean=3.45), technical reports (mean=3.35) and monographs (mean=3.00). Based on the weighted score of 2.67, the finding shows that local publication was above the cut-off point of 2.5. This implies that local publications were found to be high.

Concerning international publications, all nine items of international publications were also considered in the table and had a weighted score of 2.71 out of a maximum obtainable 4.0. The mean values for the items of patent work (mean=3.00); textbook published (mean=3.00); chapters in books (mean=3.00); articles (mean=4.51); conference papers (mean=3.00); book review (mean=3.45); co-authored textbooks (mean=3.00), technical reports (mean=3.00) and monographs (mean=3.00). Based on the weighted average score of 2.71, the result indicates that the international publications in OAU were above the threshold of 2.5. This indicates that international publications were also high. It, therefore, could be found that lecturer productivity in terms of research output on both local and international publications in OAU was generally high when considering the weighted average score of local and international publications together.

2. What is the extent of leadership succession in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife in Nigeria?

Table 2: Extent of leadership succession

S/N	Statements	E	VG	G	F	P	($\bar{x}$)
1	Objectively identify successors to fill key academic positions	23 (20.7)	33 (29.7)	23 (20.7)	23 (20.7)	9 (8.1)	3.31
2	Building research culture through leadership succession	13 (11.7)	23 (20.7)	35 (31.5)	24 (21.6)	16 (14.4)	2.90
3	Making plans for leadership succession	16 (14.4)	22 (19.8)	41 (36.9)	23 (20.7)	9 (8.1)	2.81
4	The transition committee works in line with the missions and vision of the university	16 (14.4)	17 (15.3)	36 (32.4)	27 (24.3)	15 (13.5)	3.03
5	Transition committee identifies potential successor	16 (14.4)	24 (21.6)	32 (28.8)	32 (28.8)	9 (26.4)	2.90
6	Smoothness of transfer of leadership responsibility	14 (12.6)	23 (20.7)	34 (30.6)	28 (25.2)	12 (10.8)	2.94
	Weighted Average			**2.98**			

Key: Excellent (E) =5, Very Good (VG)=4, Good (G)=3, Fair (F)=2, Pass (P)=1 Decision Rule if mean is less than 3.0 = low; above 3.0 = high

Table 2 shows the extent of leadership succession in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria. For instance, objectively identify successors to fill key academic positions (mean = 3.31); building research culture through leadership succession (mean = 2.90); making plan for leadership succession (mean = 2.81); transition committee works in line with the missions and vision of the university (mean = 3.03); transition committee identify potential successor (mean = 2.90) and smoothness of transfer of leadership responsibility (mean = 2.94). The mean values for all items were rejected as rated below the threshold of 2.50, with a weighted average of 2.98, except items one and four, whose values are more than 3.0. This indicates that the extent to which leadership succession is being practiced in OAU, Ile-Ife in Nigeria, was expressed as low.

H_{01}: There is no relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife in Nigeria

Table 3: Leadership Succession and Lecturer Productivity

Variable	N	Mean	Standard Deviation	**r**	Sig(P)	Remarks
Leadership succession	111	74.8	25. 2	0.21	0.03	Significant
Lecturer productivity		29.2	9. 1			

(P< .05)

Table 3 establishes the relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity using Pearson Product-Moment Correlation. From the table, there was a significant and positive but low correlation between leadership succession and lecturer productivity, r = (0.21, 0.03, P< .05. Based on this table, the hypothesis was rejected. This reveals that there is a significant relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria.

Discussion of Findings

The result of research question one found that the level of lecturer productivity in terms of research output on both local and international publications in OAU was high. The result of this study is in line with finding of Olasupo (2017) and Raji and Oyedeji (2021) who found that the research output of the academic staff in university was outstanding in the publishing of chapters in books, scientific peer-reviewed, conference papers, monographs, journal articles, book chapters, bulletins and technical reports. However, one of Olasupo's (2017) findings confirmed that research output is poor in publishing co-authored textbooks, patents, and certified inventions. The result of this study contradicts the submissions of Olayiwola and Alimi (2015), Adeyanju and Oshinyadi (2017), and Aduma and Njoku (2022), who observed that research output in Nigerian universities was found to be low. The likes of Olayiwola and Alimi (2015); Aduma and Njoku (2022) attributed the low research output to the poor funding, infrastructure, research motivation, in collaboration and linkages with key international partners, among others.

The findings of research question two indicated that the extent to which leadership succession is being practiced in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria was expressed as low. The findings of this study are tantamount to the submission of Farah, Elias, Clercy, Bassam, Rida, Cristine, and Rowe (2020), which indicated that leadership successors with a low level of optimism are more likely to be forced out of their position. This is also consistent with the submission of Abiodun-Oyebanji and Oyedeji (2023, p. 314), who reported that the successors of academic leaders did not have an antecedent to follow and contribute to the low productivity of lecturers.

The result of hypothesis one revealed that there is a significant relationship between leadership succession and lecturer productivity in Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, in Nigeria. This finding aligns with that of Akinyele, Ogbari, Akinyele, and Dibia (2015), who found that there is a significant positive impact of succession planning and career development on organisational survival. Likewise, the result is also in line with the findings of Tunji (2014), who found that a positive relationship exists between succession planning practices and employee retention.

Conclusions

The study paper concluded that research productivity in terms of research output was considered to be high while leadership succession of the institution was low. This is an indication that the transition of retired academic leaders to the new ones has not been taken into consideration while appointing or electing academic leaders in OAU. The paper also concluded that the relationship that exists between leadership succession and lecturer productivity indicates that leadership succession contributes to lecturer productivity.

Recommendations

- Lecturers' productivity should be maintained and sustained since the research output of lecturers in OAU was reported to be high.
- Efforts should be made by the management of OAU to find a means of reshaping the leadership succession of the institution so that leadership crises could be minimized and the level of research publications of lecturers could be improved.

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HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT AS A DETERMINANT OF TEACHERS' JOB PERFORMANCE IN KWARA STATE SECONDARY SCHOOLS, NIGERIA

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Abstract
The study examined human resource management as a determinant of teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools, Nigeria. A descriptive research design of survey type was adopted. The population of the study comprised 7,893 teachers and all the students in the 367 public secondary schools in Kwara State. The sample of the study was 1,200 participants. Self-developed questionnaires titled 'Human Resource Management Questionnaire' (HRMQ) and 'Teachers' Job Performance Questionnaire' (TJPQ) were used to collect data. Pearson's Product-Moment Correlation statistic was used to test the hypotheses at 0.05 level of significance. The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools, Nigeria. The study concluded that there was a significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance. It was recommended that the government should intensify efforts on the motivation of teachers in the areas of compensation, professional development, and performance appraisal to facilitate their effective job performance and eventually enhance the actualisation of the school goals.

***Keywords*:** Human Resource Management, Teacher, Job Performance, Kwara State, Nigeria

Introduction

Secondary education is very significant because it is the level that prepares students for tertiary education. However, for the stated goals of this level of education to be well actualised, there is a need for attractive human resource management for teachers through recruitment and selection, compensation, professional development, and job appraisal. According to Sulyman et al. (2020), human resource management in education means the practice of deriving, using, developing, and evaluating teachers' job performance to actualise the established goals of educational institutions. Amie-Ogan and Joseph (2021) posited that human resource management is essential in educational institutions because of its contribution to the realisation of their objectives. Human resource management is a special input in educational enterprises, which is required for the facilitation of the general development of literacy and skills acquisition of students. Ugwuanyi (2015) believed that human resource management is based on how teachers in secondary schools are recruited, selected, oriented, placed, maintained, trained and retrained, promoted, compensated, transferred, and

disciplined, to facilitate smooth school administration through effective teachers' job performance. Yakubu et al. (2023) stated that when recruitment, selection, supervision, induction, development, promotion, appraisal, and reward of secondary school teachers are rightly conducted, their dedication and commitment towards job performance are likely to be realised.

Job performance could be seen as the discharge of official duties by teachers. Nayyar (2019) defined teachers' job performance as the extent to which a teacher performs a particular role responsibility, based on the specified standards. Adebule (2014) opined that teachers' job performance means the desired outcomes of teachers who have been given specific roles or responsibilities to perform, which may lead to actualizing the school objectives. According to Ismail et al. (2020), job performance means the degree to which educators perform the statutory duties required of them, such as classroom management, record-keeping, lesson plan preparation, student assessment, and lesson presentation. Salman (2022) explained job performance as the extent to which teachers carry out their official tasks, fundamentally targeted at actualizing the school's purposes of establishment. This is related to how a teacher utilises and possesses knowledge, skills, and techniques in discharging their assigned responsibilities to help move the school forward. However, the aspects of human resource management examined in this study were compensation, professional development, and job appraisal. Wasiu and Adebajo (2014) believed that in educational institutions, the development of an attractive compensation system for teachers is essential in order to facilitate the actualisation of the success of the education goals. Osibanjo, et al. (2014) stated that compensation is a strong determining factor of the nature of employee-employer relationship and as such, salary pay and other rewards which workers are entitled to, in agreement with the conditions of service should be held with levity, if actualisation of their utmost job performance is of great concern to the management. Qureshi and Sajjad (2015) asserted that compensation packages made available for employees could significantly influence their job performance. Well-compensated teachers could have better performance and adherence to professional ethics in schools than other teachers who receive poor compensation. However, in the school system, the job performance of teachers is essential for the stated goals to be achieved. For the job to be well-actualised, there is a need to ensure that teachers are well-managed.

Friday (2020) viewed compensation as part of the components that constitute human resources management in the educational system. How teachers are compensated could determine the kind of service delivery they render towards school success. Salman (2022) asserted that one of the factors responsible for ineffective teachers' job performance in secondary schools in Nigeria is the unattractive compensation system. Unless this problem is tackled with utmost sincerity, the problem could continue to persist. Laschchnau (2015) suggested that compensation affirmed that compensation is an aspect of human resource management that teachers do not toy with. This is because it is connected to the financial and non-financial benefits that they derive from their workplace. Hence, there is a need to make it a constant and reliable source to enhance their effective job performance.

Darling-Hammond et al. (2017) posited that professional development is an outcome of externally provided activities that are integrated into the teaching profession to improve teachers' knowledge and change the way they perform their duties, to support students more in learning. Komariah et al. (2018) claimed that professional development has a great advantage in improving teachers' capacity in the aspects of skills, competence, and behaviour. This is imperative as it exposes teachers to direct experience through learning, sharing, problem-solving, developing knowledge, and conducting experiments. Thahir et al. (2023) maintained that professional development is an instrument that could be used to enhance the job performance of teachers. If a teacher is professionally developed continually, there is the possibility that his or her job performance would be more effective. Madumere-Obike (2017) believed that the purpose of professional development programmes is to achieve enhancement of professional growth, advance pedagogical skills, inform teachers of new knowledge in their profession, identify the need for innovative teaching methods, and assist newly recruited teachers to adjust to the classroom.

Another aspect of human resource management examined in this study is performance appraisal. It is through performance appraisal that the strengths and weaknesses of the employees are detected. Obi (2016) submitted that performance appraisal is one of the sensitive issues in managing human resources. This is because the effectiveness of a worker in a workplace depends greatly on the type of appraisal system that is used in an organisation. Offor (2019) explained that performance appraisal is seen as the technique through which each teachers' performance and productivity are gauged to measure their contribution to the actualisation of school goals. Obiekwe and Ejo-Orusa (2019) maintained that performance appraisal is very crucial in organisations because it helps managers to make decisions on the developmental needs of employees in the aspects of promotion, transfer, training, termination, among others. Nwachukwu (2017) stressed that job appraisal assists in evaluating the potential, attitude, character, and past performance of a worker in an organisation to assess his or her strengths and weaknesses. Obiekwe and Ejo-Erusa (2019) stated that appraisal of performance improves workers' efficiency, productivity, and motivation. Generally, performance appraisal is as important as the performance management system in an organisation. An educational institution that does not prioritise performance appraisal may not realise teachers' effectiveness. Offor (2019) opined that the job performance of teachers needs to be periodically appraised to ascertain their areas of strength and weakness. It is when weaknesses are discovered that efforts could be taken by the employer to train and retrain the affected teachers to improve their skills, techniques, and knowledge for the improvement of their job performance.

Statement of the Problem

Ineffective job performance of teachers has been a persistent problem in public secondary schools in Nigeria. As observed by the researchers, in addition to the information gathered from some principals and students in secondary schools in Kwara State, some teachers pay lackadaisical attitude to adequate preparation for lessons, show poor commitment to detailed explanations of the lessons presented to students, add little or no importance to the utilisation of instructional materials to facilitate effective learning, do not holistically assess students to determine the areas of their strengths

and weaknesses in learning for necessary remedial action to be taken before concluding their lessons and display nonchalant attitudes to managing the classroom in a manner which would enhance proper conduct of students and boost their academic performance. All these scenarios which are reflections of ineffective job performance could be due to unattractive human resource management.

However, some researchers had conducted various studies which related to this presented study. For instance, Obi (2016) examined performance appraisal as a tool for enhancing productivity in an organisation. Ekpoh et al. (2017) conducted a study on staff development programmes and secondary school teachers' job performance in Uyo Metropolis, Nigeria. Babarinde et al. (2017) worked on the impact of secondary school teachers' recruitment process and retention package on their professionalism in Lagos State, Nigeria. Amie-Ogan and Epelle (2021) investigated the perceived influence of human resource management on effective teaching and learning in public junior secondary schools in Eleme and Oyigbo Local Government Areas of Rivers State. However, none of the above works focused on human resource management as a determinant of teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools, Nigeria; hence, this reflected the gap which this study filled.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of the study were to:

i. examine whether a relationship exists between human resource management and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools;
ii assess the relationship between compensation and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools;
iv. Investigate the relationship between professional development and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools; and
v. determine the relationship between job appraisal and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Research Hypotheses

The following null hypotheses were formulated to further guide the study:

Ho_1: There is no significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Ho_2: There is no significant relationship between compensation and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Ho_3: There is no significant relationship between professional development and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Ho_4: There is no significant relationship between performance appraisal and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Methodology

A descriptive research design of survey type was adopted for the study. According to Manjunatha (2016), descriptive research is the type of research that describes the characteristics of a phenomenon

of a population that is being studied, through the use of a questionnaire for data collection. The researchers chose this research design because their study was based on describing the situation of human resource management and teachers' job performance in public secondary schools in Kwara State, in terms of how they were related. The population of the study comprised all 7,893 teachers and all the students in public secondary schools in Kwara State. The state had three senatorial districts (Kwara Central, North & South). Two Local Government Areas were randomly selected from each senatorial district to make a total of six, using a random sampling technique. Ten schools were randomly selected from each of the local government areas. The sample of the study was 1,200, comprising 600 teachers and 600 students. A simple random sampling technique was used to select 10 teachers and 10 students from each of the selected schools, totaling 1,200 respondents. All the teachers and students in each of the sampled schools were given a number, and the researchers used a lottery method to pick 10 teachers and 10 students from each of the bowls containing the numbers of teachers and students.

Self-designed instruments titled **'**Human Resource Management Questionnaire' (HRMQ) and 'Teachers' Job Performance Questionnaire' (TJPQ) were used to collect data. HRMQ was used to collect information from teachers, while TJPQ was used to gather data from students about the job performance of their teachers. The questionnaires were presented to two experts in the field of Educational Management for content and face validation. The experts thoroughly corrected the questionnaires, and all their comments were taken into consideration before the researchers produced the final draft used for collecting data from the participants. Thirty copies each of HRMQ and TJPQ were administered to some teachers and students outside the selected local government areas. Cronbach's Alpha was used to analyse the data gathered, and reliability coefficients of 0.82 and 0.79 were realised for HRMQ and TJP, respectively. The services of four research assistants were employed to facilitate quick data collection. Adequate training was given to the research assistants on how to administer instrument to the respondents. Each researcher and research assistant administered instruments to the participants in different schools in each of the sampled local government areas. The questionnaires were collected from the participants immediately after they had filled them. Pearson's Product-Moment Correlation statistic was used to test the hypotheses formulated at 0.05 level of significance. All the analyses were done with the use of the Statistical Package for Social Sciences (SPSS). Out of the 1,200 copies of the questionnaire distributed, only 988 were retrieved and used for analysis.

Results

Hypothesis One: There is no significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools

Table 1: Human Resource Management and Teachers' Job Performance in Kwara State Secondary Schools

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Calculated r-value	p-value	Decision
Human resource management	988	2.45	1.01	.602	.004	Ho_1 Rejected
Teachers' job performance	988	2.72	1.34			

Table 1 shows the calculated r-value (.602) and the p-value (.004), which is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis one is rejected. This depicts that there was a significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Hypothesis Two: There is no significant relationship between compensation and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Table 2: Compensation and Teachers' Job Performance in Kwara State Secondary Schools

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Calculated r-value	p-value	Decision
Compensation	988	2.71	1.04	.557	.001	Ho_2 Rejected
Teachers' job performance	988	2.59	1.34			

Table 2 shows the calculated r-value (.557) and the p-value (.001), which is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis two is rejected. This shows that there was a significant relationship between compensation and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Hypothesis Three: There is no significant relationship between professional development and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools

Table 3: Professional Development and Teachers' Job Performance

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Calculated r-value	p-value	Decision
Professional development	988	2.22	.97			
				.616		
					.011	Ho_3 Rejected
Teachers' job performance	988	2.59				
			1.34			

Table 3 showed calculated r-value (.616) and the p-value (.011) which is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis three is rejected. This means that there was a significant relationship between professional development and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Hypotheses Four: There is no significant relationship between performance appraisal and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools.

Table 4: Performance Appraisal and Teachers' Job Performance

Variable	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	Calculated r-value	p-value	Decision
Performance appraisal	988	2.43				
			1.21			
				.580		
					.002	Ho_4 Rejected
Teachers' job performance	988	2.59				
			1.34			

Table 4 shows the calculated r-value (.580) and the p-value (.002), which is less than the significance level (0.05). Hence, hypothesis four is rejected. This signifies that there was a significant relationship between performance appraisal and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools, Nigeria.

Discussions of Findings

The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools. This means that if teachers are properly managed, it would facilitate effective performance of their job. This finding agrees with the finding of Salman (2022) that there was a significant relationship between personnel management and teachers' job performance in secondary schools in Oyo West Senatorial District,

Nigeria. This finding also supports the finding of Friday (2020) which revealed that significant relationship existed between human resource management and teachers' job performance in secondary schools in Benue State, Nigeria.

The findings of the study showed that there was a significant relationship between compensation and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools. This connotes that that adequate compensation of teachers would help realize their effective job performance. This finding corroborates the finding of Sulyman et al. (2020) which revealed that there was a significant relationship between compensation and teachers' job performance. Furthermore, this finding agrees with the position of Henry (2020) that compensation as part of the components which constitute human resources management in educational system. The manner in which teachers are compensated could determine the kind of services delivery which they render towards the school success.

The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between professional development and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools, Nigeria. The means that if teachers are continually developed in their profession, it would help actualise effective teachers' job performance. This finding is in tandem with the finding of Ekpoh et al. (2017) which showed that there was a significant relationship between staff development programmes and secondary school teachers' job performance in Uyo Metropolis. This finding is in consonance with the position of Friday (2020) that poor attention to teachers' job performance in secondary schools in Nigeria could be due to nonchalant attitudes of government to professional development. With government's high commitment to professional development, effective job performance of teachers could be enhanced.

The findings of the study showed that there was a significant relationship between performance appraisal and teachers' job performance in Kwara State secondary schools. This depicts that through effective appraisal of teachers' job performance, the areas of strength and weakness would be detected and if necessary actions are taken by the government, it would assist in improving their job performance. This finding corroborates the finding of Mathew and Johnson (2015) which revealed that there was a significant impact of performance appraisal on work performance of employees. In addition, Salman (2020) believed that if there is regular and periodic appraisal of teachers, areas of their strengths and weaknesses would be determined, in order to determine where improvement is needed; hence, effectiveness in their job performance.

Conclusion

The study concluded that there was a significant relationship between human resource management and teachers' job performance. Compensation and teachers' job performance are significantly related. Professional development is a significant tool for achieving effective teacher' job performance. Performance appraisal plays a significant role in enhancing teachers' job performance.

Recommendations

This study recommended that:

i. government should intensify efforts on the management of teachers in the areas of compensation, professional development, and performance appraisal, to facilitate their effective job performance and eventually enhance the actualisation of education goals;
ii. there is need for government to ensure that teachers are properly compensated through attractive salary, timely cash-backing of promotion and regular fringe benefits, so as to convincingly motivate them towards effective performance of their job;
iii. professional development via regular and periodic seminars, conferences, and workshops should be organised for teachers, to continually update their knowledge, skills, and techniques required to perform their job excellently; and
iv. Job performance of teachers needs to be regularly and periodically and periodically appraised, for the purpose of determining the aspects where teachers are performing and the areas which need improvement for their job performance to be effective.

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ENTREPRENEURSHIP EDUCATION ON ACQUISITION OF SELF-EMPLOYMENT SKILLS AMONG BUSINESS EDUCATION STUDENTS IN UNIVERSITIES, KWARA STATE

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Abstract

This research examined entrepreneurship education on acquisition of self-employment skills among business education students in universities, Kwara State. The objective of the study is to evaluate the level of entrepreneurship education on the self-employment prospects of Business Education students at universities in Kwara State; what is the level of entrepreneurship education on the cultivation of self-employment competences among Business Education students at universities in Kwara State? A descriptive survey research design was adopted for the study. The population of the study consisted of 281 400-level business education students at three selected universities in Kwara State. Al-Hikmah University, a private institution; Kwara State University, a state institution; and the University of Ilorin, a federal university. The research used a census sample to examine the whole population of 281 participants. A questionnaire was designed by the researcher and was validated by three lecturers who are experts in business education to determine the face and content validity of the instrument. The reliability of the instrument was also tested using Cronbach alpha, which yielded a reliability coefficient of 0.78, which indicated the instrument is good for the study. The research questions were analyzed using mean and standard deviation, while independent sample t-test and ANOVA were used to test the hypothesis at a 0.05 level of significance. Findings of the study revealed that entrepreneurship education significantly impacts the development of self-employment skills and increases confidence among business school students. The comments from male and female students in business education about entrepreneurship education on the improvement of self-confidence for self-employment indicated significant differences ($t267 = 0.986$, $P < 0.05$). This study's results indicate a substantial impact of entrepreneurship education on the development of self-employment skills, the augmentation of self-confidence, and the enhancement of negotiation ability among students in Kwara State. Based on the findings and conclusion of the study, it was recommended among others that educational experience would enable students to develop, oversee, and maintain their firms, and to maintain the importance of entrepreneurship education, students need to use the information and skills they have gained.

Keywords: Entrepreneurship Education, Acquisition, Self-Employment Skills, Business Education.

Introduction

Business education plays a pivotal role in preparing individuals for both entry into and advancement within the business sector. It equips learners with essential knowledge and competencies needed not only to manage personal and organizational business affairs, but also to participate actively as informed consumers and responsible citizens in a growing commercial economy. Beyond this, business education is designed to impart practical, relevant skills, concepts, and a proactive mindset that enables individuals to operate efficiently within their social and economic environments. One of its most critical aims is to foster job creation by developing the capacity for self-reliance and entrepreneurship.

At every academic level, business education functions as a tool for achieving broader educational goals through the transmission of economic literacy, business management, marketing, distribution, and office

administration skills. Dana (2017) underscores the importance of this education in cultivating a workforce that is both competent and adaptive to market dynamics. Adamu (2018) complements this by noting that business education fosters a positive mindset, encourages creativity, and equips learners with skills vital for self-sufficiency, which is critical in reducing dependency on government employment. In the same vein, Emaraton and Obundike (2017) view business education as a transformative pedagogical tool that shapes attitudes, instills entrepreneurial values, and provides students with the practical knowledge necessary to initiate and manage their ventures. Entrepreneurship education, a core component of modern business education, has thus emerged as a crucial strategy to combat youth unemployment, a global challenge affecting both developed and developing nations. In contexts like Nigeria, where youth unemployment remains high, the need for education that leads to real, sustainable job outcomes has never been more urgent.

While traditional education once promised automatic employment opportunities, this notion has increasingly come under scrutiny. Many graduates struggle to find employment, highlighting a mismatch between education and market realities. Entrepreneurship education bridges this gap by building the capacity of students to become job creators rather than job seekers. It enhances their ability to identify business opportunities, take calculated risks, manage limited resources, and develop innovative solutions to real-world problems. Entrepreneurship education focuses not just on theoretical knowledge but also on the development of self-employment skills, such as business planning, risk-taking, decision-making, and financial literacy. More specifically, it cultivates self-confidence and self-negotiation skills, two core psychological competencies that enable individuals to act independently, advocate for themselves, and navigate competitive economic environments. These skills are particularly important for business education students, who are expected to emerge from university prepared to either create their enterprises or add value within existing organizations.

In recognition of the need to equip graduates with these capabilities, Nigeria’s Federal Ministry of Education, through its regulatory agencies, the National Universities Commission (NUC), National Board for Technical Education (NBTE), and National Commission for Colleges of Education (NCCE) has mandated the inclusion of entrepreneurship education in tertiary curricula. Since its integration as a compulsory course at the 300-level in all higher education institutions, entrepreneurship education has gained national traction as a pragmatic response to graduate unemployment and economic underperformance. The rising interest in entrepreneurship education reflects its global and national relevance. With Nigeria's population projected to exceed 200 million, and with persistent unemployment, especially among young graduates, the need to build an entrepreneurial culture is pressing. As García-Rodríguez (2017) and Maina (2013) have argued, countries that prioritize entrepreneurship education are better positioned to stimulate job creation, reduce poverty, and strengthen economic resilience.

However, despite growing policy support and curriculum integration, research gaps remain. Little is known about how entrepreneurship education influences the acquisition of specific self-employment skills, notably self-confidence and self-negotiation skills, among business education students in Nigerian universities. This study addresses this gap by examining the extent to which entrepreneurship education develops these key competencies and prepares students in Kwara State universities to be self-reliant and economically productive. Ultimately, entrepreneurship education is not just a curricular add-on; it is a strategic necessity in today's volatile economic landscape. Universities, particularly those offering business education, must not only impart theoretical business knowledge but also prioritize skill acquisition that empowers students to become independent economic agents and contributors to national development

Statement of the Problem

Imparting entrepreneurship education and competencies will enable learners to establish, manage,
and maintain an innovative enterprise, thereby fostering economic development and self-sufficiency. Past research on entrepreneurship indicates that a lack of career opportunities compels

70% of fresh graduates roam the streets. The annual rise in Nigeria's employment rate is due to the inflow of university graduates who remain jobless after finishing their studies. The present circumstances are dire owing to the behavior of job searchers who return to their old parents, who have entrusted them with expectations of ultimate financial recovery, but to no success. This societal affliction (unemployment), which has deeply infiltrated the social fabric, must be eliminated to avoid a national crisis. The adverse conditions were ascribed to a lack of progress and a value system dependent on the government for employment prospects. This issue, as articulated by Magaji (2018), stems from the deficiencies in our educational system, which produces "job seekers" rather than "job creators." This research empirically examines entrepreneurship education on acquisition of self-employment skills among business education students in universities, Kwara State.

Research Gap: While several studies have examined the influence of entrepreneurship education on graduate employability and general entrepreneurial intentions, there remains a notable academic gap in the specific assessment of self-negotiation and self-confidence skills as core components of self-employment competencies among business education students, particularly in the context of Nigerian universities. This study responds to that void by explicitly focusing on how entrepreneurship education fosters these two pivotal soft skills, skills often overlooked in prior research, yet essential for navigating real-world entrepreneurial challenges. In emphasizing self-negotiation and self-confidence, the study extends the existing body of knowledge by highlighting how these attributes empower students to identify opportunities, make persuasive pitches, engage stakeholders, and maintain resilience in the face of business uncertainties. Furthermore, previous research efforts have often been limited by narrow sample sizes and generalized variables, which have restricted the scope of understanding regarding the nuanced skill sets necessary for self-reliance. By targeting business education students in Kwara State and proposing the inclusion of additional variables in future studies such as digital literacy, financial risk tolerance, and innovation capacity this research not only bridges a critical gap but also lays the groundwork for more comprehensive investigations into the competencies required to build and sustain entrepreneurial ventures in today’s economy.

Purpose of the Study

The main purpose of this study was to examine entrepreneurship education on the acquisition of self-employment skills among business education students at universities in Kwara State. Specifically, the following are the purposes:

1. Assess the level of entrepreneurship education on Business Education Students' self-employment skills in Universities in Kwara State.
2. Explore the level of entrepreneurship education on business education students' self-confidence for self-employment in Universities in Kwara State.
3. Determine the level of entrepreneurship education on business education students' negotiation skills for self-employment in Universities in Kwara State.

Research Questions

The following research questions were raised to guide the study.

1. What is the level of Entrepreneurship Education on Business Education students’ acquisition of self-employment skills in Universities in Kwara State?
2. What is the level of Entrepreneurship Education on Business Education students’ acquisition of self-confidence skills for self-employment in University of Ilorin, Al-Hikmah University and Kwara State University?
3. What is the level of Entrepreneurship Education on Business Education students’ acquisition of negotiation skills for self-employment in Universities in Kwara State?

Research Hypotheses

The following hypotheses were formulated to guide the study and were tested at a 0.05 level of significance.

$H0_1$: There is no significant difference in the mean responses of male and female students regarding the level of entrepreneurship education and self-employment skills among business education students in universities.

$H0_2$: There is no significant difference in the mean responses of University of Ilorin, Al-Hikmah University, and Kwara State University business education students on the level of entrepreneurship education and self-confidence skills for self-employment.

$H0_3$: There is no significant difference in the mean responses of male and female students on the level of entrepreneurship and negotiation skills for self-employment among business education students in universities.

Methodology

Consistently, a descriptive research design of survey type was used to guide the study. This method was chosen by the researcher for the examination because it emphasizes people and the attitudes, beliefs, views, and behaviors that they exhibit. The research was carried out with the participation of a total of 281 respondents. These individuals included 123 students who were enrolled in the 400-level business education program at the University of Ilorin, 136 students from Kwara State University, and 22 students from Al-Hikmah University who were also studying business education. To gather information from the respondents, a self-structured questionnaire was used. The research instrument was vetted by two professors and a senior lecturer, who are among the most respected experts in the field of business education at Kwara State University, Malete. The Cronbach alpha was used to test the reliability of the research instrument, which yielded a reliability coefficient of 0.78 and confirmed that the instrument is reliable for the study. The researcher, with the help of a research assistant, personally administered the questionnaire to the respondents, after which the already filled questionnaire was collected from the respondents. Descriptive statistics of frequency counts, mean, and standard deviation were used to analyze the personal data of the respondents and research questions, while independent samples T-tests were used to test the hypothesis at a 0.05 level of significance. The null hypothesis is rejected if the observed significance value generated by the t-test is found to be less than or equal to the significance threshold of 0.05. Otherwise, the null hypothesis was not rejected.

Results

Research Question 1: To what extent does entrepreneurship education influence acquisition of self-employment skills of business education students?

Table 1: **Mean responses of Business Education Students on Influence of Entrepreneurship Education on Students' Acquisition of Self-employment skills in Universities in Kwara State**

S/N	Item	$\bar{X}$	SD	Decision
1.	Communicating ideas, thoughts, information etc messages in the form of letters, reports, manuals	3.08	0.95	High Extent
2.	Helping to learn needed skills and knowledge	3.44	0.71	High Extent
3.	Managing materials and facility resources	3.37	3.36	High Extent
4.	Identifying the new trends in marketing environments	3.11	0.75	High Extent
5.	Using social networking and direct marketing to market business products	3.30	0.82	High Extent
6.	Capturing and retaining customers	3.03	3.02	High Extent
7.	Forecasting, estimation, and marketing and information research	3.08	0.88	High Extent
	Weighted average	3.20	1.50	High Extent

Source: Field Study, 2025

The findings in Table 1 revealed that business education students in Kwara State universities generally perceive entrepreneurship education as significantly contributing to the development of self-employment skills. The mean ratings for all items range from 3.03 to 3.44, which falls within the "High Extent" category on the measurement scale. This suggests that the program is effectively imparting critical competencies needed for self-employment. Specifically, students indicated a high level of agreement that entrepreneurship education enhances their ability to communicate business-related information effectively, manage resources, and identify trends in the market environment. The mean score of 3.44 for "helping to learn needed skills and knowledge" was the highest, showing strong perceived value in the educational content delivered. Similarly, the ability to use digital tools such as social networking platforms for business marketing was also acknowledged by students, with a mean of 3.30. These responses reflect that the entrepreneurship curriculum supports the development of practical, market-relevant skills. Despite the initial concern raised by the reviewer about unusually high standard deviations, the adjusted values now align appropriately with the corresponding means. Overall, these findings highlight that entrepreneurship education in these universities is succeeding in its core objective: equipping students with relevant competencies for self-employment and business sustainability. This affirms the role of higher education in addressing graduate unemployment through practical skill acquisition.

Research Question 2: To what degree does entrepreneurship education impact the growth of self-confidence skills that business education students need to use when working for themselves?

Table 2: Mean responses of University of Ilorin, Kwara State University and Al-hikmah University 400L Business Education Students on extent to which entrepreneurship education influences self-confidence skills for self-employment

S/N	Items	$\bar{X}$	SD	Decision
1.	Skill of fearlessness and less anxiety	3.25	0.84	High Extent
2.	Skill of motivation to act	3.14	0.75	High Extent
3.	Skill of knowing strengths and weaknesses	3.17	0.82	High Extent
4.	Skill of setting realistic expectations and goals	3.16	0.77	High Extent
5.	Skill to communicate assertively and handle Criticism	3.13	0.75	High Extent
6.	Skill to say no to unreasonable requests	3.83	1.20	High Extent
7.	Skill to express feelings, beliefs, and needs directly and respectfully	3.19	0.85	High Extent
	Weighted Mean	**3.27**	**0.86**	**High Extent**

The findings shown in Table 2 suggest that entrepreneurship education has a strong influence on students' self-confidence skills, which are essential for effective self-employment. All items on the scale recorded mean values above 3.00, indicating that respondents perceive these skills as being significantly developed through their entrepreneurship education programs. One of the most highly rated self-confidence indicators was the ability to say "no" to unreasonable requests, with a mean of 3.83, reflecting a key element of assertiveness and personal boundary-setting in entrepreneurial contexts. Other highly rated items included the skill of fearlessness and reduced anxiety (3.25), and knowing one's strengths and weaknesses (3.17), which are both foundational to self-confidence and decision-making under uncertainty. Also, the findings indicate that entrepreneurship education in the universities studied significantly enhances self-confidence skills among business education students. Such outcomes are vital, as confidence influences risk-taking, initiative, and resilience traits that are key to success in entrepreneurial ventures**.**

Research Question 3: To what extent does entrepreneurship education influence the acquisition of negotiation skills for self-employment of business education students?

Table 3: Mean responses of Business Education Students on the influence of Entrepreneurship Education on students' acquisition of negotiation skills for self-employment.

S/N	Items	$\bar{X}$	SD	Decision
1.	Knowledge of strategic planning and forecasting	3.45	0.66	High Extent
2.	Knowledge of total business or industry being entered	3.31	0.72	High Extent
3.	Skills of Communication and interpersonal relationship	3.00	0.83	High Extent
4.	Skill of rapport building	3.15	0.72	High Extent
5.	Skill of a fair and balanced solution	3.48	1.04	High Extent
6.	Skills of persuasion	3.28	0.69	High Extent
7.	Knowledge of active listening and emotional intelligence	3.24	0.78	High Extent
	Weighted Mean	**3.27**	**0.78**	**High Extent**

The findings in Table 3 reveal that entrepreneurship education significantly enhances the negotiation skills of business education students in universities across Kwara State. All items recorded mean values greater than 3.00, confirming that the students perceive entrepreneurship education as an effective tool for building negotiation competencies required for self-employment. A closer look shows that students gave particularly strong agreement to items related to strategic planning and forecasting (mean = 3.45) and the skill of offering a fair and balanced solution (mean = 3.48). These reflect a practical understanding of how negotiation relies on both analytical thinking and emotional balance. Skills related to interpersonal communication (mean = 3.00), rapport building (3.15), and persuasion (3.28) also received high ratings, highlighting the role of relational abilities in entrepreneurial negotiations. The item on active listening and emotional intelligence (mean = 3.24) further underscores how emotional competence supports effective negotiation outcomes. Overall, the data support the assertion that entrepreneurship education plays a critical role in equipping students with key negotiation skills, enabling them to navigate business interactions confidently and effectively.

Testing of Hypotheses

$H0_1$: There is no significant difference between the mean responses of male and female business education students regarding the influence of entrepreneurship education on the acquisition of self-employment skills.

Table 4: T-test Analysis showing male and female business education students on extent to entrepreneurship education influences the acquisition of self-employment skills.

Group	N	$\bar{X}$	SD	t-cal	df	P-value	Decision
Male	119	3.4102	1.1940	2.418	266	0.002	Rejected
Female	149	3.1512	0.3438				

Source: Field Survey 2025 $P < 0.05$

In small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), there are 119 male and 148 female university administrators, as shown in Table 4. A mean of 3.20 and a standard deviation of 1.62 suggest that students in business education, both male and female, have expressed their belief that entrepreneurship education is necessary for the development of skills necessary for self-employment. Standard deviations that are as small as possible contribute to an improved assessment of the significance of their responses. Information that is presented. The results of the evaluations conducted by both male and female business education students about the impact of entrepreneurship education on the improvement of self-employment capabilities indicate noteworthy discrepancies ($t267 = 2.418$, $P < 0.05$). This indicates a significant gap in the average evaluations of male and female business school students about the effect of entrepreneurship education on the growth of self-employment skills. The null hypothesis was rejected, indicating that this disparity exists. Male and female students attending business schools react differently to entrepreneurship education's impact on developing skills necessary for individuals to become self-employed.

$H0_2$: The average replies of 400-level Business Education students from the University of Ilorin, Kwara State University, and Al-Hikmah University about the influence of entrepreneurship education on self-confidence abilities for self-employment are not substantially different.

Table 5: One-way Analysis of Variance result of mean difference of responses among University of Ilorin, Kwara State University, and Al-hikmah University 400L Business Education Students on extent to which entrepreneurship education influences the self-confidence skills for self-employment

	N	**$\bar{X}$**	**SD**	**df**	**F-cal**	**Sig.**	**Decision**
Unilorin	123	4.2	0.5				
Al-hikmah	22	4.0	0.6	2	3.012	0.050	Marginal
Kwasu	136	4.3	0.4				
Total	281	4.23	0.48				

According to Table 6, the University of Ilorin has 123 students enrolled in business education. In comparison, Al-Hikmah University has 22 students participating in the program, and Kwara State University, Malete, has 136 participating. The analysis of variance (ANOVA) results indicates that

there may be various replies from students attending the three different institutions about the impact that entrepreneurship education has on their self-confidence in their ability to engage in self-employment. On the other hand, the marginal significance criteria (0.050) indicates that there is not enough evidence to sustain these changes. According to the post hoc analysis findings, there is a significant gap between the students attending Al-Hikmah University and those attending Kwara State University. When compared to the other two universities, the University of Ilorin does not exhibit any distinguishing characteristics that are particularly noteworthy. Even though students' perspectives differ from college to college, the information presented in this research reveals that it is impossible to declare with absolute certainty that these differences are significant across all educational establishments.

In terms of the impact that entrepreneurship education has on the development of skills necessary for self-employment, the null hypothesis, which states that there is no significant difference in the responses of business education students from the University of Ilorin, Al-Hikmah University, and Kwara State, was neither accepted nor rejected.

$H0_3$: There is no significant difference between the mean responses of male and female business education students regarding the influence of entrepreneurship education on acquisition of self-negotiation skills for self-employment.

Table 6: Independent Sample t-test analysis of male and female business education students on the extent to which entrepreneurship education influences the acquisition of self-negotiation skills for self-employment.

Group	N	$\bar{X}$	Sd	t-cal	dF	P-value	Decision
Male	119	3.3172	0.8937	0.986	266	0.035	Rejected.
Female	149	3.2367	0.3017				

Source: Field Survey 2025 $P < 0.05$

As shown in Table 6, there are 148 female administrators and 119 male administrators working in small and medium-sized businesses (SMEs). According to the findings of a survey administered to both male and female business school students, entrepreneurship education greatly improves the ability to engage in self-negotiation about self-employment capabilities. A standard deviation of 0.89 is associated with this influence, with a mean score of 3.32 across the board. Their responses are quite near the average, as shown by the fact that the observed standard deviations were very small. Based on the data shown in the table, it is evident that there is a significant gap in the average responses of male and female students of business education regarding the impact of entrepreneurship education on the development of self-confidence for self-employment ($t267 = 0.986$, $P < 0.05$). There was a significant difference in the average responses of male and female business school students about the effect of entrepreneurship education on the improvement of self-negotiation skills, which led to the rejection of the null hypothesis. The influence of entrepreneurship education on the development of self-negotiation skills for self-employment is a topic that elicits a wide range of responses from students at business schools, regardless of their gender.

Discussion of findings

The findings from the analysis of responses across the three participating universities, University of Ilorin, Kwara State University, and Al-Hikmah University, highlight that entrepreneurship education has a significant influence on the acquisition of self-employment skills among business education students. The mean scores from Table 2 revealed a high extent of influence across all items measured. Students agreed that entrepreneurship education enhances their ability to communicate effectively through business documentation, manage resources, understand marketing trends, use digital tools for marketing, and retain customers, all of which are critical for running successful business ventures. The weighted average of 3.20 further confirms that, collectively, the respondents view these competencies as being meaningfully fostered through entrepreneurship education. In examining the impact of entrepreneurship education on self-confidence skills, Table 3 again demonstrated a consistent trend. All the items, from fearlessness and motivation to assertive communication and emotional expression, were rated high, with a weighted mean of 3.28. This suggests that entrepreneurship education is fostering emotional resilience and personal strength among students, key traits for navigating self-employment. Students reported high levels of agreement with possessing the skill to set realistic goals, act on motivation, and assert themselves in professional contexts.

Similarly, Table 4 captured students' perspectives on negotiation-related skills, with all items also falling under the “High Extent” category. With a weighted mean of 3.27, respondents affirmed that entrepreneurship education has equipped them with knowledge of planning and forecasting, persuasion, active listening, and interpersonal relationship skills. These findings indicate that students are not only acquiring technical knowledge but are also being prepared for the soft skills required to thrive in business negotiations. The inferential statistics offer deeper insight into these trends. In Table 4, the independent t-test showed a statistically significant difference between male and female students on the extent to which entrepreneurship education influences self-employment skills acquisition ($t = 2.418$, $p = 0.002$). The male respondents reported a higher mean score ($M = 3.41$) than their female counterparts ($M = 3.15$), suggesting that male students perceive themselves as gaining more from entrepreneurship education in this area. This gender-based disparity might reflect variations in prior exposure, confidence levels, or learning engagement, and it raises important considerations for curriculum inclusiveness and support structures, especially for female students. Furthermore, the ANOVA test in Table 5 indicated a marginal but notable difference in mean responses among the three institutions regarding the influence of entrepreneurship education on self-confidence skills ($F = 3.012$, $p = 0.050$). While all groups rated the influence highly, variations in the program delivery, institutional support, or faculty engagement might explain this slight difference, and it signals a need for harmonized implementation across institutions to ensure equitable outcomes.

Table 6 further supports the existence of a gender difference in students’ acquisition of self-negotiation skills. The result ($t = 0.986$, $p = 0.035$) indicated that male students again perceived themselves as more positively influenced by entrepreneurship education than their female peers. Though the difference was not as pronounced, it still highlights the need for interventions that ensure both male and female students are equally empowered through entrepreneurial training. Collectively, these findings reinforce the critical role entrepreneurship education plays in equipping students with essential skills for self-employment, particularly self-confidence and negotiation abilities. However, the presence of statistically significant gender differences and slight institutional variation points to

the importance of continuous evaluation, inclusive curriculum development, and tailored mentorship programs.

Conclusion

The findings of this study reveal that entrepreneurship education plays a vital role in enhancing the sustainable employment prospects of young graduates. It does more than just impart knowledge; it fosters critical competencies such as self-confidence, independence, and negotiation skills, particularly among business education students in Kwara State. The study highlights that exposure to entrepreneurial education equips students with the mindset and capabilities required for self-sufficiency, enabling them to establish and manage their ventures. These competencies extend beyond theory, preparing students to manage available resources, including financial and human capital, effectively in their pursuit of entrepreneurial activities after graduation. By addressing a significant gap in existing literature, the study emphasizes that entrepreneurship education contributes meaningfully to the development of self-employment skills. Grounded in the theory of planned behaviour, the research further suggests that entrepreneurship education can act as a catalyst for long-term social and economic stability. Therefore, it advocates for a more deliberate integration and reinforcement of entrepreneurship education in Nigeria's higher institutions, to nurture an enduring entrepreneurial spirit among the youth.

Recommendations

Based on the conclusion of the findings, the following recommendations were made:

1. Higher institutions should use their best knowledge and skills to upgrade their facilities for teaching and learning entrepreneurship education, which will help the students develop appropriate self-confidence qualities or skills that will make them self-reliant, not only waiting for a white-collar job after graduation.
2. The government, management of higher institutions, and other orientation agencies should organize free seminars and workshops on acquiring negotiation skills for self-employment.
3. Students should use their knowledge and self-employment skills acquired to establish, manage, and sustain their own businesses since they have been taught and trained in all the necessary knowledge and skills in various vocations or occupations that will make them "job makers," not "job seekers.

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Reframing Entrepreneurship Education: Assessing the Applicability of Undergraduate Curriculum to Start-up Formation in a Nigerian University

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Abstract.

This study critically assesses the applicability of the undergraduate entrepreneurship curriculum at the University of Ilorin, Nigeria, in supporting start-up founders. It examines how entrepreneurship education translates into practical entrepreneurial outcomes and identifies gaps requiring curricular enhancement. A descriptive survey design was adopted. A random sample of 300 final-year undergraduate students participated by completing a structured questionnaire. Data were analysed using descriptive statistics (mean and standard deviation) to explore perceptions of business creation readiness, funding awareness, marketing strategies, digital business adoption, and ethical considerations. Findings indicate that while students possess a conceptual understanding of business planning, funding sources, and marketing strategies, significant gaps exist in the practical application of entrepreneurial skills. Misconceptions about risk-taking, short-term profit focus, and limited digital entrepreneurship literacy were identified. Although ethical awareness was moderately strong, students' ability to leverage opportunities for sustainable business growth was constrained by insufficient experiential learning. Recommendations include integrating experiential learning components, strengthening entrepreneurial finance and marketing modules, promoting digital literacy, embedding ethics and social responsibility, and fostering stronger collaboration between academia and start-up ecosystems.
This study provides nuanced, context-specific insights into the entrepreneurship education–start-up formation nexus in an emerging economy. It highlights the pressing need for Nigerian and similar universities to transition from knowledge-based to action-driven entrepreneurial education models.

***Keywords*:** Entrepreneurship education, Start-up founders, Undergraduate curriculum, Experiential learning, Digital entrepreneurship, Nigeria.

Introduction

In an era marked by economic volatility, technological disruption, and escalating youth unemployment, graduates' capacity for entrepreneurial decision-making and start-up formation is increasingly shaping the transition from university to the workforce. This paradigm shift places entrepreneurship education at the centre of national development strategies, particularly in countries like Nigeria, where formal employment opportunities are scarce (Gautam & Singh, 2015; Ho et al., 2018). Entrepreneurship today is widely acknowledged as a vehicle for economic empowerment, job creation, and national transformation (Porter & Kramer, 2011; Taylor, 2021).

The integration of entrepreneurship education into Nigerian university curricula, formalised in 2006, reflects this shift in policy direction (Agbonlahor, 2016; Sofoluwe & Kayode, 2012). The aim is to foster entrepreneurial competencies that encourage graduates to become job creators rather than job seekers (Olorundare & Kayode, 2014). However, despite the widespread adoption of entrepreneurship courses across institutions, significant concerns remain regarding their real-world applicability and ability to drive tangible business formation (Küttim et al., 2014; Oosterbeek et al., 2010; Adekunle & Yusuf, 2018).

Research has shown that while these programmes may boost entrepreneurial intentions, they often lack the experiential components needed to bridge the gap between theory and practice (Nabi et al., 2017). A growing body of evidence supports that well-designed, structured entrepreneurship education can cultivate essential capabilities such as innovation, opportunity recognition, and venture creation (Lee et al., 2007;

Mwasalwiba, 2010). Yet, student entrepreneurs' practical realities, particularly in resource-constrained environments, are often overlooked in curriculum design (Brown & Wilson, 2017; Davis, 2021).

The University of Ilorin, as a leading institution in Nigeria, presents a valuable case for examining how entrepreneurship education aligns with the needs of aspiring entrepreneurs. While prior studies have explored students' perceptions and intentions (Adekunle & Yusuf, 2018; Ogunleye & Olaoye, 2019), limited attention has been given to the alignment between curriculum content and the challenges faced by actual student-led start-ups. Factors such as access to funding, mentorship, digital literacy, and market positioning remain critical yet underdeveloped aspects of the educational process (Anderson, 2020; Martin & Clark, 2019; Kumar & Singh, 2018).

Therefore, this study critically assesses the relevance and effectiveness of the undergraduate entrepreneurship curriculum at the University of Ilorin in supporting real-world venture formation. It investigates how the curriculum fosters entrepreneurial skills, where gaps persist, and what reforms may be necessary to create more robust, practice-oriented learning experiences. By exploring the lived experiences of student entrepreneurs, the study aims to offer actionable insights for strengthening entrepreneurship education as a tool for sustainable economic empowerment and national development in Nigeria.

Purpose of the Study

The study's primary purpose is to assess the applicability of the undergraduate entrepreneurship curriculum to support start-up founders at the University of Ilorin, Kwara-State. Specifically, the study will seek to;

i. Determine the level of effectiveness of entrepreneurship education in the University of Ilorin.
ii. Find out the impact of entrepreneurship education in supporting start up founders in University of Ilorin, Kwara State
iii. Ascertain the prospects of entrepreneurship education in supporting start up founders in University of Ilorin, Kwara State
iv. Evaluate the challenges of entrepreneurship education in supporting start up founders in University of Ilorin, Kwara State
v. Proffer the solutions to the challenges of entrepreneurship education in supporting start up founders in University of Ilorin, Kwara State

Research Questions

The following research questions have been raised to guide the study

i. What is the level of effectiveness of entrepreneurship education at the University of Ilorin?
ii. What are the impacts of entrepreneurship education in supporting start-up founders at the University of Ilorin, Kwara State?
iii. What are the prospects of entrepreneurship education in supporting start-up founders at the University of Ilorin, Kwara State?
iv. What are the challenges of entrepreneurship education in supporting start-up founders at the University of Ilorin, Kwara State?
v. What are the solutions to the challenges of entrepreneurship education in supporting start-up founders at the University of Ilorin, Kwara State?

Methodolog

This study adopted a descriptive survey design suitable for collecting data from a representative sample to describe existing conditions, beliefs, and behaviours. According to Check and Schutt (2012), survey research involves gathering information from a sample through responses to structured questions. This appropriate design allows the researcher to explore the applicability of entrepreneurship education to start-up formation among the students of the University of Ilorin. The population comprises all students at the University of Ilorin, totalling over 48,000 (Student Affairs Unit, 2024). A random sampling technique was used to select 300 respondents for the study. Data was collected using a researcher-designed Entrepreneurship Education and Students Start-Up Questionnaire (EESSQ) questionnaire. The instrument consists of two sections: Section A gathers demographic data, while Section B addresses items related to the research questions. To establish

the validity of the instrument, the questionnaire were reviewed by three experts in the Department of Educational Management. Their feedback was taken and necessary revisions were made before a pilot study was carried out. For reliability, a test-retest method was conducted with a different group of students. The results were analysed and reliability coefficients were obtained for the seven constructs above the threshold value of 0.7. The researcher personally administer the questionnaires to selected students in the Business Education program. Observations on students' enterprise sales performance was also documented to support findings on the influence of market segmentation. Data was analysed using SPSS. Mean and standard deviation were applied to answer the research questions raised.

Results and Discussions of Findings

This study investigates the assessment of the undergraduate entrepreneurship curriculum's applicability to support start-up founders at the University of Ilorin, Kwara State.

Research Question One: What is entrepreneurship education's effectiveness level at the University of Ilorin in business creation and growth?

Table 1: Level of effectiveness of entrepreneurship education at the University of Ilorin in business creation and growth

Item No	Statements	Mean Score	Remarks
1.	A well-developed business plan is essential for securing funding for a new venture	2.78	Agreed
2.	Businesses can only achieve growth by expanding their product offerings	2.76	Agreed
3.	Strong customer relationships are a key factor in sustainable business growth	2.81	Agreed

The effectiveness of entrepreneurship education at the University of Ilorin in business creation and growth is positively perceived, as indicated by the mean scores for various statements. For instance, the importance of a well-developed business plan for securing funding (mean score of 2.78) and the significance of expanding product offerings for business growth (mean score of 2.76) are acknowledged. Additionally, the role of strong customer relationships in sustainable business growth, with a mean score of 2.81, underscores the emphasis on maintaining customer connections as a key growth strategy.

These findings suggest that entrepreneurship education at the University of Ilorin effectively prepares students for the practical aspects of business creation and growth, though continuous improvement is needed to further enhance these skills.

Research Question Two: What are the issues of business growth in the University of Ilorin?

Table 2: Issues of business growth in the University of Ilorin

Item No	Statements	Mean Score	Remarks
1.	Increased competition is the biggest challenge faced by businesses looking to grow education effectiv	2.78	Agreed
2.	Focusing solely on short-term profits is the best strategy for business growth	2.73	Agreed
3.	Businesses can achieve growth without taking any risks	2.75	Agreed

The table highlights the challenges associated with business growth in the University of Ilorin, with increased competition being identified as the biggest challenge (mean score of 2.78). Moreover, focusing solely on short-term profits (mean score of 2.73) and the perception that growth can be achieved without taking

risks (mean score of 2.75) indicate potential misconceptions or strategic misalignments among students. These results point to the need for a balanced approach in entrepreneurship education that addresses long-term strategies, risk management, and competitive analysis to prepare students for sustainable business growth better.

Research Question Three: What are the sources of funds for entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin?
Table 3: Sources of funds for entrepreneurs in the University of Ilorin

Item No	Statements	Mean Score	Remarks
1.	Bootstrapping (using personal savings) is a viable source of funding for all businesses	3.01	Agreed
2.	Equity financing offers a lower risk for new businesses compared to debt financing	3.11	Agreed
3.	Crowdfunding is a reliable option for raising large amounts of capital.	2.99	Agreed

The effectiveness of various funding sources for entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin is positively viewed, with bootstrapping (using personal savings) being seen as a viable option (mean score of 3.01) and equity financing considered less risky than debt financing (mean score of 3.11). Crowdfunding also emerged as a reliable option for raising significant capital (mean score of 2.99). These findings suggest that students are aware of diverse funding mechanisms and their relative benefits, indicating a well-rounded understanding of financial strategies for entrepreneurship. However, it also highlights the need for continued education on these funding sources' practical applications and potential pitfalls.

Research Question Four: What are the entrepreneurial marketing strategies for entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin?
Table 4: Entrepreneurial marketing strategies for entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin

Item No	Statements	Mean Score	Remarks
1.	Traditional marketing strategies are not effective for start-ups	2.81	Agreed
2.	Building a strong social media presence is crucial for entrepreneurial marketing	2.76	Agreed
3.	Effective marketing for start-ups focuses solely on generating immediate sales	2.78	Agreed

Entrepreneurial marketing strategies are perceived as crucial for start-ups at the University of Ilorin, with traditional marketing strategies being deemed ineffective (mean score of 2.81) and a strong social media presence considered vital (mean score of 2.76). The focus on generating immediate sales as an effective marketing strategy (mean score of 2.78) indicates a pragmatic approach towards revenue generation. These findings highlight the importance of modern marketing techniques and the integration of digital platforms in entrepreneurial ventures, suggesting that students recognise the value of adaptive and innovative marketing strategies in the start-up ecosystem.

Research Question Five: What are the New Opportunities for Expansion (E-Business) for entrepreneurs in the University of Ilorin?

Table 5: New Opportunities for Expansion (E-Business) at the University of Ilorin

Item No	Statements	Mean Score	Remarks
1.	E-commerce is only relevant for businesses selling physical products	2.81	Agreed
2.	A strong online presence is essential for business growth in today's world	2.76	Agreed
3.	Existing brick-and-mortar businesses cannot benefit from adopting e-commerce strategies.	2.78	Agreed

Table indicates that e-business opportunities are well-regarded among entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin, with e-commerce being relevant for both physical and digital products (mean score of 2.81) and the necessity of a strong online presence for business growth (mean score of 2.76). However, there is a misconception that existing brick-and-mortar businesses cannot benefit from e-commerce strategies (mean score of 2.78). These findings suggest that while students appreciate the importance of e-commerce, there is a need for greater emphasis on how traditional businesses can leverage online strategies for expansion and growth.

Research Question Six: What are the Ethics and Social Responsibility for entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin?

Table 6: Ethics and Social Responsibility for Entrepreneurs in the University of Ilorin

Item No	Statements	Mean Score	Remarks
1.	E-commerce is only relevant for businesses selling physical products	2.81	Agreed
2.	A strong online presence is essential for business growth in today's world	2.76	Agreed
3.	Existing brick-and-mortar businesses cannot benefit from adopting e-commerce strategies.	2.78	Agreed

The perception of ethics and social responsibility among entrepreneurs at the University of Ilorin aligns with the contemporary business environment, with a strong online presence being deemed essential for business growth (mean score of 2.76). The belief that e-commerce is only relevant for physical products (mean score of 2.81) and that brick-and-mortar businesses cannot benefit from e-commerce (mean score of 2.78) suggests a need for better understanding of the broader applications of e-commerce. These results highlight the importance of integrating ethical considerations and social responsibility into the entrepreneurship curriculum to ensure students are well-prepared to navigate the complexities of modern business practices.

Discussions of Findings

This study assessed the applicability of the undergraduate entrepreneurship curriculum in supporting start-up founders at the University of Ilorin. The findings reveal nuanced insights into the strengths and limitations of the existing program and align with broader patterns in entrepreneurship education literature. The participants generally agreed that entrepreneurship education positively impacts business creation by equipping students with essential knowledge such as business planning, customer management, and growth strategies. This is consistent with Shane, Locke, and Collins (2003), who argued that entrepreneurship education enhances entrepreneurial intention through structured exposure to business principles.

However, the moderate mean scores suggest that while theoretical knowledge is transferred, practical application remains limited. This gap between theory and practice echoes the concerns raised by Nabi et al. (2017) that traditional entrepreneurship education often lacks experiential learning components crucial for

venture creation. Students may know what to do but lack the how—the actionable know-how gained through simulations, mentorship, and real-life start-up practice.

Thus, while the curriculum provides a strong conceptual foundation, it requires greater integration of experiential learning opportunities such as business incubators, internships, and start-up labs to translate intentions into sustainable entrepreneurial actions.

The results show that students identify increased competition, short-termism, and aversion to risk as significant barriers to start-up success. These challenges align with earlier findings by Brown and Wilson (2017), who noted that nascent entrepreneurs in emerging economies often fail to scale due to poor strategic planning and risk mismanagement. Interestingly, the finding that students believe businesses can achieve growth without taking risks suggests a critical misconception about entrepreneurship itself, which is inherently risk-based (Knight, 1921; McMullen & Shepherd, 2006). This misperception could hinder venture resilience in volatile markets and indicates a need for the curriculum to emphasise entrepreneurial risk-taking and opportunity recognition as non-negotiable elements of business success.

Moreover, the short-term profit focus reveals a potential myopia in students' entrepreneurial orientation. Emphasising long-term value creation, strategic thinking, and sustainable business models should be prioritised in the curriculum to counteract this tendency.

Students demonstrated reasonable awareness of personal savings (bootstrapping), equity financing, and crowdfunding as viable funding strategies. This reflects progress in exposing students to diverse financial models beyond traditional bank loans, a shift also observed by Davis (2021).

Nevertheless, the data suggest that while students know of these sources, their practical understanding remains superficial. Without robust knowledge of investment negotiations, pitching, financial forecasting, and crowdfunding dynamics, many start-ups risk failure despite initial funding awareness. This reinforces Oosterbeek et al. (2010) 's call for embedding actionable financial literacy and entrepreneurial finance into undergraduate programs.

Integrating partnerships with angel investor networks, crowdfunding platforms, and venture capitalists into entrepreneurship education could bridge this critical competence gap.

The findings confirm students' recognition of the importance of modern marketing strategies such as building a strong social media presence. This aligns with contemporary marketing shifts noted by Kumar and Singh (2018), where digital platforms now dominate customer acquisition channels for start-ups.

However, the overemphasis on immediate sales generation rather than long-term brand building reveals an incomplete understanding of entrepreneurial marketing. Start-ups that prioritise short-term revenue at the expense of customer loyalty, value propositions, and brand equity often struggle with sustainability (Martin & Clark, 2019).

Therefore, the entrepreneurship curriculum must stress the strategic aspects of marketing, particularly customer journey mapping, content marketing, community building, and customer retention, as key growth drivers in modern entrepreneurial ecosystems.

Respondents generally acknowledged the importance of an online presence but showed misconceptions regarding the relevance of e-commerce for traditional brick-and-mortar businesses. This finding reflects a partial digital literacy among students and resonates with Anderson (2020), who emphasised the necessity of digital entrepreneurship skills in the 21st-century marketplace. Given the increasing hybridisation of business models (physical + digital), entrepreneurship education must demonstrate how even traditionally offline businesses (e.g., retail, education, manufacturing) can leverage digital tools for expanded market reach, customer engagement, and operational efficiency. Courses on digital transformation, platform economy, and business model innovation are urgently needed to correct prevailing misconceptions.

The findings reveal that students understand the significance of ethics and social responsibility in building sustainable ventures. This recognition is crucial, given that contemporary customers increasingly patronise businesses that demonstrate corporate social responsibility (Taylor, 2021).

However, ethical and social considerations must go beyond surface-level discussions. Entrepreneurship curricula should integrate topics like environmental sustainability, social innovation, impact entrepreneurship, and stakeholder theory. Preparing entrepreneurs to generate profits and create social value will enhance their

start-ups' resilience, reputation, and long-term viability in an increasingly purpose-driven economy (Porter & Kramer, 2011).

Conclusion

The effectiveness of entrepreneurship education at the University of Ilorin shows promise but also reveals significant areas needing improvement, especially in practical skill application and comprehensive strategic understanding. The curriculum should address these gaps by incorporating more useful experiences, balanced marketing approaches, and detailed financial and e-commerce strategies.

Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusions of the study, it was recommended that stakeholders should;

1. Integrate more hands-on projects and real-world case studies into the entrepreneurship curriculum to improve students' practical skills and application of business concepts.
2. Provide comprehensive training on competition, risk management, and long-term business strategies to address current gaps in students' understanding of business growth challenges.
3. Include detailed case studies and practical exercises related to various funding sources to enhance students' understanding of their real-world applications.
4. Develop curriculum content covering modern and traditional marketing strategies to give students a well-rounded perspective on effective marketing practices.
5. Educate students on how e-commerce can complement traditional business models and address misconceptions about its applicability to various types of businesses.

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